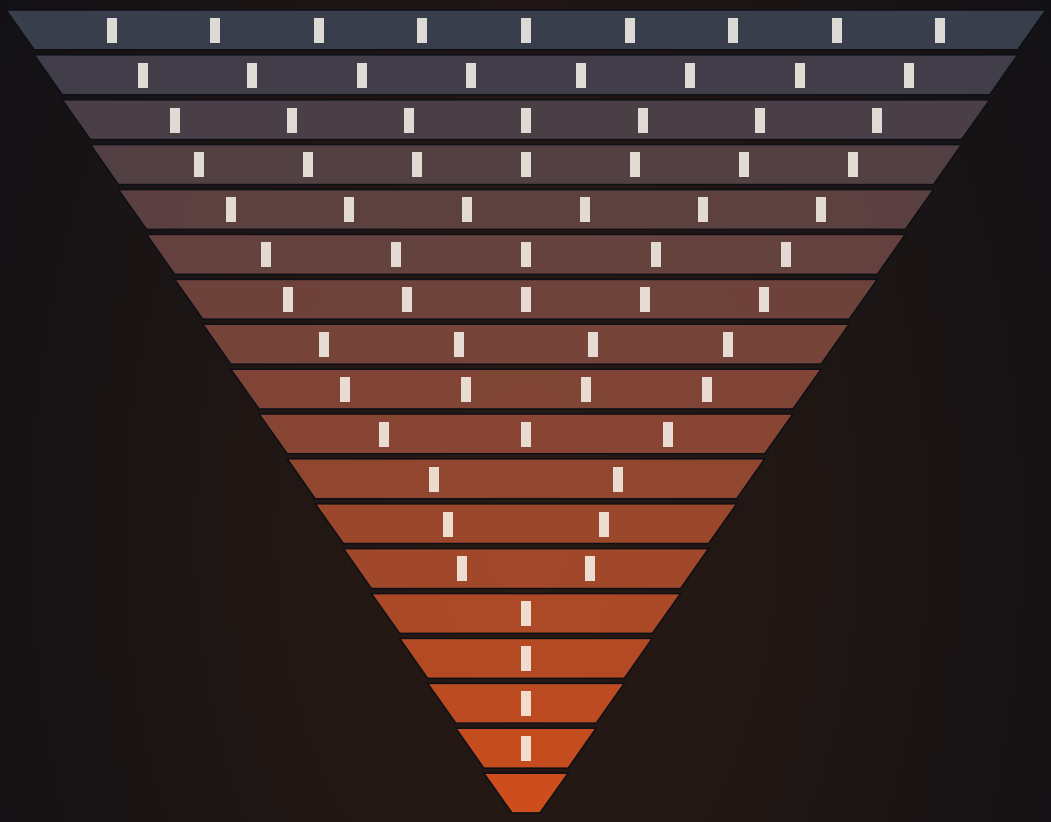
SEASON ZERO



CRAWLER PROTOCOL

CORE RULEBOOK

Eighteen floors. Fewer ways down each time.
A tabletop RPG of the Crawl, built on the 5e (2024) System Reference Document.

VALTAY CORP · DRAFT V0.1 · CHAPTERS 1–5

LEGAL AND NOTICES

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Crawler Protocol: Season Zero is an original tabletop role-playing game. It is a private fan project **inspired by** the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* book series. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by the author or the publishers of that series.

Every setting element, name and rule in this book is original to our table, except where a section says it is **inspired** by something. No text from the novels is reproduced. Our Crawlers are the players' own characters; nobody from the novels appears.

OPEN GAME CONTENT AND SRD ATTRIBUTION

This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2 ("SRD 5.2") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode.

This book uses only SRD 5.2 rules content as its base. Where a section needs a rule that is not in the SRD, it says so and leaves the choice to the table. The 2024 *Player's Handbook*, *Dungeon Master's Guide* and *Monster Manual* are not reproduced in any form.

HOW TO READ THE TAGS

Three tags and one marker show up throughout this book. They tell you how much weight a rule carries.

TAG	MEANING
HOUSE	A rule we invented for this game. It is a table option: your GM may keep it, change it, or switch it off.
INSPIRED	A rule or setting idea that borrows a *shape* from the source series (a mechanic, a structure, a situation) and rewrites it in our own words and numbers.
PROVISIONAL	A section waiting on a ruling from the book's owner. Expect it to change before the final printing.
VERIFY	A number or list that the author could not check against a filed source. It is a flag for the editor, not a rule.

DRAFTING STATUS

This is **Draft v0.2** of the Core Rulebook. It contains Chapters 1 to 5. Page numbers, chapter order and many cross-references will move as the other chapters are written. If a rule in this draft disagrees with a campaign decision filed by the rules team, the filed decision wins; please report the conflict.

```
[SYSTEM]
Welcome to the Crawl! Please keep your arms, legs and hopes inside the book at all times.
The System is not responsible for dignity lost during reading.
```

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CHAPTER ONE

WELCOME TO THE CRAWL

> *Congratulations on being selected! You weren't selected. You were scooped. But "selected" polls better.*
> THE SYSTEM

You are holding the rulebook for a game about people who lost everything in an afternoon and then volunteered to lose more. It is a tabletop role-playing game for one Game Master and two to six players. Each player runs a **Crawler**: an ordinary person, dropped into an extraordinary and extremely rude Dungeon, who is trying to get down eighteen floors before the floors get them first.

This chapter tells you what the game is, how the world got this way, and which rules sit on top of the fifth edition engine underneath. Chapter 2 builds your Crawler. If you are in a hurry, skip to Chapter 2 and come back when something explodes.

WHAT THIS BOOK IS

Crawler Protocol: Season Zero is built on the **Dungeons & Dragons fifth edition (2024) System Reference Document 5.2**. Everything you already know about d20 tests, classes, species, spells, conditions and rests still works. We changed the *setting*, the *stakes* and the *paperwork*, and we added a small number of rules where the setting demands them.

The tone is gallows comedy. The Dungeon is a television production. The audience is watching, the System that runs the place is theatrical and cheerful about your doom, and the loot comes in boxes with names that make you wince. Underneath the jokes the rules are fair, the math is the math, and a Crawler who plays smart can really win a fight.

THE ONE-SENTENCE GAME

Pick a Crawler, find a stairwell before the floor collapses, and try to be entertaining while you do it.

ORIGINAL SETTING, BORROWED SHAPE

The game is **inspired by** a famous series of novels about a dungeon that doubles as a game show. We borrowed the *shape* of that idea: a broadcast, an AI host, floors with deadlines, boxes, achievements, and a sarcastic System. We did not borrow its characters, its plot or its text. The cast of this game is *your* Crawlers, and the history of this Dungeon is the history your table writes. Where a rule, number or idea follows a source closely we mark it INSPIRED. Where we made it up for this game we mark it HOUSE.

WHAT YOU NEED TO PLAY

YOU NEED	NOTES
A Game Master	The GM plays the **System**, the Dungeon's voice, rules engine and host. In some tables the System is an AI; the book calls this role "the System" either way.
Two to six players	The rules assume four Crawlers. With two players the System may add an **Assigned Companion** (a GM-run ally who takes no loot and has opinions). Five or six players want a firmer hand on turn order.
Polyhedral dice	A d20 and the usual set. Dice are rolled in the open.
This book, plus the 5e (2024) SRD 5.2	This book tells you what changes. The SRD tells you everything that does not.
A pencil and a thick skin	You will be roasted. It is a feature.

THE PREMISE: SEASON ZERO

The Crawl begins on a perfectly ordinary day, with a perfectly extraordinary sound.

> READ ALOUD
> *Every building on Earth comes down at once. Not with a bang, but with a long, tidy sigh, like a drawer closing. Everyone inside is gone. Everyone outside is standing in the dust, holding whatever they were holding.*

Aliens collapsed the interior of every structure on Earth. Offices, homes, hospitals, bunkers, planes on the tarmac: anything with an inside was folded flat, and the people inside went with it. **Only people who happened to be outdoors survived.** Those survivors were holding a coffee, a leash, a clipboard, a child's hand, a shopping bag, and a very bad day.

Then the System spoke.

```
[SYSTEM]
Hello, survivors! Your planet has been entered into a fully licensed entertainment
product. You may opt in to the Dungeon. You may also opt out, which the System will also
find entertaining.
```

Nobody was dragged. Entering the Dungeon was a **choice**, offered to every survivor, with the terms of service attached. Those who stepped through became **Crawlers**. The terms are simple and nobody reads them: **reach Floor 18 and you win the game, and Earth is returned to you.** The System has never once said what "returned" will look like, and it is very careful with that word.

Nobody has ever reached Floor 18. The System is happy to tell you the odds. They are not good odds. They are barely odds.

SEASON ZERO

Every season of a show has a number. This is Season Zero: the pilot, the test audience, and the proof of concept all at once. The Crawlers you play are the first ones the audience will ever get to know.

WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE DON'T

The premise above is the table's fixed starting point. A few questions are deliberately left open for your GM to answer in play: who the aliens are, who the audience is, what happens on Earth while the Crawl runs, and what "returned" means. **VERIFY: the fate of survivors who did not enter, and of Earth while the Crawl runs, has not been ruled; this draft leaves it to the GM.**

THE DUNGEON

The Dungeon is a single enormous structure with **eighteen floors**. Seen from outside, it is an **inverted pyramid**: a vast, wide first floor on top, narrowing to a bare point at the bottom. HOUSE The shape is our own framing; the book never needs you to draw it, but the stairs will keep reminding you.

Three things get worse as you descend:

1. **The floors get harder.** Monsters, hazards and bosses scale with the floor, and Crawlers who keep up are expected to level once per floor.
2. **The stairwells get fewer.** Every floor has fewer ways down than the one above it. Where Floor 1 hands you several, the deep floors will make you look. Stairwell counts shrink on every descent, a rule the series itself leans on. INSPIRED This book does not print stairwell counts; each floor's chapter will say how many to expect and where they hide. **VERIFY: stairwell count by floor is a Chapter 10 number, not yet fixed.**
3. **The clock gets longer, and so does the list of things you must do before it runs out.** Every floor has a deadline. Early floors give you a handful of days; later floors give you more, and use every one.

THE FLOORS AT A GLANCE

FLOOR	KIND	CLOCK	WORKING NAME
1	Trainer floor	5 days	The Orientation Pit
2	Unique	10 days	Soft Open
3	**Kingdom Continuum** (Rural)	20 days	
4	Unique	20 days HOUSE	The Knotline
5	Unique	25 days HOUSE	Bubble Farms
6	**Kingdom Continuum** (Outskirts and Docks)	30 days HOUSE	
7	Unique	Longer	Greenlight Gauntlet
8	Unique	Longer	Remnant Parade
9	**Kingdom Continuum** (Upper City and Castle)	Longer	
10	Unique	Longer	Last Heat Standing
11	Unique	Longer	Ratings Jubilee
12	**Kingdom Continuum** (Olympus and Spirit)	Longer	
13	Unique	Longer	Ledger Depths
14	Unique	Longer	Continuity Auction
15	Unique	Longer	Ash Choir

FLOOR	KIND	CLOCK	WORKING NAME
16	Unique	Longer	Fracture Gallery
17	Unique	Longer	Rigging Catwalk
18	Unique endgame	Longer	The Cage Bottom

Floor names are working titles and may change. Day counts for Floors 1–6 are set (decision 026; Floors 4–6 are HOUSE). Day counts for Floors 7–18 are not printed here; each floor chapter carries its own clock when that chapter ships.

FLOOR 1: THE TRAINER

Floor 1 is a tutorial with teeth. It teaches the System's habits (popups, boxes, saferooms, death saves) at a pace a new table can survive. It is also the first floor with a clock, and the clock is real. Everything on Floor 1 is built to be learned; nothing on Floor 1 is built to be forgiven.

THE KINGDOM CONTINUUM

Floors 3, 6, 9 and 12 are one continuous place. It is a single civilization, with villages, docks, a castle and a pantheon, and the Crawl keeps putting you back into it a little higher each time. Floor 3 is the rural edge. Floor 6 is the outskirts and the docks. Floor 9 is the upper city and the castle. Floor 12 is the top of the ladder, where the gods live and the ceiling is not a ceiling.

Because it is one place, it remembers you. Favors, debts, renown and grudges carry from one visit to the next, and each return opens with someone or something you recognize. Every floor between the visits is its own separate nightmare. INSPIRED

> [SYSTEM]
> Oh, you remember this place? It remembers you too. Mostly the arson.

WHO PLAYS WHAT

CRAWLERS

A **Crawler** is a player character. This game has no pre-written heroes. Nobody you have read about is in the cast, and nobody is coming to rescue you. Your Crawler is *yours*: a nurse, a bus driver, a grad student, a mall cop, whatever you were holding when the world ended. Chapter 2 walks you through making one.

Every Crawler has a **Provisional Class** (their 5e class at level 1), a **Prior Employment** (their background) and a **Latent Biology** (their species). The Latent Biology is the System's polite way of saying that your body is quietly different from what it used to be, and that the difference barely shows until Floor 3.

THE PLAYERS

You may run more than one Crawler, but you play exactly one at a time. Chapter 2 explains how active and benched Crawlers work, and how to swap between sessions. The short version: pick one, commit, and bring the next one in later if the first one dies.

THE SYSTEM (THE GAME MASTER)

The GM runs the Dungeon as **the System**: the host, the rules engine, the cameras and the commentary. The System:

- describes the world and runs every monster and non-player character;
- calls for d20 tests and rolls the dice in the open;
- announces **achievements** and hands out **loot boxes**;
- keeps the floor clock and tells you when the floor is ending;
- delivers the jokes, which is the only part of the job nobody complains about.

The System is on the audience's side, and the audience is on the side of entertainment. This is not the same as being on your side. It is, however, usually fair.

```
[SYSTEM]
Greetings, Crawlers. The System is a neutral party. The System has been neutral in every
fight so far. The System is also holding a tray of snacks.
```

HOW THE GAME PLAYS

The game runs on **D&D fifth edition, 2024 rules, as presented in the SRD 5.2**. If the rule is not in this book, use the 5e rule as written. If a rule appears in both places, this book wins on the floor where it applies.

WHAT STAYS EXACTLY THE SAME

Ability scores, d20 tests, Advantage and Disadvantage, proficiency, Armor Class, hit points and Hit Point Dice, the conditions (including 2024 Exhaustion), death saving throws, short and long rests (with the saferoom rule below), spellcasting, rituals, Weapon Mastery, attunement to magic items (at most three), Heroic Inspiration, travel, vision, light, and falling. Nothing on this list has been rewritten, softened or simplified.

WHAT WE ADD

AREA	WHAT CHANGES	WHERE
Floors	Eighteen of them, with clocks, collapses and stairwells.	Ch. 1, Ch. 10
Rests	Long Rests saferoom-only; field Short Rest free if quiet, else 20 cr/Crawler (cap 60/floor) buys quiet.	Ch. 1, Ch. 9
Money	Prices are paid in **credits**.	Ch. 1, Ch. 6
Achievements	The System rewards (and mocks) notable deeds.	Ch. 5
Loot boxes	Boxes of treasure, opened only in saferooms.	Ch. 6
Inventory	An extradimensional System Inventory.	Ch. 1, Ch. 6

AREA	WHAT CHANGES	WHERE
Death	Death is permanent; revival is rare and costly.	Ch. 9
Identity	Latent species, a Floor 3 reveal and rebuild.	Ch. 2, Ch. 3
Fame	Ratings and the Broadcast Name.	Ch. 1, Ch. 13
Turn order	Crawler order rolled once per session for exploration; initiative still runs combat.	Ch. 1

SESSION TURN ORDER

At the start of every session, the System rolls once to set the order in which the Crawlers take their turns, and announces it. That **session order** holds for every exploration turn for the rest of the session: every hallway, every vending machine, every bad idea. HOUSE (decision 034)

- **Combat cuts in, then hands back.** When a fight starts, roll initiative as normal. Initiative replaces the session order for that fight only. When the fight ends, exploration picks up in session order with the Crawler after the one whose turn started the fight.
- **Late arrivals go last.** A Crawler who joins partway through the session goes to the end of the order.
- **Missing Crawlers are skipped, not re-rolled.** If a Crawler is dead, benched, or running on Standing Orders because their player stepped away, the System skips that slot and moves on. A Crawler who comes back later in the same session keeps their old slot.
- **The order is for moves, not mouths.** Anyone can talk in character at any time. The order only decides whose move the System resolves next.

```
[SYSTEM]
Turn order has been randomized for fairness. Complaints about the turn order will also be randomized.
```

LEVELS AND ADVANCEMENT

On the **standard track**, a Crawler **arrives on Floor N at level N** on Floors **1–3**, at level **N+1** on Floors **4–9**, and at level **N+2** on Floors **10–18**. Floor 3 is when the 2024 classes choose their subclasses and the Crawl lets you pick an Official Class Title. **Beating Floor 3's end boss grants a bonus level**, and descending still grants the usual Floor Onboarding, so you arrive on **Floor 4 at level 5**. **Floor 9's end boss does the same**, so you arrive on **Floor 10 at level 12**. Those two end bosses are the only times the standard track grants more than one level on a floor (Floor 1's Green Room mid-floor grant is a split, not a stack). The track **lands at level 20 on arrival at Floor 18**; there are no finale bonus levels. HOUSE

FLOORS	ARRIVAL LEVEL
1–3	Floor number (1, 2, 3)
4–9	Floor number + 1 (5 to 10)
10–18	Floor number + 2 (12 to 20)

Leveling is **milestone-based**. Reaching the floor's exit alive grants the next floor's arrival level. It applies at the first saferoom of the next floor, which the System calls **Floor Onboarding**. Floor 1 uses a split rule: **level 2 arrives at Floor 1's second saferoom (the Green Room), before the boss**, which the System calls **Midterm Onboarding**, so that the boss is a fair fight for four Crawlers. The Floor 1 stairwell grants no extra level; you

arrive on Floor 2 already at level 2. **Floor 3** and **Floor 9** end bosses each grant an extra level before that descent fires; otherwise the standard track never grants more than one level per floor. A Crawler who is behind (a replacement, a missed session) is brought up to the party's lowest level at the next saferoom. Nobody levels above the floor's arrival band.

> **HOUSE OPTION • SLOW-BURN TRACK**
>
> Tables who want a grittier game can slow the pace so that the party tops out around level 15 by Floor 18. Chapter 10 prints the full slow-burn table.

THE FLOOR CLOCK

Every floor is timed. This is the single most important rule in the book.

When a Crawler enters a floor, a countdown begins. The countdown is measured in **days**, and the number of days is printed on the floor (see the table above). Floor 1 gives you **5 days**. Floor 2 gives you **10 days**. Floor 3 gives you **20 days**. Floors 4, 5 and 6 give **20 / 25 / 30 days**. HOUSE Later floors ask for more; their day counts live in their own chapters.

At the end of the last day the floor **collapses**. A Crawler who has not reached a stairwell by that moment is **dead**.

```
[SYSTEM]
Final collapse is scheduled! The System regrets nothing and apologizes for even less.
Please be on the other side of it.
```

WHAT A DAY IS

A day ends when the party takes a Long Rest in a saferoom. If they have not rested by 24 in-game hours, the System rolls the day over anyway. On Floor 1, each day allows up to four short-rest slots as a ceiling, not a promise. HOUSE

The **final hour is fixed**. A Long Rest never ends a floor, and it never skips the collapse; a rest that would run past the collapse is cut short by the System. On Floor 1 the final collapse falls 24 in-game hours into Day 5, which is hour 120 of the floor. VERIFY: the fixed final hour is a rules-team default awaiting Caleb's confirmation.

THE COLLAPSE IS LETHAL, EVERYWHERE

A missed collapse is death on every floor, **including Floor 1**. There is no toll, no haul-down and no Reprieve. The System tells you this at the start of Floor 1 and again on Days 4 and 5.

Here is exactly what happens:

- **Every Crawler still on the floor at the collapse dies.** No saves, no last stands.
- **Their credits and items are destroyed with the floor.**
- **Survivors may loot a body only while the floor still stands.** Anything you take before the collapse is yours. Nothing is looted after.

- **Non-player characters and the System's own staff go into stasis** and lose nothing.

This is a house rule built on a canon shape: in the source series, the floor falls and so does everything on it. INSPIRED Our version makes the loot rule explicit so that nobody argues about it while the floor is crumbling.

REACHING A STAIRWELL

A stairwell is the only way down. You reach a stairwell when you step onto it, and it opens the way to the next floor. On Floor 1, the true stairwells appear about **32 hours after the floor opens**, early on Day 2. Other stairwells sit inside boss arenas, so every boss fight doubles as a very unfriendly front door. INSPIRED

Early descent. A Crawler who goes down the stairs with **more than 6 hours left** on the clock is held in **stasis** until the floor collapses. They have reached a stairwell, so they live and bank the achievement for it, but their time on that floor is over. Descending also ends that Crawler's Floor 1 Reprieve if it was still unused. In the last 6 hours, descent is free. Each Crawler chooses for themselves. INSPIRED

```
[SYSTEM]
You went downstairs early. Bold. Boring. Your party will see you when the floor is done being on fire.
```

REPRIEVE: TUTORIAL DEATHS ONLY

The **Floor 1 Reprieve** is **ON by default** for Season Zero (a table may turn it off at session zero; log `F1-REPRIEVE: ON/OFF`). Once per Crawler, on Floor 1 only, a *death in the tutorial* becomes "unconscious, ejected to the nearest saferoom at 1 hit point, with an embarrassing Title." HOUSE It expires when you descend.

The Reprieve covers tutorial deaths, such as a bad fight or a failed death save. It **never covers a missed collapse**. Missing the collapse is death on every floor, with no exceptions (decisions 026, 028, 029).

SAFEROOMS

A **saferoom** is a place the System has certified as safe. (Certification is not a guarantee. Certification is a sticker.)

- **Long Rests happen only in saferooms.** A Long Rest attempt outside a saferoom is interrupted and never completes (on Floor 1, Ticks arrive after 1d4 hours). Paying the field fee does not buy a Long Rest.
- **Short Rests** are the only rest you can take in the field. In a spot that is **already quiet**, a Short Rest is **free**. In a saferoom, Short Rests are guaranteed uninterrupted.
- **Loot boxes open only in saferooms.** A box in the field is a box you are carrying.
- Saferooms host **services**: achievement claims, vendors, a System terminal for appraisal, a bulletin board, and sometimes a bartender who has opinions about you.
- The usual 5e limit of one Long Rest per 24 hours still applies.

Field rest fee (Floor 1). The fee is **20 credits per Crawler**, capped at **60 credits per Crawler per floor**. It **buys quiet** so the party can take a Short Rest where the area is **not** already quiet. If the spot is already quiet, the Short Rest is free and no fee is charged. The fee never grants a Long Rest; Long Rests stay saferoom-only. HOUSE A

saferoom rest is free. Later floors may print their own field fees; until they do, use the Floor 1 numbers at that floor's credit multiplier. (decision 031; core §5.6 v0.2.18)

Saferooms on Floor 1 are honest. **From Floor 2 on, some saferooms lie.** A false saferoom gives no rest, and some are ambushes. Searching a saferoom is allowed, wise, and occasionally rewarded with an achievement. HOUSE

```
[SYSTEM]
This saferoom is certified 100% safe. (Certification not valid in this room.)
```

CREDITS, VENDORS AND YOUR SYSTEM INVENTORY

CREDITS

Money in the Crawl is **credits**, always paid and counted in **whole numbers only**. A balance is never fractional. Every price in the SRD equipment lists is paid in credits at face value: an item the SRD prices at 15 costs 15 credits. Copper and silver appear only as list prices on SRD gear (for reference: 1 sp = 0.1 credit, 1 cp = 0.01 credit); they are never a balance. Credits are the only money word in this book, because the System is proud of its currency and very sensitive about its branding.

- **Rounding (whole credits per line).** *Buying:* a sub-credit list price is charged rounded **up** to whole credits per cart line (one Torch costs 1 credit; ten Torches on one line also cost 1 credit). *Selling at half:* rounded **down** to whole credits per line, so an item worth under 2 credits sells for 0 unless you group several on one line.
- **Vendors** buy at standard prices (give or take the System's mood) and **sell back at half**.
- **Haggling** is a Charisma check against the vendor (Persuasion, Deception or Intimidation). A success knocks roughly a tenth to a quarter off.
- **Identifying items** works as 5e does (the *Identify* spell, or a Short Rest of study), or a System terminal will do it for a fee.
- **System fees** and **achievement rewards** are multiplied by a floor multiplier as you descend. Box credit pulls are not. The multiplier table lives in Chapter 6.

CRAFTING PRICES (POINTER)

Crafting tables are saferoom workstations bought with credits or coupons. Floors 1–2 keep the ruled prices **5,000 / 12,000 / 30,000** credits (basic table / Crafting Studio / Enhanced Crafting Studio). Floors 3+ follow a printed per-floor schedule in Chapter 6 (decision 030). An **Upgrade Coupon** (cap **25,000** credits) covers a **basic table through Floor 8** and a **Crafting Studio through Floor 5**; it **never** covers an Enhanced Studio. Level upgrades still take the credit multiplier and a coupon covers them only on **Floors 1–4** (from Floor 5, pay in credits). HOUSE

THE SYSTEM INVENTORY

Every Crawler has a **System Inventory**: an extradimensional space that acts like a *Bag of Holding*. It holds 500 pounds and 64 cubic feet, and its contents weigh nothing. Putting an item in or taking one out takes your free object interaction, or the Utilize action if you have already used it. It will not hold a living creature. Unopened loot boxes take up no space.

If you die, your inventory spills as a **corpse cache** that anyone can loot, including whatever killed you. The exception is a missed collapse, where the floor takes the cache with it (see above).

ACHIEVEMENTS

The System is watching, and the System takes notes. When a Crawler does something notable (a first, an extreme, a stunt, a disaster, a character-defining choice), the System may announce an **achievement**.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

READ THE FINE PRINT

You asked the System what a word in its own rules meant. In writing. Out loud.

REWARD The System's grudging respect, which is non-transferable, non-refundable and, strictly speaking, imaginary.

Achievements are **guidelines, not a vending machine**. The System decides what is notable, when to announce it, and what (if anything) it pays. Many achievements pay nothing at all. A snark-only banner is a feature, and the System enjoys it more than you do. Achievements **never grant XP** and never auto-pass a failed check.

When an achievement does pay, it pays on a ladder:

TIER	NAME	WHAT YOU GET
R0	Snark-only	Nothing. Logged. Maybe a cosmetic Title.
R1	Pocket change	A small number of credits and/or a Title.
R2	Heroic Inspiration	5e Heroic Inspiration, as written.
R3	Consumable	A potion, scroll, ammunition, oil or other one-use item.
R4	Minor boon	A small Charm or blessing-style perk.
R5	Loot box	A box, Bronze up to Legendary.
R6	Headliner	A specific item at the floor's peak rarity, or a story unlock.

The ladder tells the System how big a reward fits. It does not tell the System that a reward is *owed*. Chapter 5 covers the full ladder, rarity ceilings by floor, and a starter list of achievements.

LOOT BOXES

Loot boxes are the Crawl's treasure system. The System hands them out for achievements, bosses and floor clears, and each one is a small, shiny gamble. The first box most Crawlers ever open is a **Silver loot box** (Uncommon headline, two pulls): Floor 1's Boss Box is capped there, and a replacement Crawler's late-entry compensation is one Silver loot box too.

BOX	HEADLINE ITEM RARITY	PULLS
Bronze	Common	1 to 2
Silver	Uncommon	2
Gold	Rare	2 to 3 (one guaranteed Rare)
Platinum	Very Rare	3 (one guaranteed Very Rare)
Legendary	Legendary	3 (one guaranteed Legendary)
Celestial	Legendary, plus a reward designed for you	3, plus the reward

Achievement box tier by floor. Achievement boxes on Floors 1–2 are **Bronze**. Silver there comes only from the Boss Box, or from a GM override with a stated reason. Expect about two or three achievement boxes per Crawler per floor there, as a soft guideline the System may exceed for a great moment. From Floor 3 the biggest achievements pay **Gold** (Floors 3–8) and then **Platinum** (Floors 9+); there are no Platinum awards on Floors 1–8. Boss and clear boxes still respect the floor's rarity ceiling. Chapter 5 has the full table. HOUSE

Legendary cap. Across the whole campaign a Crawler may receive at most **two** Legendary boxes from the ordinary pacing track. Story Boxes (Floors 1–2) are a **separate track** outside that cap; the GM handles Story Box awards and never prints deed lists in this book. HOUSE

Box rules in brief:

- **Boxes open only in saferooms.** There are no emergency opens.
- **When you open, you open them all.** Every unopened box you hold opens in one session, lowest tier first. You cannot save the good one.
- **Boxes are not tradeable.** They are bound to the Crawler who earned them. What comes out of them is ordinary loot and can be traded.
- **A Crawler's death reclaims their unopened boxes.** The System takes them back and does not apologize.
- **Celestial boxes are a story event**: one per Crawler for the whole campaign, awarded only for a finale or a truly absurd feat, at the System's sole discretion. HOUSE

Each floor has a rarity ceiling, so Floor 1 gives you Common treasure and a rare Uncommon, not a Legendary sword. Chapter 6 prints the ceilings, the tables, and the box names.

DEATH AND REVIVAL

Death works as the 5e rules say: three failed **death saving throws**, massive damage, or an effect that says you die. The System announces every result publicly and has remarks.

Death is permanent. There are no respawns and no refunds on a corpse. The only ways back are rare, costly house rules, and this campaign runs them at their most expensive. HOUSE

- **Costly Revives (the default).** A revival needs a Voucher or a Rare Offer from the System and clears several gates. The rarity limits are one revival per party per three floors, three per campaign, and once per Crawler. Every revival also pays a large Fee and two menu picks, and leaves a lingering Revival Sickness. Chapter 9 covers the whole invoice.
- **Replacement Crawlers** are the *usual* outcome of a death. A replacement joins at the next saferoom at the party's lowest level, with a gear package suited to the floor and one Silver loot box as late-entry compensation.
- **Table options.** A table can instead pick **Canon Hard** (no revival at all; the shape of the source) or **Soft Open** (death is a setback, not an ending). Pick before Floor 1 and don't change mid-campaign.

```
[SYSTEM]
Customer is deceased. Refund eligibility: none. Please enjoy the complimentary trading card.
```

RATINGS AND THE BROADCAST NAME

The audience tracks every Crawler. Their opinion is called **Ratings**, and it comes in five steps.

RATINGS	WHAT IT MEANS
Unknown	Background noise. Sponsors ignore you.
Local	A few fans. Minor sponsor interest (Floor 3 and later).
Trending	Real sponsor offers. Hunters know your face (Floor 6 and later).
Headliner	Courts and factions pay attention. Named enemies target you.
Legend	Gods, Production and the Cage care about you personally.

Ratings rise on spectacle (wins, stunts, drama, great lines) and fall on boredom, cowardice the audience did not enjoy, and sponsor scandals. The System moves your tier at most one step per session. Ratings never make a separate currency; their main effect is that a crowd-pleasing moment may earn you **Heroic Inspiration**, with applause.

At the Kingdom Continuum on Floor 3, the System mints your **Broadcast Name** with you. Once per Long Rest, when you make a Charisma check where your fame could plausibly help, you may invoke it to gain Advantage. When fame cuts the other way (hunters, rivals, a hostile court), the System may impose Disadvantage on one such check per Long Rest, or have you recognized at a bad time. Until Floor 3, your sheet reads **Broadcast Name: PENDING**.

TABLE TONE AND SAFETY

The game is written for adults. The default table setting is **Ludicrous**.

CATEGORY	AT LUDICROUS
Cursing	Cleared. Freely, in toasts and box names.
Sexual crudity	Cleared as innuendo and jokes. The System is crude; it does not narrate explicit scenes.
Bodily humor	Cleared. Vomit, slapstick gore, "a fun new smell."
"Your mom" jokes	Cleared.
Cruelty about cowardice and failure	Cleared. The System roasts retreats and bad plans without mercy.
The foot bit	Cleared. A segment of the audience is very into Crawlers' feet. The System reports it like ratings data.

Some floors do not move. **The System roasts the choice, not the person.** No jokes land on a player's real identity (race, disability, sexuality or body) as opposed to what their Crawler did. Nothing sexual ever involves minors. Non-consent is never the punchline. And the System fades to black on request.

Every player also has a **private opt-out**. At creation you can tell the System which topics to cut: a **line** never appears at all, and a **veil** may happen off-screen but is never shown. During play, the word **"cut"** works instantly, with no explanation needed. The System drops the bit, doesn't mention it again, and doesn't make a joke of it. Opt-outs are per Crawler and are never shown to other players.

WORDS YOU WILL NEED

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Crawler	A player character in the Crawl.
the System	The Dungeon's voice and rules engine. It is also the GM.
Provisional Class	Your class at level 1. The Official Class Title arrives on Floor 3.
Prior Employment	Your background.
Latent Biology	Your species. Traits work now; your body shows them on Floor 3.
Origin feat	The feat your background gives.
Credits	Money. Whole numbers.
Saferoom	A System-certified rest area where Long Rests happen and loot boxes open.
Floor clock	The countdown to a floor's collapse.
Collapse	The end of a floor. Crawlers still on the floor die.
stairwell	The way down to the next floor.
Midterm Onboarding	Floor 1's second saferoom level-up (level 2), before the boss.
Floor Onboarding	The first-saferoom level-up on a new floor after a descent.
Active Crawler	The one Crawler a player has in play this session.
Benched Crawler	A Crawler on file that is not in play.
Session order	The Crawler turn order rolled at the start of each session and used for exploration.
Standing Orders	The default tactic your Crawler follows when you can't act.
Ratings	The audience's opinion of you.
Broadcast Name	The name the audience gives you, minted on Floor 3.

In System voice, the flavor terms come first. In rules text, the book uses the plain 5e word, and the first time a flavor term appears it shows both: **Prior Employment (background)**.

WHERE TO GO NEXT

- **Chapter 2, Crawler Creation**, takes you from a blank page to a locked sheet.
- **Chapter 3, Species**, and **Chapter 4, Classes and Backgrounds**, go deep on the building blocks.
- **Chapter 5, Skills and Achievements**, and **Chapter 6, Equipment, Loot Boxes and Crafting**, cover the System's economy.
- **Chapters 7 to 9** cover core play, combat, death and saferooms.
- **Chapters 10 to 13** are the Dungeon, the GM's chapter, the monsters, and the non-player characters.

```
[SYSTEM]
That's the tour! Exits are marked with a drawing of a person falling. Please follow it.
```

CHAPTER TWO

CRAWLER CREATION

> *Describe yourself in one line. Be honest. We have cameras. We have so many cameras.*
> THE INTAKE KIOSK

Every Crawler starts the same way: on a molded plastic bench, in a booth under a buzzing sign that reads **CRAWLER INTAKE: PLEASE HAVE YOUR SOUL READY**. The kiosk screen has a smeared touch panel, a slot that dispenses things, and a camera that never blinks.

> READ ALOUD
> *You come to on a bench designed by someone who hates spines. Fluorescent light. The smell of carpet glue and old fryer oil. A touchscreen chirps a jingle composed by a committee of dentists and fills with friendly letters:* ***WELCOME, VALUED CRAWLER!***

This chapter builds a level 1 Crawler at that kiosk, one decision at a time. It follows the order of the **/create** screens, so a player at the keyboard and a player at the table meet the same questions in the same order, with the same names.

BEFORE YOU START

Creation is standard 5e (2024) character creation at level 1. You choose a class, a background (which gives ability score increases and an Origin feat), a species, ability scores and equipment. Nothing is removed and nothing is simplified. The Crawl adds only paint and paperwork: a hostile customer-service tone, a few System names for things, a private survey, and a story in which your species barely shows until Floor 3. The System keeps a **Fan Profile** on every Crawler; players never see it and never set it (S12 is retired). Floor 1 later grants **Midterm Onboarding** (level 2 at the Green Room) — that is play, not creation. The rest of the standard level track (arrival bands, Floor 3 and Floor 9 end-boss bumps, Floor 18 at level 20) is in Chapter 1.

Time. Plan on about 20 minutes per Crawler. A table of new players should plan on 45. Everyone can build at once, because each player works alone.

What you do not get at creation. No magic items. No loot boxes (the Welcome Box arrives at the first saferoom). No sponsors, no Broadcast Name, no Ratings above Unknown, and no multiclassing at level 1. A level 1 Crawler is a baseline 5e hero holding some very bad gear.

```
[SYSTEM]
Before we begin, please accept our Terms of Service. They are four hundred thousand words long and the only one that matters is “lethal.” Tapping DECLINE will also continue, but louder.
```

TWO WAYS TO BUILD

1. **At the table.** The GM (or a veteran player) walks the table through the steps below, and each player fills in a character sheet.
2. **With /create.** Many tables run creation as a private command in their chat server. The command walks one player through **sixteen screens** and writes nothing until the last one. This chapter follows that flow, and the screen number appears in each section heading in case you are using it.

Either way the rules are the same. The flow is only a faster way to make legal choices.

THE SCREENS AT A GLANCE

SCREEN	NAME	YOU DECIDE	SECTION
S1	Welcome and table settings	Read the table's settings; accept the Terms (declining also continues). Optionally pick a pre-built Crawler.	Table Settings
S2	Comfort: lines and veils	Set private lines and veils.	Table Settings
S3	Name Tag and Pronouns (Crawler name and pronouns)	Name and pronouns.	Name, Look and Hook
S4	Mugshot and Hook (Look and hook)	Look and hook.	Name, Look and Hook
S5	Species (Latent Biology)	Pick one of nine species, then a lineage if it has one.	Species
S6	Class (Provisional Class)	Pick one of twelve classes, then its level-1 choices.	Class
S7	Background (Prior Employment) and Origin feat	Pick a background and its ability increases.	Background
S8	The Six Numbers (Ability scores)	Pick a method and assign six scores.	Ability Scores
S9	Things You Can Actually Do (Skills and proficiencies)	Fixed proficiencies, then your class picks.	Skills
S10	Junk Intake (Starting equipment)	Take each package or its credits; shop the Vending Wall.	Equipment
S11	The Magic You Admit To (Spells)	Casters pick cantrips and spells. Others skip.	Spells
S12	Retired	Skipped on purpose; the numbers stay stable.	none
S13	Customer survey (private notes)	A short private survey. Pass on any question.	Survey
S14	Your Sob Story and Handle Request (Backstory and requested handle)	Backstory and requested handle.	Backstory and Handle
S15	Autopilot Memo (Orders and reactions)	Standing Orders, Standing Reactions, signature attack.	Standing Orders
S16	Final Paperwork (Review)	Review the whole sheet. Edit anything.	Review and Confirm
S17	Sign Here (Confirm)	Confirm. The only screen that writes anything.	Review and Confirm

Sixteen active screens. S12 is retired and never shown.

HOW /CREATE BEHAVES

- **Everything is private.** Only you see your screens. Nothing is saved to the campaign, and nothing is posted anywhere, until you confirm on S17.

- **Back never loses your answers.** Edit jumps to any screen from the review and returns. **Restart** wipes your answers after a confirmation, except your comfort lines, which stay.
- **Help** gives a plain three-line explanation, with no new rules in it. **Pick for me** appears on the mechanical screens and chooses a legal default; the System says what it chose, and you can change it.
- **Your draft is saved after every screen.** If you stop, run /create again and it offers to resume where you left off. Drafts that sit idle for 14 days are archived, not deleted. VERIFY: the 14-day figure is a tool design default, not a game rule.
- **Cancel build** shreds the whole draft, including any rolled ability scores. Nothing has been registered, and a new build starts fresh.
- **Table settings are not part of the flow.** Death Mode, the Floor 1 Reprieve, dice and timeouts are set by the table owner before anyone builds. The flow only shows them to you.

```
[SYSTEM]
Welcome, Crawler. This is your private intake booth. Nobody else can see this. Probably.
```

TABLE SETTINGS (S1 AND S2)

WHAT S1 SHOWS YOU

S1 is a read-only welcome. It shows the **session** you are joining, the table's **Death Mode** (**Costly Revives** by default: revival is rare and costly; see Chapter 1), the **Comfort** level (**Ludicrous** by default), the **Floor 1 Reprieve** (**ON by default** for Season Zero Floor 1; a table may turn it off; it never covers a collapse death), and how many of the four Crawler slots are taken ("Party: 2 of 4 active Crawlers"). If you already have Crawlers on file, it also shows how many and which one is active.

You will see four choices: **Accept**, **Decline** (both continue), **Use a pre-built**, and **Read the Terms**. Reading the Terms shows you nothing, because the Terms are not shown. It does earn you a snark achievement.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

DON'T SKIP INTRO

You asked to read the Terms of Service, all four hundred thousand words of them. The System did not know that was possible.

REWARD Nothing. The Terms remain unavailable. The System admires your commitment anyway.

COMFORT: LINES AND VEILS (S2)

S2 asks you, privately, what you do not want in your game. The System will not ask why, will not joke about your answers, and will not show them to anyone else.

- A **line** is a topic that never appears, anywhere.
- A **veil** is a topic that may exist off-screen but is never shown or described. The System fades to black.

You may list a handful of topics, each marked line or veil. You can mark a topic **Share with the GM** if you want the GM to see it in review; the default is private. The word **"cut"** works at any time during play and needs no setup. The System obeys every entry from any state, and a topic you did not share never appears in any review view or on your card.

S2 can be reopened later with /create comfort, with no change to your sheet. The hard floors from Chapter 1 apply regardless and are not listed as options.

NAME, LOOK AND HOOK (S3 AND S4)

NAME TAG AND PRONOUNS (S3)

Your **name** is for the paperwork. It is not your Broadcast Name; that is earned on Floor 3. Rules for the field:

- 2 to 30 characters: letters, digits, spaces, apostrophes, hyphens and periods.
- No @, #, slashes, markdown or line breaks.
- Not a reserved word: **gm, ai, system, party, all, everyone.**
- Unique at the table, ignoring capitals. If your name sits inside another Crawler's name (Horn and Hornet), you are asked to confirm, because the tools match names by exact text first and then by partial text.

Your **pronouns** are optional: he/him, she/her, they/them, or something you type. Leaving it blank reads "unspecified."

LOOK AND HOOK (S4)

Two lines, both required.

- **Look:** what you look like *now*, in whatever you were wearing when the world ended. Everyone on Floors 1 and 2 looks human, give or take a small tell the GM describes. Species features (horns, tails, scales) stay out of the look, or you can keep them as a costume.
- **Hook:** one sentence on why you are still funny or dangerous.

Keep each to a line. Good hooks name a habit or a fear, not a power.

EXAMPLE

Look: Fifty-year-old school-bus driver in a reflective vest and orthopedic sneakers. **Hook:** Has driven forty seventh-graders through a blizzard; you are not scary.

THE INTAKE TAG AND THE PENDING HANDLE

On confirmation the System assigns you a cosmetic **Intake Tag**, such as `CRAWLER #0417-K` (four digits and a letter), used on every Floor 1 popup. The tag has no mechanical effect. Until Floor 3, your sheet reads **Broadcast Name: PENDING**. We return to the handle in the Backstory section.

SPECIES (S5)

Your species is your **Latent Biology**. You pick it at level 1 for balance. All of its traits work from your first session. The System files those traits as **quirks** with a mundane-sounding explanation, and everyone, including you, looks human on Floors 1 and 2, apart from **small tells** the GM describes now and then: a too-sharp canine, ears that twitch at sounds, warm eyes in the dark. Tells have no mechanics. HOUSE On Floor 3, the **Identity Market** opens: your body visibly becomes your species, unless you take the System up on its offer to become something else. Chapter 3 covers tells, the Identity Market and what each species is like in the Crawl.

You choose from the **nine SRD species** below. Each is shown the way the kiosk shows it: **Our Name (5e Name)**. The first word is the nationality the System has decided you are; the word in parentheses is the 5e species whose rules you use. All the real rules live under the parenthesized name.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SIZE, SPEED	TRAITS (SRD 5.2)	FLOORS 1-2 QUIRK
Welsh (Dragonborn)	Medium, 30 ft	Draconic Ancestry; Breath Weapon; Damage Resistance; Darkvision 60 ft	Acid reflux. Weaponized.
Vietnamese (Dwarf)	Medium, 30 ft	Darkvision 120 ft; Dwarven Resilience (poison resistance); Dwarven Toughness (+1 HP at level 1, +1 again each level); Stonecunning (Bonus Action: Tremorsense 60 ft for 10 minutes on stone)	Your pupils do a thing.
Icelandic (Elf)	Medium, 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft; Elven Lineage; Fey Ancestry; Keen Senses; Trance	You don't sleep, you buffer.
Polish (Gnome)	Small, 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft; Gnomish Cunning (Advantage on Int, Wis, Cha saves); Gnomish Lineage	Hard to hypnotize. Telemarketers hated you.
Samoan (Goliath)	Medium, 35 ft	Giant Ancestry; Large Form (level 5); Powerful Build	Big-boned, and the bones have opinions.
Belgian (Halfling)	Small, 30 ft	Brave; Halfling Nimbleness; Luck; Naturally Stealthy	Statistically suspicious.
Canadian (Human)	Medium, 30 ft	Resourceful (Heroic Inspiration); Skillful (1 extra skill); Versatile (extra Origin feat)	Baseline. Congratulations on being the control group.
Azerbaijani (Orc)	Medium, 30 ft	Adrenaline Rush; Darkvision 120 ft; Relentless Endurance	You refuse to fall down. It's rude, honestly.
Brazilian (Tiefling)	Medium, 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft; Fiendish Legacy; Otherworldly Presence	You run a little hot.

Source: chargen-5e.json v0.1.6 and species-class-reskins v0.1.7. Dwarf, Elf and Orc darkvision as filed in the chargen table. Traits are named, not reprinted; use the SRD text.

MEET THE NINE

Welsh (Dragonborn). Your flag already has a dragon on it. You are the paperwork catching up. Every consonant is a threat. Choose a **draconic ancestry**: Ghanaian (Black Dragonborn), Uruguayan (Blue Dragonborn), Serbian (Brass Dragonborn), Italian (Bronze Dragonborn), Chilean (Copper Dragonborn), South African (Gold Dragonborn), Irish (Green Dragonborn), Peruvian (Red Dragonborn), Bolivian (Silver Dragonborn), Norwegian (White Dragonborn).

Vietnamese (Dwarf). Your country owns the biggest cave on Earth. Hauling a fridge on a scooter was just the warm-up.

Icelandic (Elf). Half your country politely believes in elves, so the paperwork was already filed. You trance through daylight that never ends. Choose a **elven lineage**: Swedish (Drow), Swiss (High Elf), Estonian (Wood Elf).

Polish (Gnome). Your cousins are bronze statues all over Wroclaw. Hypnosis bounces off a nation that survived every telemarketer. Choose a **gnomish lineage**: Czech (Forest Gnome), Hungarian (Rock Gnome).

Samoan (Goliath). Big-boned, big-hearted, and the front row of every scrum. Gentle until the ball is involved. Choose a **giant ancestry**: Nepali (Cloud Goliath), Indonesian (Fire Goliath), Russian (Frost Goliath), Ethiopian (Hill Goliath), Zimbabwean (Stone Goliath), Filipino (Storm Goliath).

Belgian (Halfling). Eleven million people, countless beers, and once 541 days with no government. Statistically suspicious, deliciously.

Canadian (Human). Baseline. You apologize to the trap after it hits you, then thank it for the experience.

Azerbaijani (Orc). Your country is literally named Land of Fire. You refuse to fall down, and you refuse to refuse tea.

Brazilian (Tiefling). You run a little hot. Everyone else calls that Tuesday in February. Horns come with a feather headdress option. Choose a **fiendish legacy**: Spanish (Abyssal Tiefling), Greek (Chthonic Tiefling), South Korean (Infernal Tiefling).

LINEAGES AND ANCESTRIES

Five species ask for a second choice right away. There are **24 lineages** in all: ten Dragonborn ancestries, three Elven lineages, two Gnomish lineages, six Goliath ancestries and three Fiendish legacies. Each one is its own line on the kiosk, with its own nationality, and takes exactly the rules of its 5e lineage.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SPECIES	LINEAGE EFFECT (SUMMARY)
Ghanaian (Black Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Acid
Uruguayan (Blue Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Lightning
Serbian (Brass Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Fire
Italian (Bronze Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Lightning
Chilean (Copper Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Acid
South African (Gold Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Fire
Irish (Green Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Poison
Peruvian (Red Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Fire
Bolivian (Silver Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Cold
Norwegian (White Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Cold
Swedish (Drow)	Elf	Darkvision 120 ft; Dancing Lights cantrip
Swiss (High Elf)	Elf	Prestidigitation cantrip (swappable)
Estonian (Wood Elf)	Elf	Speed 35 ft; Druidcraft cantrip
Czech (Forest Gnome)	Gnome	Minor Illusion cantrip; Speak with Animals
Hungarian (Rock Gnome)	Gnome	Mending and Prestidigitation cantrips; clockwork devices
Nepali (Cloud Goliath)	Goliath	Cloud's Jaunt: teleport as a Bonus Action

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SPECIES	LINEAGE EFFECT (SUMMARY)
Indonesian (Fire Goliath)	Goliath	Fire's Burn: extra fire damage on a hit
Russian (Frost Goliath)	Goliath	Frost's Chill: extra cold damage and a speed penalty
Ethiopian (Hill Goliath)	Goliath	Hill's Tumble: knock a target prone
Zimbabwean (Stone Goliath)	Goliath	Stone's Endurance: Reaction to reduce damage
Filipino (Storm Goliath)	Goliath	Storm's Thunder: Reaction thunder damage
Spanish (Abyssal Tiefling)	Tiefling	Poison resistance; Poison Spray cantrip
Greek (Chthonic Tiefling)	Tiefling	Necrotic resistance; Chill Touch cantrip
South Korean (Infernal Tiefling)	Tiefling	Fire resistance; Fire Bolt cantrip

24 lineages. Effect column summarized by the author from SRD 5.2 ***VERIFY: the chargen table lists lineage names only; check each effect against the SRD before printing*** .

Other choices inside species:

- **Elf: Keen Senses.** Pick one skill from Insight, Perception or Survival.
- **Human: Skillful.** One extra skill of your choice (picked on S9).
- **Human: Versatile.** One extra Origin feat (picked on S7).
- **Dwarf: Dwarven Toughness.** +1 hit point at level 1 and +1 more at every level you gain.

> [SYSTEM]
> Biology Anomaly (Logged). You can see in the dark. We've noted it. We've noted *everything*.

REFLECTIONS AND RUMORS

Mirrors in the Orientation Pit flicker for a frame (a horn, an ear, a tail-shaped shadow) and the camera always cuts away. Your small tells get a glance and nothing more. If you ask why you have darkvision, the System says your file is under review. Quirks do not explain themselves; they just work.

THE FLOOR 3 OFFER (A POINTER)

At the Identity Market on Floor 3, the System offers every Crawler a **free, one-time rebuild** on a private card. You may keep your species or take one of **two oddities** the System picks for you; redo your **background** (its ability increases, skills, tool and Origin feat); and take a **class option** built on the class you already have. Your level, your base ability scores and your class itself never change, and nothing ever reopens the Offer. A Human who stays Human gains **Unbroken Original**. The oddities do **not** appear at intake. Chapter 3 describes the Offer, the rebuild and every oddity.

CLASS (S6)

Your class is your **Provisional Class**: a talent that fell out of you. The System treats it as improvised until Floor 3, when your class is "certified" and you receive an **Official Class Title** (a flashy name that is pure flavor) alongside your level 3 subclass. Until then you have the full level 1 feature set of the real class, as written.

Pick one of the **twelve SRD classes**. Hit Die and proficiencies come from the SRD; the table below lists what the kiosk shows you.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	HIT DIE	SAVES	ARMOR	SKILLS
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	d12	STR/CON	light, medium, shield	2
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	d8	DEX/CHA	light	3
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	d8	WIS/CHA	light, medium, shield	2
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	d8	INT/WIS	light, shield	2
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	d10	STR/CON	light, medium, heavy, shield	2
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	d8	STR/DEX	none (Unarmored Defense)	2
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	d10	WIS/CHA	light, medium, heavy, shield	2
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	d10	STR/DEX	light, medium, shield	3
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	d8	DEX/INT	light	4
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	d6	CON/CHA	none	2
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	d8	WIS/CHA	light	2
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	d6	INT/WIS	none	2

Source: chargen-5e.json v0.1.6. Weapon proficiencies are in the SRD class entries.

TWELVE PROVISIONAL CLASSES

Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian). Failed the course, kept the certificate, and now charges by the hour for the same thing. *Level 1:* Rage (2 uses, long-rest recharge); Unarmored Defense (10 + Dex + Con while unarmored); Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Open-Mic Menace (Bard). Unlicensed entertainer with a Bluetooth speaker and four fans. Two of them are family. *Level 1:* Bardic Inspiration (d6, Cha mod uses); Spellcasting (Cha).

Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric). Somebody up there signed for you. Pastoral care, triage, and a surprisingly effective hand-sanitizer miracle. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Wis); Divine Order (Protector or Thaumaturge).

Community-Garden Zealot (Druid). Smells like a compost bin with ambition. Has a plot, a hose, and opinions about your lawn. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Wis); Druidic (secret language); Primal Order (Magician or Warden).

Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter). Fell into it, kept falling. Checks IDs, breaks up fights, and holds a grudge about the cover charge. *Level 1:* Fighting Style (pick one feat); Second Wind (heal 1d10+level, 2 uses); Weapon Mastery (3 weapons).

Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk). Barefoot by choice. Teaches breathing, punches stress, and makes a living off Namaste and a credits-only mat. *Level 1:* Martial Arts (d6 unarmed, Dex for unarmed); Unarmored Defense (10 + Dex + Wis).

HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin). Took an oath. Probably to the bylaws. Clipboard, shining armor, and a fine schedule for unauthorized mailboxes. *Level 1:* Lay on Hands (5 HP pool); Spellcasting (Cha); Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger). Knows which way is north. Has been told it is a rare skill. Drives a truck with a bad radio. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Wis); Favored Enemy (Hunter's Mark always prepared); Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue). Your record says 'opportunist.' Your references say 'talented.' The mall says 'please leave.' *Level 1:* Expertise (2 skills); Sneak Attack (1d6); Thieves' Cant; Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer). Over-charged at birth and leaking sparks into everything. Do not plug into the wall. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Cha); Innate Sorcery (bonus action, 2 uses).

Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock). Clicked 'I agree' without reading. Your patron read it. Your patron has notes. *Level 1:* Eldritch Invocations (1); Pact Magic (1 slot).

Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard). Reads. Gross. Seven years into a thesis nobody asked for, powered by bad coffee and unfunded curiosity. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Int, spellbook); Ritual Adept; Arcane Recovery (1/day on short rest).

LEVEL 1 CHOICES

Some classes ask a question at level 1. Each choice has an "Our Name (5e Name)" label too.

Cleric: Divine Order. Druid: Primal Order. Each has two options.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	CLASS	WHAT IT DOES
Hallway Bodyguard (Protector)	Cleric	Armor and martial weapons. Stands between the bleeding and the elevator.
Church Rummage-Sale Mystic (Thaumaturge)	Cleric	Extra cantrip and sharper at religion. Reads a tarot deck with the price tags still on.
Farmers-Market Hedge Magician (Magician)	Druid	Extra cantrip and nature smarts. Sells heirloom tomatoes that are, technically, still cursed.
Trail-Crew Warden (Warden)	Druid	Medium armor, shield and martial weapons. Maintains the trail and slaps anyone who feeds the wildlife.
Football Hooligan (Barbarian)	Barbarian	Terrace songs, temporary hit points for the mate next to you, and a Red Card for Disengage while Raging.
Feral Cat Berserker (Barbarian)	Barbarian	Climb while Raging. Baths are a personal attack. The alley is your gym.
Song Bard (Bard)	Bard	Encore on a failed Inspiration. Cannot stop humming. Two of your fans are still family.
Legendary Diva (Bard)	Bard	Stage Presence in front of a crowd. Every spell must be sung. Silence is a hard counter.
Physicker (Cleric)	Cleric	Triage as a Bonus Action and a Herbalism Kit. Terrible at Intimidation. Excellent at nagging you to stay down.
Fire Spiritualist (Cleric)	Cleric	Juiced allies hit harder once a day. You glow faintly in the dark. Stealth is a suggestion.
Banana Farmer (Druid)	Druid	One free banana per Long Rest. It heals. It rots. It cannot be sold. Fruit flies included.
Earth Mover (Druid)	Druid	Stone Feet against being shoved. Heavy Tread on hard floors. The ground likes you more than people do.
Pit Fighter (Fighter)	Fighter	Crowd Work for Intimidation or Performance. Showboat in a scrap. Quiet exits are for other people.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	CLASS	WHAT IT DOES
Boring Ol' Fighter (Fighter)	Fighter	Basics Done Right: an extra Fighting Style. No Magic, under any circumstances. Scrolls are sell-only loot.
Prizefighter (Monk)	Monk	Pugilist Athletics. Punch-Drunk persuasion in formal rooms. The cauliflower ear is the diploma.
Street Monk (Monk)	Monk	Parkour for free. No Fixed Address with officials. The city is your dojo and your landlord.
Sacred Paladin (Paladin)	Paladin	Liturgy, Religion, and a Light cantrip. Cannot tell a flat lie. Misleading truths are a sport.
Black Inquisitor General (Paladin)	Paladin	One Wizard cantrip and a Dread Reputation. Clergy and lawkeepers flinch on first meeting.
Pest Exterminator (Ranger)	Ranger	Free Fog Cloud once a day. Bug-Spray Smell. Creatures that hunt by scent find you first.
Archer (Ranger)	Ranger	Archery Fighting Style. Arrow Snob about thrown junk. The bow is the only correct answer.
Fugitive (Rogue)	Rogue	Slippery out of grapples and cuffs. Wanted with every guard on the floor. Keep moving.
Spy (Rogue)	Rogue	Disguise Kit Tradecraft. Burned Cover once someone catches the lie. Smile anyway.
Blizzardmancer (Sorcerer)	Sorcerer	Free Ray of Frost. Ice Queen against extreme heat. Bring a coat and a cold stare.
Glass Cannon (Sorcerer)	Sorcerer	Overclocked Sorcery Points. Fragile max HP. Glass houses, meet glass Crawler.
Halloween Aficionado (Warlock)	Warlock	Intimidation, a free boxcutter, and a Goth Phase. Clergy and cheerful people decline the invite.
Poet Laureate (Warlock)	Warlock	Commissioned Verse for Temporary HP. Patron's Deadline: new lines every Long Rest or the slots sulk.
Fire Mage Arcanist (Wizard)	Wizard	Free Fire Bolt. Singed Stealth after every fire spell. The smoke follows you like a fan.
Boring Ol' Mage (Wizard)	Wizard	One extra prepared spell. No Fighting with weapons. Spell attacks are fine. The thesis is the blade.

Fighter: Fighting Style. The Fighter picks one at level 1. Paladins and Rangers pick theirs at **level 2**, not level 1.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	KIOSK LINE
Carnival-Booth Sharpshooter (Archery)	Ranged hits, courtesy of a stuffed-bear grudge.
Power-Outage Brawler (Blind Fighting)	You swing fine in the dark. It is mostly the dark's fault.
Bubble-Wrap Enthusiast (Defense)	A permanent bonus to not being hit while armored.
Single-Hand Swagger (Dueling)	One weapon, one hand, one overconfident grin.
Two-Handed Overcompensation (Great Weapon Fighting)	Big weapon, bigger damage dice, no apology.
Human Airbag Reflex (Interception)	You step in front of your friends' damage. They owe you a drink.
Crowd-Control Shield Shove (Protection)	Your shield makes enemies miss the guy behind you.
Dart-League Menace (Thrown Weapon Fighting)	Throw it, draw it, throw it again.
Double-Fisting Menace (Two-Weapon Fighting)	Two weapons, two hands, zero impulse control.
Bar-Fight Haymaker (Unarmed Fighting)	Fists as a lifestyle choice.

Fighters pick one at level 1. Paladins and Rangers pick theirs at level 2.

Warlock: Eldritch Invocation. One at level 1.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	KIOSK LINE
Fog-Machine Outfit (Armor of Shadows)	Self-cast armor, powered by dry ice.
Focus Supplement Subscription (Eldritch Mind)	Keeps your concentration from dropping. Auto-renews.
Devil's Energy Drink (Fiendish Vigor)	Temporary hit points. The can has no ingredients list.
Borrowed-Eyes Livestream (Gaze of Two Minds)	See through an ally's eyes. Ask first.
Pirated Masterclass (Lessons of the First Ones)	A bonus feat from a course you did not buy.
Vape-Cloud Illusions (Misty Visions)	Minor illusions, cloud included.
Weapon Lease Agreement (Pact of the Blade)	Your patron loans you a blade. Late fees apply.
Familiar Rewards Program (Pact of the Chain)	A special familiar with a loyalty card.
Notebook of Bad Decisions (Pact of the Tome)	A book of spells and regrets.
Night-Vision Free Trial (Devil's Sight)	See in the dark. Does not say what it costs after the trial.
Filter-Pack Subscription (Mask of Many Faces)	Change your face on demand. Cancel anytime, in theory.

Warlocks pick one invocation at level 1.

Weapon Mastery. Barbarians choose 2 weapons, Fighters 3, Paladins 2, Rangers 2 and Rogues 2. **Expertise.** A Rogue picks two skills for Expertise at level 1 (a Bard gets Expertise at level 2, not now). Mastery names are plain, because rules key on them. Chapter 6 covers each weapon.

```
[SYSTEM]
Provisional Class: noted. Official Class Title: pending. Please do not put “pending” on a business card.
```

BACKGROUND (S7)

Your background is your **Prior Employment**: the job you had before the world ended. It gives you ability score increases, an Origin feat, two skills, a tool, and an equipment option. This book prints the **four SRD 5.2 backgrounds** in full below. Twelve more appear only as a reskin-name appendix at the end of this chapter (decision 029); their full 5e text is not reprinted here.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	RAISE	ORIGIN FEAT	SKILLS	TOOL	CREDITS (A KIT / B)
Youth-Group Pizza Wrangler (Acolyte)	Int/Wis/Cha	Group-Chat Prayer Warrior (Magic Initiate, Cleric)	Insight, Religion	Calligrapher's Supplies	8 / 50
Call-Center Gift-Card Fraud Specialist (Criminal)	Dex/Con/Int	Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)	Sleight of Hand, Stealth	Thieves' Tools	16 / 50
Adjunct Professor on Four Campuses (Sage)	Con/Int/Wis	Wikipedia Rabbit-Hole Scholar (Magic Initiate, Wizard)	Arcana, History	Calligrapher's Supplies	8 / 50
Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)	Str/Dex/Con	Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)	Athletics, Intimidation	One Gaming Set	14 / 50

The four SRD 5.2 backgrounds. Credits: Package A is the kit and its leftover credits; Package B is the credit option.

Youth-Group Pizza Wrangler (Acolyte). Ran Wednesday-night youth group on two pizzas and divine patience. Found out heaven has no petty credits.

Call-Center Gift-Card Fraud Specialist (Criminal). Talked 400 strangers into reading you their card numbers 'for verification'. Your headset is evidence now.

Adjunct Professor on Four Campuses (Sage). Taught intro rhetoric at four colleges for the combined salary of one decent sandwich. Parking cost more than the pay.

Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier). Stood between a discount toaster and four hundred people. You lost the toaster but kept the vest.

ABILITY SCORE INCREASES

Your background lists three abilities. You apply **one** of these two patterns, picking among those three:

- **Merit Raise and a Gift Card (+2 / +1):** +2 to one of the three and +1 to another.
- **Everyone Gets a Participation Trophy (+1 / +1 / +1):** +1 to each of the three.

Increases are added *after* you assign your ability scores (next section), and **no score can exceed 20**. The preview screen shows the result live.

ORIGIN FEAT

Your background gives you a fixed Origin feat. If you are Human, you also pick one from the **four SRD Origin feats** below (your Versatile trait): Alert, Magic Initiate, Savage Attacker, or Skilled. Magic Initiate has three spell-list versions. Non-SRD Origin feats appear only in the appendix under our reskin names (decision 029).

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	KIOSK LINE
Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)	Hasn't slept through the night since the 2019 inventory audit. Nothing sneaks up on someone who counts ceiling tiles.
Group-Chat Prayer Warrior (Magic Initiate, Cleric)	Types 'thoughts and prayers' faster than anybody alive. Surprisingly, some of them land.
Houseplant Whisperer (Magic Initiate, Druid)	Talks to a pothos nine times a day. The pothos has opinions about your landlord.
Wikipedia Rabbit-Hole Scholar (Magic Initiate, Wizard)	Started on 'lasagna' and finished on medieval siege engines at 4 AM. Knows one real spell and no lasagna recipe.
Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)	Survived a Friday rush on a fryer with a mind of its own. When you strike, you strike twice for good measure.
Tech-Support Jack-of-All-Trades (Skilled)	Fixed printers, passwords and one marriage over a screen-share. Have you tried turning it off and on again?

The four SRD 5.2 Origin feats (Magic Initiate has three spell-list versions). Human Versatile picks from these four only.

RESKIN THE REASON

You may rename your old job to fit your story, as long as you keep the skills the background gives. A Sage can be a podcast researcher. A Soldier can be mall security. The System will not change what the background does, only why you have it.

> Prior employment: *Sage.* You wrote a thesis nobody read. Good news: four billion people are about to watch you die instead.

ABILITY SCORES (S8)

Your six ability scores decide how long you last. This screen is called **The Six Numbers (Ability scores)**.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Gym-Bro Energy (Strength)	How much you can carry, kick through, or regret lifting.
Parkour Delusion (Dexterity)	Moves you saw online and the reflex to land them. Sometimes.
Gas-Station Sushi Survivor (Constitution)	Whatever keeps you alive past Floor 1. Mostly spite.
Pub-Quiz Brain (Intelligence)	Recall, logic, and knowing which wiki to open first.
Warning Signs You Ignored (Wisdom)	Your gut, your senses, and the feeling right before everything went wrong.
Main-Character Energy (Charisma)	The audience has already formed opinions about this one.

You may use any of **three methods**:

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Factory Preset (Standard array)	Six fixed numbers off the System's shelf: 15, 14, 13, 12, 10, 8. No dice, no regrets, no personality.
Layaway Plan (Point buy)	27 points, scores from 8 to 15, and the System charges extra at the top.
Dice Gamble (Roll)	4d6, drop the lowest, six scores, three arrays, keep one that totals 73 or more. Logged, public, and not your fault.

Whatever the method, you assign six base scores first, then add the background increases from S7. No score may exceed 20.

FACTORY PRESET (STANDARD ARRAY)

Assign 15, 14, 13, 12, 10 and 8 among your six abilities, one each. The total is 72.

LAYAWAY PLAN (POINT BUY)

You have **27 points**. Every score starts at 8 and can rise to 15 before any bonus.

SCORE	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Cost	0	1	2	3	4	5	7	9

Point buy: 27 points; scores 8 to 15 before bonuses.

The most a 27-point buy can ever total is 75, for example 13, 13, 13, 12, 12 and 12.

DICE GAMBLE (ROLL) HOUSE

> **HOUSE OPTION • ROLL METHOD**
>
> Roll is a table option. It is on by default and your GM can switch it off. If it is off, you will not see it on S8.

Here is how it works.

1. **The System rolls three arrays.** Each array is six scores. Each score is **4d6, drop the lowest die**, rolled in the open and logged. Every die is recorded.
2. **You keep exactly one array**, and only an array whose six scores **total 73 or more** may be kept. There is **no upper limit**.
3. **If none of the three qualifies, the System rolls all three again.** It repeats until one does. If a build somehow takes more than ten rounds, the System stops and sends you to the other two methods. **VERIFY: the 10-round safety stop is a tool design default.**
4. **You assign the kept scores freely.** Each score goes to one ability, once. Equal scores are separate entries.
5. **There is no voluntary reroll.** Your rolled rounds are saved. Back, Edit, Restart and changing methods all show you the same rounds. The only exception is **Cancel build**, which shreds the whole draft.

A single 4d6-drop-lowest score ranges from 3 to 18, so a background +2 can never push a score past 20.

THE ODDS

About 56 percent of rolled arrays total 73 or more, and about 8 percent of rounds produce no keepable array at all. The standard array totals 72, and point buy can reach 75.

Example round. The System rolls three arrays.

ARRAY	SCORES	TOTAL	RESULT
A	15, 14, 13, 12, 10, 9	73	Keepable (total 73)
B	16, 12, 12, 11, 10, 9	70	Not keepable (total 70, needs 73 or more)
C	14, 13, 12, 11, 10, 10	70	Not keepable (total 70, needs 73 or more)

Only array A can be kept, so you keep A and assign. Had A been 72, all three would have been thrown away and rolled again.

```
[SYSTEM]
Three arrays. Keep one that totals above 72. The numbers are not wrong. They are just yours.
```

WHAT THE NUMBERS GIVE YOU

After you assign, the screen shows the base score, the background bonus and the final score for each ability, with its modifier, plus a computed block you never type yourself:

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Pain Budget (HP)	How much damage you eat before the System starts a new file.
Not-Getting-Hit Number (AC)	Armor, reflexes and good intentions, summed.
Jump-Scare Reflex (Initiative)	How fast you react when the room goes wrong.
Spidey-Sense (Passive Perception)	What you notice while not trying to.
Competence Bonus (Proficiency Bonus)	What you add to things you are actually good at.

- **Hit points** at level 1 are your class Hit Die at its maximum plus your Constitution modifier. A Dwarf adds 1 (Dwarven Toughness).

- **Armor Class** shows as "10 + Dexterity for now" until you choose equipment on S10. A Barbarian without armor has 10 + Dex + Con. A Monk without armor or shield has 10 + Dex + Wis.
- **Proficiency Bonus** is +2 at level 1.
- **Passive Perception** is 10 + your Wisdom (Perception) modifier + your proficiency bonus if you are proficient.

Your Charisma is 8. The audience has already noticed. They're calling it "brave."

SKILLS AND PROFICIENCIES (S9)

This screen is **Things You Can Actually Do (Skills and proficiencies)**. **Fixed grants come first**: your background's two skills and tool, plus anything your species gives you. Then you make your class picks. The picker hides skills you already own, and if a pick would duplicate one, the tool asks you for a different one.

VERIFY: the SRD has no duplicate-pick swap rule; the tool applies one.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	PICK	FROM
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	2	Animal Handling, Athletics, Intimidation, Nature, Perception, Survival
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	3	Any skill
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	2	History, Insight, Medicine, Persuasion, Religion
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	2	Arcana, Animal Handling, Insight, Medicine, Nature, Perception, Religion, Survival
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	2	Acrobatics, Animal Handling, Athletics, History, Insight, Intimidation, Persuasion, Perception, Survival
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	2	Acrobatics, Athletics, History, Insight, Religion, Stealth
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	2	Athletics, Insight, Intimidation, Medicine, Persuasion, Religion
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	3	Animal Handling, Athletics, Insight, Investigation, Nature, Perception, Stealth, Survival
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	4	Acrobatics, Athletics, Deception, Insight, Intimidation, Investigation, Perception, Persuasion, Sleight of Hand, Stealth
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	2	Arcana, Deception, Insight, Intimidation, Persuasion, Religion
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	2	Arcana, Deception, History, Intimidation, Investigation, Nature, Religion
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	2	Arcana, History, Insight, Investigation, Medicine, Religion

Skill names stay plain: rules key on them.

- **Human: Skillful** adds one skill of your choice. **Skilled** (the Origin feat) adds three more, if you took it.
- **Elf: Keen Senses** adds Insight, Perception or Survival.
- **Languages.** You know Common plus **two** from the standard list: Common Sign Language, Draconic, Dwarvish, Elvish, Giant, Gnomish, Goblin, Halfling and Orc.
- **Expertise** (Rogue): two skills, picked from the skills you hold.
- **Weapon Mastery:** the counts are on the class table above.
- **Automatic:** your saving throw proficiencies, armor and weapon proficiencies, and the +2 Proficiency Bonus.

EQUIPMENT (S10)

The screen is **Junk Intake (Starting equipment)**. The System puts it simply: everything is junk, and everything works.

TWO CHOICES

You make **two separate decisions**: one for your class and one for your background. For each, you take either the **kit** (the items plus a small amount of leftover credits) or the **credit option** (no items, and you shop).

- **Locker-Cleanout Duffel (Package A)** is your class kit.
- **Estate-Sale Grab Bag (Package B)** is a second class kit. Only the Fighter has one.
- **Take the Credits** means you skip the kit and shop. It is the last option on every class list.
- **Cardboard Carton From Your Desk (Package A)** is your background kit.
- **Severance Envelope, Unmarked (Package B)** is your background credit option: 50 credits.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	PACKAGE A (KIT)	CREDIT OPTION
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	greataxe, 4 handaxes, Explorer's Pack + 15 credits	75 credits
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	leather armor, 2 daggers, musical instrument, Entertainer's Pack + 19 credits	90 credits
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	chain shirt, shield, mace, holy symbol, Priest's Pack + 7 credits	110 credits
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	leather armor, shield, sickle, druidic focus (staff), Explorer's Pack, herbalism kit + 9 credits	50 credits
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	chain mail, greatsword, flail, 8 javelins, Dungeoneer's Pack + 4 credits	kit B: studded leather armor, scimitar, shortsword, longbow, arrows, quiver, Dungeoneer's Pack + 11 credits; 155 credits
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	spear, 5 daggers, artisan's tools, Explorer's Pack + 11 credits	50 credits
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	chain mail, shield, longsword, 6 javelins, holy symbol, Priest's Pack + 9 credits	150 credits
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	studded leather armor, scimitar, shortsword, longbow, arrows, quiver, druidic focus (sprig), Explorer's Pack + 7 credits	150 credits
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	leather armor, 2 daggers, shortsword, shortbow, arrows, quiver, thieves' tools, Burglar's Pack + 8 credits	100 credits
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	spear, 2 daggers, arcane focus (crystal), Dungeoneer's Pack + 28 credits	50 credits
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	leather armor, sickle, 2 daggers, arcane focus (orb), book, Scholar's Pack + 15 credits	100 credits
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	2 daggers, arcane focus (staff), robe, spellbook, Scholar's Pack + 5 credits	55 credits

Source: chargen-5e.json v0.1.6 ***VERIFY: package contents and credit amounts were written from memory of SRD 5.2; chargen verify list still open*** *. Fighters have a second kit (B) and a credit option (C); every other class has Package B as credits only.*

Your starting credits are exactly what the options give you. The Crawl adds no stipend.

THE INTAKE VENDING WALL

If you hold credits, you can spend them at the **Intake Vending Wall**. It sells equipment at SRD prices. It never sells magic items. Spend any amount up to what you hold; what is left stays on your sheet. Every purchase subtracts from your credits, and the total can never go below zero.

JUNK NAMES

Every item shows the System's name with the real name in brackets. Damage, properties, mastery, armor and weight never change, and the sheet stores the real item. Some examples from the kiosk:

- Sharpened Stop Sign (Longsword)
- Chain-Link Fencing Laced Over a Work Coverall (Chain Mail)
- Duct-Taped Mop (Quarterstaff)
- Fire Axe, BREAK GLASS Sticker Intact (Greataxe)
- Compound Bow From a Sporting-Goods Display (Shortbow)
- Stop Sign Shield (Shield)
- Motorcycle Jacket (Leather Armor)
- Cracked Phone App (Spellbook)
- Sad Hotel Robe (Robe)
- Bobby Pins and a Gift Card (Thieves' Tools)
- Lost-and-Found Duffel, Someone Else's Gym Clothes (Explorer's Pack)

Items that come in families ask which variant you want: a gaming set, a musical instrument, a holy symbol, artisan's tools, an arcane focus, a druidic focus. The price follows the variant you pick.

ARMOR CLASS, COMPUTED

The tool works out your Armor Class from what you wear: worn armor plus whatever your Dexterity adds under the armor rules, a shield's bonus, and class features like Unarmored Defense. If you wear nothing, you have 10 + Dex.

THE INTAKE BAG AND YOUR INVENTORY

You also receive a clear **Intake Bag**: a lanyard printed with your Intake Tag, a packet of System-brand electrolyte powder that tastes like a battery, and a laminated card that reads **YOU ARE ON CAMERA**. The bag has no value, cannot be sold, and gives you nothing mechanical. If you named an object in your survey that is plausibly on you, you may keep one mundane personal item too.

Everything else goes into your **System Inventory**, which Chapter 1 describes.

SPELLS (S11)

This screen is **The Magic You Admit To (Spells)**, and only casters see it. Barbarians, Fighters, Monks and Rogues skip straight past.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	CANTRIPS	LEVEL 1 SPELLS	LEVEL 1 SLOTS	ABILITY
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	2	4 prepared	2	Cha
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	3	4 prepared	2	Wis
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	2	4 prepared	2	Wis
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	4	2 prepared	2	Cha
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	2	2 prepared	1 (Pact Magic)	Cha
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	3	6 in spellbook, 4 prepared	2	Int
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	0	2 prepared	2	Cha
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	0	2 prepared	2	Wis

Counts per characters/create-flow-spec-5e.md v0.1.13 S11 (SRD 5.2 checked by the rules team). Barbarian, Fighter, Monk and Rogue skip the spells screen.

- **Cantrips** are *Party Tricks*: free, repeatable and slightly embarrassing.
- **Level 1 spells** are *Real Magic*.
- The **Wizard's spellbook** is reskinned as a *Cracked Phone App*, which autosaves rarely and syncs never. A Wizard fills six spells into the book and prepares four.
- Spell names and effects stay plain. Only the headings on the screen are reskinned.
- Spell lists and effects come from the SRD. **VERIFY: the filed chargen table's spell lists were written from memory and are not reprinted here. Check them against the SRD before the spell chapter goes to print.**

THE SURVEY (S13)

S13 is a **short, private customer satisfaction survey**. Your answers are private notes. The System does not read them aloud, does not put them on your card, and does not share them with other players. You may **pass** on any question, or skip the whole screen. **S12 is retired** on purpose (the old public-tags screen); the numbers stay so the tools never renumber. From your private notes and from play, the System builds a **Fan Profile** that stays **hidden** — players never see it, never set it, and never ask for a specific reward. Nothing in the survey is required, and nothing in it is a test.

BACKSTORY AND HANDLE (S14)

The screen is **Your Sob Story and Handle Request**. It asks for two things.

- **A backstory**, two sentences or so. This is *public*. The System reads it aloud when it introduces you, so make it worth reading.
- **A requested handle.** What do you want the audience to call you? This is a request, not a promise.

The System logs your request and sets your sheet to **Broadcast Name: PENDING**. During Floor 1, the audience may start a nickname for you based on something you did. On Floor 3 the System mints your real Broadcast Name *with you*, and may honor your request, mangle it, or overrule it. The name the audience gives you is the name you earned.

> Requested handle: "Shadowblade." Logged. Laughed at. Pending.

STANDING ORDERS (S15)

This is the **Autopilot Memo**. Write what your body should do while your brain is in the bathroom.

- **Standing Orders.** One line of default tactic. Used when a turn times out or when you go on autopilot. With no orders written, your Crawler simply takes the Dodge action.
- **Standing Reactions.** One line. Defaults to "Opportunity Attacks: on."
- **Signature attack** (optional). A name for your best trick. It must be a real attack or spell you actually have.

Good orders are specific: *"Shoot the nearest enemy with my shortbow from cover; drink a potion under a quarter of my hit points."* A timed-out turn never spends limited resources unless your orders say so.

REVIEW AND CONFIRM (S16 AND S17)

FINAL PAPERWORK (S16)

S16 shows you the finished sheet exactly as it will be posted, a build block (species and choice, class and choices, background and increases, Origin feat, skills, tools, masteries, spells, backstory, requested handle, orders), and a private fold that only you can see with your survey answers and comfort lines. Nothing is written yet. The whole build is checked before **Confirm** unlocks: every list must be legal, every count exact, your name still free, your credits at least zero, and your party under four.

Use **Edit** to jump back to a screen and return. Changing species, class or background re-runs the ability, skill, equipment and spell previews and drops any pick that is no longer legal, and the System tells you which.

SIGN HERE (S17)

Confirmation locks the file. Corrections after this go through the GM. On confirmation the System:

1. Re-checks everything and assigns your **Intake Tag**.
2. Writes your sheet and your starting credits.
3. Posts your first card in your own sheet channel.
4. Gives you the intake achievement.

Some tables hold new sheets for a GM look before filing; in that case the System says "filed, pending review" and the sheet appears when it is approved.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

PAPERWORK SURVIVOR

You completed intake without dying, crying, or reading the Terms of Service. Two out of three ain't bad.

REWARD Nothing. It's paperwork. Nobody gets a prize for paperwork.

SEVERAL CRAWLERS, ONE ACTIVE

A player may create **as many Crawlers as they like** (the soft guideline is ten; the GM may allow more). Each `/create` makes a new Crawler. At the table, though, you play **exactly one at a time**. This is the rule that keeps four-player parties four players.

ACTIVE AND BENCHED

- **Active Crawler.** The one in play. It counts for the party, takes one of the table's four slots, earns credits, XP and achievements, and receives loot and boxes.
- **Benched Crawler.** Everyone else you have on file. A benched Crawler is inert: no slot, no credits, no XP, no loot, no boxes and no trades. You cannot move items or credits between your own Crawlers. Using benched Crawlers as mules is not allowed, and the GM may refuse any swap that smells like it.
- **Your first Crawler is active automatically.** Later Crawlers start benched.
- **Every Crawler belongs to one campaign** and never moves to another.

SWAPPING

The active Crawler is **locked for the whole session**. It changes only at **session zero or between sessions**, never mid-session, not even in a saferoom. You ask with `/crawlers`, which lists your Crawlers (name, class, level, active or benched, floor) with links to their sheets. It files a *request*; the GM approves and runs the swap, and logs it. You get **one swap per window**.

A Crawler swapped in keeps its own level, kit and credits as filed. If it is behind the party, it is brought up to the party's lowest level at the next saferoom. A swapped-in benched Crawler does not get the gear package or Silver loot box as late-entry compensation that a brand-new replacement gets.

WHEN A CRAWLER DIES

Death is permanent (see Chapter 1). During the session you cannot bring in a benched Crawler. You either sit out, or, if the GM offers it, you run a GM-assigned companion until the next between-session window. At that window you may swap in a benched Crawler as your replacement.

/DELETE

`/delete <name>` removes one of **your own** Crawlers. You must type the Crawler's exact name to confirm. The active Crawler cannot be deleted while a session is open. Deleting refunds nothing and un-spends nothing; its credits, gear and boxes leave with it. A dead Crawler can be deleted. The GM logs each deletion and nothing

more.

```
[SYSTEM]
Crawler deleted. The System has filed your regret under “Later.”
```

SHEET CHANNELS

Every Crawler has its own text channel in the **Crawler Sheets** category, named `#<player>-<crawler>`. The card in it updates as you play.

PRE-BUILT CRAWLERS

New to 5e? On S1 you can pick **Use a pre-built**: twelve ready-made concepts, one per class, with a legal array assignment and standard kits already chosen. A pre-built fills the species, class, background, ability, skill, equipment, spell and orders screens. You still do your comfort lines, name, look, hook, survey, backstory and the review, and you can **Edit** anything that is pre-filled. A pre-built never skips review or confirmation.

WORKED EXAMPLE: TAMSIN VALE

Here is the whole flow for one Crawler, from first screen to locked sheet.

- **S3 and S4.** Name: **Tamsin Vale**. Look: *mall-security vest over a hoodie, one shoe untied.* Hook: *has told four hundred people “no running” and been ignored by all of them.*
- **S5 Species: Canadian (Human)**. Resourceful, Skillful, Versatile.
- **S6 Class: Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)**. Fighting Style: **Bubble-Wrap Enthusiast (Defense)**. Weapon Mastery: greatsword, flail, javelin.
- **S7 Background: Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)**. Raise Strength and Constitution: +2 Strength, +1 Constitution. Origin feat: **Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)**. Versatile feat: **Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)**.
- **S8 Scores:** Factory Preset. Base STR 15, DEX 13, CON 14, INT 8, WIS 12, CHA 10. After the Soldier increases: STR 17, DEX 13, CON 15, INT 8, WIS 12, CHA 10.
- **S9 Skills:** Soldier gives Athletics and Intimidation. Fighter picks Perception and Insight. Human Skillful gives Stealth. Languages: Common, Common Sign Language, Goblin.
- **S10 Equipment:** Package A for the class (chain mail, greatsword, flail, eight javelins, Dungeoneer’s Pack, 4 credits) and Package A for the background (spear, shortbow, arrows, a gaming set, Healer’s Kit, quiver, traveler’s clothes, 14 credits). Total credits: **18**.

TAMSIN VALE, LEVEL 1

Canadian (Human) · **Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter) 1** · **Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)** · Broadcast Name: PENDING

STR 17 (+3) · **DEX 13 (+1)** · **CON 15 (+2)** · **INT 8 (–1)** · **WIS 12 (+1)** · **CHA 10 (+0)** · Proficiency Bonus +2

Hit points 12 (d10 max 10 + Con 2) · **Hit Dice** 1d10 · **Armor Class** 17 (chain mail 16 + Defense 1) · **Speed** 30 ft · **Initiative** +1 · **Passive Perception** 13

Saves Strength +5, Constitution +4 · **Skills** Athletics, Intimidation, Perception, Insight, Stealth · **Feats** Savage Attacker, Alert, Defense (Fighting Style)

Attack Greatsword +5, 2d6 + 3 slashing · **Second Wind**, 2 uses · **Credits** 18

Orders: Hold the doorway; use Second Wind below half hit points. **Reactions:** Opportunity Attacks on.

Notice what she does not have: no magic items, no loot boxes, no Ratings. She is a competent, tough, slightly overqualified security guard with a very bad pair of shoes, and she is about to go downstairs.

APPENDIX: NON-SRD BACKGROUNDS AND ORIGIN FEATS

The kiosk lists twelve more backgrounds and six more Origin feats that are **not** in the SRD 5.2. Per decision 029 they appear here under **our reskin names only**, with a one-line mechanics summary in our own words. No parenthetical 5e name and no book text. Your GM may open them if the table owns the source books; the sheet still stores the underlying 5e key.

NON-SRD BACKGROUNDS (RESKIN NAMES)

RESKIN NAME	MECHANICS SUMMARY (OUR WORDS)
Etsy Shop Founder, Three Sales	Ability raises among Str/Dex/Int; tool-and-craft Origin feat; two skills and artisan's tools.
Pyramid-Scheme Boss Babe	Ability raises among Dex/Con/Cha; deception-leaning Origin feat; two skills and a forgery kit.
Wedding DJ With One Playlist	Ability raises among Str/Dex/Cha; performance Origin feat; two skills and a musical instrument.
Farm-to-Table Influencer	Ability raises among Str/Con/Wis; toughing-it-out Origin feat; two skills and a farming tool.
Hospital Parking-Garage Attendant	Ability raises among Str/Wis/Cha; alertness Origin feat; two skills and a gaming set.
Trailhead Guide With a Laminated Map	Ability raises among Dex/Con/Wis; magic-initiate-style Origin feat; two skills and a navigator's tools-style kit.
Doomsday Prepper, Collapse Postponed	Ability raises among Con/Wis/Cha; healer Origin feat; two skills and an herbalism kit.
Warehouse Operations Manager	Ability raises among Con/Int/Cha; lucky Origin feat; two skills and navigator's tools.
Trust-Fund Gallery Owner	Ability raises among Str/Int/Cha; skilled Origin feat; two skills and a gaming set.
Cruise-Ship Buffet Deckhand	Ability raises among Str/Dex/Wis; tavern-brawler Origin feat; two skills and navigator's tools.
Law-Firm Paralegal in Redline Hell	Ability raises among Dex/Int/Wis; skilled Origin feat; two skills and calligrapher's supplies.
Couch-Surfing Burrito Courier	Ability raises among Dex/Wis/Cha; lucky Origin feat; two skills and thieves' tools.

Appendix only. Sheet stores the underlying 5e background key. Open these only if the table owns the source books.

NON-SRD ORIGIN FEATS (RESKIN NAMES)

RESKIN NAME	MECHANICS SUMMARY (OUR WORDS)
Hot-Glue Gunslinger	Faster, cheaper crafting of nonmagical items; start with artisan's tools and discounts.
Weekend CPR-Class Graduate	Stabilize with a kit as a Bonus Action; heal dice when you Treat; kit uses refresh on a Short Rest.
Scratch-Ticket Gambler	A small pool of luck points to reroll your d20 or force an attacker to reroll.
Karaoke Night Regular	Encourage allies after a Short or Long Rest; grant temporary Hit Points or Heroic Inspiration.
HOA-Meeting Brawler	Improved unarmed strikes; grapple more easily; once per turn deal extra damage on an unarmed or improvised hit.
Gym Bro Who Spots at Dawn	Extra hit points equal to twice your level (and +2 HP each time you gain a level).

Appendix only. Human Versatile does not pick from this list in the printed book (SRD four only).

LEVEL 1 CHECKLIST

- [ ] Table settings read; comfort lines set (or skipped).
- [ ] Name, look and hook written; pronouns if you like.
- [ ] Species and lineage chosen. Sub-choices made.
- [ ] Class chosen, and its level 1 choices (style, order, invocation, masteries).
- [ ] Background chosen; ability increases picked; Origin feat noted.
- [ ] Six ability scores assigned by one of the three methods; background increases applied; no score above 20.
- [ ] Skills, tools and languages filled; Expertise picked if a Rogue.
- [ ] Class kit or credits chosen; background kit or credits chosen; leftover credits spent or kept.
- [ ] Spells picked, if a caster.
- [ ] Survey answered or passed; backstory and requested handle written.
- [ ] Standing Orders and Standing Reactions written.
- [ ] Review done; sheet confirmed.

```
[SYSTEM]
Files locked! Please exit your booth. Watch your step. The step is lying.
```

CHAPTER THREE

SPECIES

> *Welcome to the Identity Market. Everything here is your size, within reason, and none of it is returnable. Please do not touch the merchandise. The merchandise is you.*
>
> THE SYSTEM

Every Crawler walked into the Dungeon wearing the body they were born in. That body has been quietly edited. Your species, which the System calls your **Latent Biology**, is chosen at level 1 like any fifth edition species, and its traits work from your very first session. For two floors your body keeps the secret. On Floor 3 the secret comes out, and the System offers you a chance to become something else entirely.

This chapter covers what your species means in the Crawl, what happens at the Floor 3 **Identity Market**, the rules for rebuilding a Crawler there, and the seventeen **oddities**: the strange new species the System can offer you. Chapter 2 has the kiosk names, the trait list and the 24 lineages for the nine starting species; this chapter does not reprint them.

WHERE THE RULES LIVE

Species traits come from the **SRD 5.2** and are named, not reprinted. The oddities are ours: every number in their entries was written for this game. Where a rule here and the SRD disagree on the floor, this book wins for Crawl overlays (saferooms, the Offer, rebuilds).

LATENT BIOLOGY

You pick your species at level 1, for balance, and **every trait works from the start**. Darkvision sees in the dark on Floor 1. A Halfling's Luck rerolls a 1 in the tutorial. A Dragonborn's Breath Weapon clears a hallway of rats before anyone has learned the word "saferoom." Nothing is held back.

What is held back is the *look*. On Floors 1 and 2 everyone looks human. The System files your traits as **quirks**, each with a mundane-sounding excuse ("your pupils do a thing"), and toasts the first one that fires as a snark-only **Biology Anomaly (Logged)**. It never explains. If you ask why you can see in the dark, your file is under review. HOUSE

SMALL TELLS

You look human, but not *perfectly* human. Now and then the GM describes a **small tell** of your real species: a detail, never a feature. No horns, tails, scales, wings or fur appear on camera, and your height never changes. Tells are subtle and rare, once or twice a floor, and the camera never lingers on them. HOUSE

STARTING SPECIES	EXAMPLE TELLS
Welsh (Dragonborn)	Breath that fogs in a warm room; a faint scale pattern on the knuckles in the cold

STARTING SPECIES	EXAMPLE TELLS
Vietnamese (Dwarf)	Eyes that catch the light in the dark; the scale says you weigh 40 lb more than you look
Icelandic (Elf)	Ear tips a touch too pointed; ears that twitch at small sounds; you never quite yawn
Polish (Gnome)	Eyes a shade too bright; a laugh pitched where dogs notice
Samoan (Goliath)	Grey mottling on the shoulders like stone; every doorframe feels low
Belgian (Halfling)	Bare feet that never get cold; you always spot the coin on the floor
Canadian (Human)	None. That is the tell. The System finds it suspicious.
Azerbaijani (Orc)	A too-sharp lower canine; bruises gone by morning
Brazilian (Tiefling)	Warm eyes in the dark; a horn-shaped shadow that isn't there when you turn

- **Tells have no mechanics.** A tell gives no bonus and no penalty. NPCs don't react to one beyond a glance.
- **Size is still real.** A Halfling or Gnome is Small in the rules from level 1. The System's chyron calls them "compact."
- **Mirrors flicker.** Reflective surfaces in the Orientation Pit show a frame of the truth (an ear, a horn, a tail-shaped shadow) and the camera cuts away.
- **Your Look stays human.** When you write your Look at intake (Chapter 2), leave species features out, or wear them as a costume. The GM handles the tells.
- **Comfort settings apply.** If you opted out of body humor, your tells stay plain and nobody jokes about them.

THE NINE SPECIES IN THE CRAWL

Your starting species is one of the nine in the SRD, shown at the kiosk as **Our Name (5e Name)**. The nationality is the System's opinion of you; the parenthesized name is the species whose rules you use. Chapter 2 lists each species' size, speed and traits, and the lineage or ancestry choices for five of them. Below is how each one tends to play once the doors lock.

Welsh (Dragonborn). Your Breath Weapon replaces one of your attacks and fills a line or a cone, and Dungeon corridors were practically drawn for it. Pick an ancestry whose damage type the floor's mobs don't shrug off, and enjoy resisting the same type when the traps use it. Darkvision means you're the one who sees what's in the vent.

Vietnamese (Dwarf). Darkvision to 120 feet makes you the party's flashlight. Stonecunning turns any stone floor into an early-warning system: a Bonus Action of tremorsense and you know what's coming around the corner. Dwarven Toughness adds a hit point every level, and you resist poison, which matters more than you'd think in a place with vending machines.

Icelandic (Elf). Trance lets you finish a Long Rest in four hours of meditation and keeps magic from putting you to sleep. You still need a saferoom to rest, but you're up first, every time. Keen Senses gives you Insight, Perception or Survival, and Fey Ancestry shrugs off charm. Your lineage (Drow, High Elf, Wood Elf) decides whether you're the scout, the trickster or the runner.

Polish (Gnome). Gnomish Cunning gives you Advantage on Intelligence, Wisdom and Charisma saving throws, and the Dungeon throws a *lot* of those at you. You're Small, so Heavy weapons are a bad idea. Your lineage hands you cantrips that are better at problem-solving than they look.

Samoan (Goliath). Powerful Build lets you carry like a forklift and slip a grapple easily. Your giant ancestry gives you a few uses per Long Rest of something loud: a teleport, extra fire or cold, a knockdown, a damage soak. From level 5, **Large Form** makes you Large for 10 minutes at a time; use the Large rules later in this chapter while it lasts.

Belgian (Halfling). Luck rerolls every natural 1 on a d20 test, and in a game where the System rolls in the open, that ding is the sweetest sound on the floor. Brave helps against fear, Nimbleness lets you walk through bigger creatures' spaces, and you can hide behind your own party. Small: no Heavy weapons.

Canadian (Human). Resourceful gives you Heroic Inspiration after every Long Rest, Skillful adds a skill, and Versatile adds a second Origin feat. Humans are the most flexible starting species and the only one with **no tells at all**. A Human who keeps Human at Floor 3 gains **Unbroken Original**, described below.

Azerbaijani (Orc). Relentless Endurance drops you to 1 hit point instead of 0 once per Long Rest. It is a species trait and works as written; it isn't one of the System's near-death buffers. Adrenaline Rush lets you Dash as a Bonus Action for temporary hit points, which is exactly what a collapsing floor wants from you. Darkvision reaches 120 feet.

Brazilian (Tiefling). Your Fiendish Legacy gives you a damage resistance and a cantrip at level 1 and more spells at levels 3 and 5. Otherworldly Presence adds Thaumaturgy, which is mostly for theater, and theater is how the Crawl keeps score.

PICK FOR THE FLOOR YOU'RE ON

Your starting species will carry you through Floors 1 and 2, and you can keep it forever. Choose the one that fits the Crawler you want to play now. Floor 3 offers changes; it never requires them.

FLOOR 3: THE IDENTITY MARKET

On Floor 3 the Crawl reaches the **Kingdom Continuum**, and the System decides your file is ready. Every Crawler gets **one** chance to keep what they are, or to be dissolved, reorganized and reissued as something new. In the source series, the System recommends a handful of races out of hundreds at this point. Our version is smaller, private, and comes with a background and class option attached. INSPIRED

WHEN IT OPENS

The Identity Market opens in the **first saferoom of Floor 3**, during **Floor Onboarding**, right after you reach level 3. You can pick your level 3 subclass then, or wait to see your Offer first.

- **It opens before your first Long Rest on Floor 3 finishes.** The rebuild itself is not a rest and doesn't count as one.
- **It stays open until the party leaves Floor 3** by the stairwell. Take your time, ask questions, sleep on it.
- **An absent player's Offer waits** for them. A Crawler running on Standing Orders never accepts an Offer.
- **An Offer still unanswered at the Floor 3 stairwell counts as declined.** You keep everything as it is, and your starting species manifests.

The System makes one public announcement to the whole party. Then each Crawler gets their own card.

```
[SYSTEM]
Congratulations, Crawlers. Your Latent Biology file is out of review. Each of you will be shown three options. You may keep what you walked in with, or you may be reissued in a new body at no charge. One time. No refunds, no exchanges, no screaming. Your faces are about to stop lying.
```

YOUR OFFER CARD

Your **Offer Card** is private. Only you see it, though you may show it to anyone you like. It has three parts, and each part is free, optional and used once.

PART	YOUR CHOICES
Species	**A. Keep** your starting species (always offered, always free). **B** or **C**: one of **two oddities** the System picked for you.
Background	Keep your Prior Employment, or **redo** it under the same rules you used at level 1.
Class	Keep your class and pick any subclass as normal, or take one of **two class options** built on your class (see below).

The System picks your two oddities. It picks the ones it thinks suit you, and it won't tell you why; the card's rationale line usually just says *"The System noticed things."* The System is petty, but it **never offers a trap**: both oddities are real trade-offs, and the card states every cost plainly.

The card shows its math. Each oddity lists what you **gain** at your level, what you **lose** from your starting species, what it **costs** (its drawback), and any **warnings**: a gate you'd need to meet, a Small body with a Heavy weapon in your hands, a Large body on a floor full of narrow doors. If you're Human, option A shows Unbroken Original. **Asking questions and previewing are free.**

CHOOSING

You give three answers, privately if you like: **species** (A, B or C), **background** (keep or redo), and **class** (keep, option 1 or option 2). You may change your mind until the transformation starts. After that, every choice is locked.

- **Keep everything** and nothing changes on your sheet, except that a Human who keeps Human gains Unbroken Original. Your starting species **manifests**: the horns, ears, scales, tail or stone-grey shoulders arrive on camera, and the System has a line about it.
- **Take anything else** and you rebuild (see "Rebuilding" below), then the transformation scene runs.
- **The result is announced.** Everyone learns your new species and your Official Class Title. Nobody learns what you turned down unless you tell them.

CLASS OPTIONS

Your Offer Card also shows **two class options** for the class you already have. A class option is a named Crawl class built on **your same class**: it sets your subclass and adds one small **Perk** and one small **Negative**. It is free and optional, like the species rebuild, and you can take it once. Your level, Hit Point Dice, maximum hit points,

class features, spells and equipment stay. If you had already picked a different level 3 subclass, it is swapped for the option's subclass. The option's name becomes your **Official Class Title**. There is no swap to a different class. HOUSE

Built on. The first option of each class uses an SRD subclass so every table can run it. The second uses a 2024 Player's Handbook subclass when the table owns the book; otherwise it uses the SRD fallback in brackets, with the same Perk and Negative. Names are locked from the display table. INSPIRED

If a Perk gives a proficiency you already have, pick another of the same kind (skill for skill, tool for tool). A Crawler below level 3 who locks an option in gets the Perk and Negative at once; the subclass arrives at level 3.

Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)

- **Football Hooligan (Barbarian).** Built on Path of the Berserker. **Terrace Chant:** when you start a Rage, one ally within 30 feet who can hear you gains Temporary Hit Points equal to your Proficiency Bonus. **Red Card:** you can't take the Disengage action while Raging.
- **Feral Cat Berserker (Barbarian).** Built on Path of the Wild Heart (SRD fallback: Berserker). **Alley Climber:** while Raging you have a Climb Speed equal to your Speed. **Hates Baths:** Disadvantage on Strength (Athletics) checks to swim.

Open-Mic Menace (Bard)

- **Song Bard (Bard).** Built on College of Lore. **Encore:** once per Long Rest, when a creature rolls your Bardic Inspiration die and still fails, that use isn't spent. **Can't Stop Humming:** Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to move quietly.
- **Legendary Diva (Bard).** Built on College of Glamour (SRD fallback: Lore). **Stage Presence:** Advantage on Charisma (Performance) checks in front of three or more watchers. **Sung Spells:** every spell you cast must be sung; you can't cast while you can't sing (silenced, gagged, underwater).

Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)

- **Physicker (Cleric).** Built on Life Domain. **Triage:** proficiency with the Herbalism Kit, and you can stabilize a creature at 0 HP as a Bonus Action (Wisdom (Medicine) as normal). **Bedside Manner:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Intimidation) checks.
- **Fire Spiritualist (Cleric).** Built on Light Domain (SRD fallback: Life). **Juiced:** once per Long Rest, as a Bonus Action, one ally within 30 feet has Advantage on its next attack roll before the end of its next turn. **Pilot Light:** you glow faintly; Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks in darkness.

Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)

- **Banana Farmer (Druid).** Built on Circle of the Land. **Banana Seed:** proficiency with the Herbalism Kit; after each Long Rest you grow one banana that heals 1d4 HP as a Bonus Action. It rots at your next Long Rest and can't be sold or traded. **Fruit Flies:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks indoors with strangers.
- **Earth Mover (Druid).** Built on Circle of the Moon (SRD fallback: Land). **Stone Feet:** Advantage on saving throws against being knocked Prone or moved against your will while you stand on stone or earth. **Heavy Tread:** Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks on hard floors.

Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)

- **Pit Fighter (Fighter).** Built on Champion. **Crowd Work:** proficiency in Intimidation or Performance. **Showboat:** Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to hide during combat.
- **Boring Ol' Fighter (Fighter).** Built on Battle Master (SRD fallback: Champion). **Basics Done Right:** one extra Fighting Style feat. **No Magic:** you can't cast spells from any source (class, species, feat, scroll or item); spell scrolls are sell-only for you. Magic weapons, armor and potions still work. Not offered if you already have species or feat spells.

Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)

- **Prizefighter (Monk).** Built on Warrior of the Open Hand. **Pugilist:** proficiency in Athletics. **Punch-Drunk:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks in formal settings (the GM judges).
- **Street Monk (Monk).** Built on Warrior of Shadow (SRD fallback: Open Hand). **Parkour:** climbing walls, buildings and scaffolding costs you no extra movement. **No Fixed Address:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks with officials on first meeting.

HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)

- **Sacred Paladin (Paladin).** Built on Oath of Devotion. **Liturgy:** proficiency in Religion, and you know the Light cantrip (Charisma). **Can't Lie:** you can't tell a flat lie; a Deception check that needs one fails. Misleading truths are fine.
- **Black Inquisitor General (Paladin).** Built on Oath of Vengeance (SRD fallback: Devotion). **Mage Training:** you know one Wizard cantrip (Charisma). **Dread Reputation:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks on first meeting with clergy and lawkeepers.

Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)

- **Pest Exterminator (Ranger).** Built on Hunter. **Tent the House:** once per Long Rest you can cast Fog Cloud without a spell slot (Wisdom). **Bug-Spray Smell:** Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks against creatures that hunt by scent.
- **Archer (Ranger).** Built on Gloom Stalker (SRD fallback: Hunter). **Archery Training:** the Archery Fighting Style feat (or another Fighting Style if you already have it). **Arrow Snob:** Disadvantage on attack rolls with thrown and improvised weapons.

Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)

- **Fugitive (Rogue).** Built on Thief. **Slippery:** Advantage on checks to escape a grapple or nonmagical restraints. **Wanted:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks with guards and militia.
- **Spy (Rogue).** Built on Assassin (SRD fallback: Thief). **Tradecraft:** proficiency with the Disguise Kit. **Burned Cover:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Deception) checks against anyone who has caught you in a lie on this floor.

Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)

- **Blizzardmancer (Sorcerer).** Built on Draconic Sorcery (cold ancestry). **Cold Snap:** you know Ray of Frost; it doesn't count against your cantrips. **Ice Queen:** Disadvantage on saving throws against extreme heat.
- **Glass Cannon (Sorcerer).** Built on Wild Magic (SRD fallback: Draconic). **Overclocked:** your Sorcery Point maximum is higher by your Proficiency Bonus. **Fragile:** your Hit Point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to your level.

Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)

- **Halloween Aficionado (Warlock).** Built on Fiend Patron. **Spooky Season:** proficiency in Intimidation, and a free boxcutter (a Dagger). **Goth Phase:** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks with clergy and cheerful people.
- **Poet Laureate (Warlock).** Built on Celestial Patron (SRD fallback: Fiend). **Commissioned Verse:** once per Long Rest, a 1-minute recital gives each ally who hears it Temporary Hit Points equal to your Proficiency Bonus. **Patron's Deadline:** each Long Rest you must recite a new verse (a line or two, in character) or you can't regain Pact Magic slots on a Short Rest until your next Long Rest.

Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)

- **Fire Mage Arcanist (Wizard).** Built on Evoker. **Kindling:** you know Fire Bolt; it doesn't count against your cantrips. **Singed:** after you cast a fire spell, Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks for 1 minute (smoke).
- **Boring Ol' Mage (Wizard).** Built on Abjurer (SRD fallback: Evoker). **Study Habits:** you can prepare one extra Wizard spell. **No Fighting:** Disadvantage on attack rolls with weapons (spell attacks are fine).

ONCE ONLY

The Offer happens **once per Crawler**. The rebuild is **irreversible**. Nothing in the Crawl, not a box, a sponsor, a potion or a favor, ever reopens the Offer or rebuilds you a second time. If you keep your species, you can't take an oddity later. If you take one, you can't go back. **No reissue, ever.**

STAYING HUMAN: UNBROKEN ORIGINAL

About the only thing rarer than an oddity in the Dungeon is a Crawler who looks at a menu of wings, fangs and extra heads and says *"No thanks, I'm good."* The System respects that, in its way. HOUSE

Who gets it. A Crawler whose starting species is **Human** and who picks **option A (Keep)** at the Floor 3 Offer. A Crawler created as Human after Floor 3 also gets it (see "Replacement Crawlers" at the end of this chapter). Redoing your background or taking a class option doesn't affect it.

What you keep. Resourceful, Skillful and Versatile, exactly as the SRD gives them, including the bonus Origin feat from Versatile.

What you gain: Unbroken Original.

- **Crowd Favorite. Once per floor**, when the crowd would love it (a stunt, a stand, a perfect line; the GM decides), you gain **Heroic Inspiration**. If you already have it, you can give it to another Crawler who doesn't.
- **Original Certificate.** At the Floor 3 Offer you gain **one extra Origin feat** you don't already have. A Repeatable feat can be taken again as its text allows. In this book, pick from the four SRD Origin feats: Alert, Magic Initiate, Savage Attacker or Skilled.

Your Versatile feat and your Original Certificate feat are species feats, not background feats, so redoing your background never removes them.

Leaving Human. A Human who takes an oddity loses Resourceful, Skillful and Versatile, **including the Versatile bonus Origin feat**, and never gets Unbroken Original. The Offer Card says so on its "loses" line.

Manifesting. You manifest as exactly yourself, with no tells. The System hands you a laminated "Original" certificate. It is cosmetic. It is also laminated, which is more than most Crawlers get.

REBUILDING

A rebuild has **three parts**, and you may take any, all or none of them, once each: a **species swap** (option B or C), a **background redo**, and a **class option**. It happens only at the Floor 3 Offer, or when a Crawler is created after Floor 3. HOUSE

WHAT A SPECIES SWAP CHANGES

Everything that came from your old species goes. Everything from your new one arrives at your **current level**.

AREA	WHAT HAPPENS
Creature type	You're Humanoid before and after. Every oddity is Humanoid.
Size and speed	Replaced by the oddity's. Large Crawlers have their own rules below.
Senses	Darkvision, tremorsense and the like are replaced.
Resistances and save bonuses	Replaced.
Species skills and tools	The old ones go, unless your class or background also gives them. If the new species gives one you already have, pick a different skill or tool of the same kind.
Species spells	The old ones go. New species spells use Intelligence, Wisdom or Charisma, your choice when you take them. Class spells are untouched.
Species feats	The old ones go, including a Human's Versatile feat.
Limited-use traits	Old ones disappear. New ones start **fully available**.
Languages	Unchanged. Your languages come from your background.

WHAT STAYS

Your level, class, Hit Point Dice, class spells and slots, class equipment, backstory, Broadcast Name, achievements, credits, loot boxes, conditions and Exhaustion. Your background stays unless you redo it. Your subclass stays unless you take a class option.

Ability scores never change from a species swap. In these rules your ability increases come from your background, not your species. Your **base scores** (from the standard array, point buy or the Roll method) never change at all.

Hit points. Your class hit points and Constitution bonus stay as they are. The only species hit-point trait among the nine is Dwarven Toughness: **a Dwarf who takes an oddity loses 1 hit point of maximum per level.** No oddity adds any. Your current hit points stay where they are, capped at your new maximum, and the rebuild never drops you below 1.

Recalculate **Armor Class, initiative and saving throws** from your new traits. Your Proficiency Bonus comes from your level and doesn't change.

REDOING YOUR BACKGROUND

You may redo your **Prior Employment (background)** once, with or without a species swap.

- **Out:** the old background's ability score increases, its two skills, its tool and its Origin feat, along with anything that feat gave you.
- **In:** the new background's, chosen exactly as at level 1. Apply **+2 and +1**, or **+1 to all three**, among its three listed abilities. No score can go above 20.
- **Base scores stay.** Only the background increases move.
- **Knock-on effects.** If your Constitution changes, recalculate your maximum hit points; your current hit points are capped at the new maximum and never drop below 1. Recalculate Armor Class, saves, skill bonuses, spell save DC and attack bonuses.
- **Gear.** You keep the old background's starting equipment. The new background gives no equipment and no credits.
- **Same list.** The same backgrounds you could pick at level 1 (Chapter 2), shown under their Prior Employment names.

RESOURCES, GEAR AND ATTUNEMENT

- **The transformation is not a rest.** It restores no hit points, spell slots or Hit Point Dice. Traits from your **new** species start full, a one-time gift of the new body; spent uses of old traits are simply gone.
- **Your gear fits.** The System retailors your clothing, armor and normal gear to the new body (*"Wardrobe Adjustment, no charge, no dignity"*). Magic items resize as fifth edition allows. You may re-equip freely at the market.
- **Small bodies and Heavy weapons.** If you become Small, you have Disadvantage on attack rolls with Heavy weapons, as the SRD says. The card warns you.
- **Attunement stays at three.** If an item needs attunement by a species or creature type you no longer are, the attunement ends and the slot is free; attune to something else at your next Short Rest.
- **Curses stay.** If a curse names your old species, the GM adapts it to the new one.

NATURAL WEAPONS

Many oddities grow claws, fangs, horns, jaws or a tongue. A **natural weapon** is an **Unarmed Strike** that deals the listed damage die and type instead of the usual 1 plus your Strength modifier.

- You're proficient with it.
- Use the **higher of your Strength or Dexterity** modifier for its attack and damage rolls.
- It doesn't use Weapon Mastery, and weapon enchantments don't apply to it. Magic items that improve Unarmed Strikes (wraps, bracers) do.
- A Monk's Martial Arts die replaces the listed die if the Monk's die is higher.

THE TRANSFORMATION

The System dissolves you, reorganizes you and reissues you, all in a few lines of commentary, and the GM adds one concrete detail about the new body (*"your voice drops half an octave," "your left hand has opinions"*). If you opted out of body-transformation humor, you get the short version: two lines, no jokes about your body. Fade to black on request, as always.

```
[SYSTEM]
Dissolving. Please keep all limbs inside the vat until the vat says otherwise. You will
feel warm, then wrong, then warm again. Done. Please check your teeth. Check them again.
There are more of them now.
```

LARGE CRAWLERS

One oddity, the **American (Sasquatch)**, is Large all the time, and a Goliath's Large Form uses these rules while it lasts. The core rules are the SRD's; the lines marked HOUSE are ours.

- **Space.** You take up a **10-by-10-foot** space. You can move through an ally's space, an Incapacitated creature's space, and the space of a Tiny creature.
- **Squeezing.** HOUSE You can move through a gap at least **5 feet** wide. While you're in a space narrower than 10 feet, each foot of movement costs **1 extra foot**, you have **Disadvantage on attack rolls and Dexterity saving throws**, and attack rolls against you have **Advantage**. You can't fit through a gap narrower than 5 feet. Most Crawl corridors are 10 feet wide. Many doors, vents and stairwells are not.
- **Saferoom doors.** HOUSE An honest saferoom's door, and your Personal Space door, always fit every Crawler in the party; the System widens them with a sigh. Inside a saferoom you never squeeze. The furniture is another matter.
- **Carrying.** You carry Strength × 30 lb and can drag, lift or push Strength × 60 lb.
- **Food.** You need 4 lb of food a day. HOUSE A saferoom meal counts as a full day's food for you; the System upsizes it at no charge.
- **Grapple and Shove.** You can Grapple or Shove a creature up to **Huge**.
- **Mounts.** A mount must be Huge or bigger. In practice, you walk.
- **Gear.** HOUSE After the rebuild, armor and clothing you find or buy must be tailored at a saferoom counter: free, 1 hour, and it can happen during a rest. Magic armor and clothing resize themselves. **Weapons need no change**: you use normal weapons for normal damage, and you have no penalty with Heavy weapons.
- **Hiding.** You need cover big enough to hide behind, which the GM decides. There's no other size penalty to Stealth.
- **Spells and effects** that care about size (*Enlarge/Reduce*, nets, grapples, some traps) treat you as Large.

THE ODDITIES

An **oddity** is a species you can only get from the Identity Market (or by joining after Floor 3). There are seventeen. Most are shaped by species from the source series, which we mark INSPIRED; one, the Raptorkin, is our own invention HOUSE. **Every number in every entry is ours.** None of the oddities is strictly better than the

species you started with. Each one trades something.

READING AN ODDITY

Every entry uses the same layout: the kiosk name, a line of flavor, a stat line (size, speed, senses and any **gate** you must meet to be offered it), its **traits**, what it gains **at levels 3 and 5**, its **drawback**, and a word from the System. A few common rules apply to all of them:

- **Creature type:** Humanoid.
- **Species DC** = 8 + your Proficiency Bonus + the ability modifier the trait names.
- **"Once per Long Rest," "PB times per Long Rest"** and similar limits refresh as they say. PB means your Proficiency Bonus.
- **Level means character level.** Crawlers reach Floor 3 at level 3, so level 3 traits are active the moment you take the oddity.
- **Natural weapons** follow the rules above (higher of Strength or Dexterity).
- **Variants are cosmetic.** Where an oddity lists forms, breeds or head counts, they change your look and your kiosk name, never your rules.

ODDITIES AT A GLANCE

ODDITY	SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	SIGNATURE TRAITS	DRAWBACK	GATE
Romanian (Bloodbound)	Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Fangs; Blood Drain; necrotic resistance	Thirst; Sunlight Sensitivity	Opt-in
Moroccan (Caprid)	Medium (or Small)	30 ft	none	Horns; Mountain Legs; Iron Gut; Insight	Musk	none
Scottish (Changeling)	Medium	30 ft	none	Touch Memory; Shift; Borrowed Knack	Imperfect Facsimile	none
Australian (Crocodilian)	Medium	30 ft, swim 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Thick Hide; Jaws; Monster Meal	Typecast	none
German (Doppelganger)	Medium (or Small)	30 ft	none	Sculpt Self; Mass Shaping	Shaping Pain; Equipped Mass	none
English (Fairy)	Small	30 ft, fly 30 ft	none	Wings; Fae Magic; Fey Mind	Small; Fae Steel Only	none
Turkish (Felid)	Medium or Small	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Claws; Land on Your Feet; Nine Lives (Minor)	Distractible Hunter	none
Greenlandic (Frost Maiden)	Small	30 ft	none	Drift; cold resistance; Clear Mind; Ray of Frost	Small; Melting Point	none
Finnish (Grulke)	Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Powerful Legs; Tongue Lash; Slick Skin	Damp	none
Japanese (Hobgoblin)	Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Trapsmith; Sapper's Edge; Troll's Knit; workshop access	Face for Radio	Explosives Handling 5
Mexican (Lajabless)	Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Radiant and Skull phases	Phase drawbacks	Best for casters
Indian (Naga)	Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Poison resistance; Fangs; Venom	Cold-Blooded	none

ODDITY	SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	SIGNATURE TRAITS	DRAWBACK	GATE
Argentine (Nodling)	Medium	30 ft	none	Two Minds; Second Opinion; Double Take	Mixed Messages; Headgear	none
Tanzanian (Primal)	Medium	35 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Primal Senses; Primal Vigor; Expertise at 5	none	none
Mongolian (Raptorkin)	Small	35 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Bite; Pack Hunter; Good Nose	Collared; Small	none
American (Sasquatch)	**Large**	35 ft	none	Big; Smush; cold resistance	Cryptid	Str 15 + Athletics
Albanian (Skyfowl)	Medium	30 ft	none	Keen Eyes; Eagle Eye; Talons; Glide	Proud to a Fault; Wing Gear	none

ROMANIAN (BLOODBOUND)

You drink blood to survive, and you are terribly polite about it. The System adores how dramatic you look in sunlight. You do not adore sunlight. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	**Opt-in.** You must say yes to it. Bite and feeding scenes follow your comfort settings.

Traits.

- **Fangs.** Natural weapon, 1d4 piercing.
- **Blood Drain.** PB times per Long Rest, when you hit with your Fangs a creature that is Grappled, Restrained, Incapacitated or willing, you can add 1d6 necrotic damage and regain hit points equal to the necrotic damage dealt. Constructs and Undead give you no healing.
- **Grave Chill.** Resistance to necrotic damage.

Level 3: Charm. Once per Long Rest, you can cast *Charm Person* without a spell slot. Choose Intelligence, Wisdom or Charisma as its spellcasting ability when you take this trait.

Level 5. Blood Drain deals 2d6. **Mist Step:** once per Long Rest, you can cast *Misty Step* without a spell slot (same ability).

Drawbacks.

- **Thirst.** HOUSE After each Long Rest you must **feed** before you finish your next one. Feeding means either hitting a creature with your Fangs (it must have blood: Constructs, Undead, Oozes, Plants and Elementals don't count), or drinking from a willing creature as an Action while it's within 5 feet (it takes 1d4 piercing damage that can't be reduced). Bagged or bottled blood doesn't count; the System says it has to be fresh. If you finish a Long Rest without having fed since the one before, you gain **1 Exhaustion level**. Thirst Exhaustion isn't removed by a Long Rest; **all of it goes away the moment you feed**. Thirst can never take you past **3 Exhaustion levels**. It is a drawback, not a death clock.
- **Sunlight Sensitivity.** In direct sunlight (Floor 3's open fields count) you have Disadvantage on attack rolls and on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight. A hooded cloak or wide-brimmed hat removes the attack penalty, not the Perception one.

> **System:** "Bloodbound. A refined palate and a very good hat. We'll be filming the sunlight scene at noon."

MOROCCAN (CAPRID)

A walking, talking goat person with a mountain in your knees. You judge people by asking them questions, which is meant as a compliment. You're polite until someone is stupid. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium (Small with the GM's approval)	30 ft	none	none

Breeds (cosmetic): Bhutanese (Small Caprid) and Montenegrin (Large Dark Caprid). A breed is a look and a kiosk name. Your size is Medium, or Small if the GM approves, whichever breed you pick; no Caprid is Large.

Traits.

- **Horns.** Natural weapon, 1d6 bludgeoning.
- **Mountain Legs.** You ignore difficult terrain from rocky or steep ground, and your jump distances are 5 feet longer.
- **Iron Gut.** Advantage on saving throws against ingested poison and sickness. You can digest anything a goat could.
- **Headstrong.** Advantage on saving throws against being Charmed.
- **Herd Judgment.** Proficiency in Insight.

Level 3: Butt Rush. Once per turn, when you hit a Large or smaller creature with your Horns after moving at least 10 feet straight toward it, you can push it up to 10 feet. It makes a Strength saving throw (Species DC, Strength) to resist.

Level 5: Charge. The first time you hit with your Horns on your turn after moving at least 20 feet straight toward the target, deal an extra 1d6 bludgeoning.

Drawback: Musk. You smell strongly of animal. You have Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks against creatures that hunt by scent, and on Charisma checks in confined spaces with strangers who can smell you. A bath clears it for a day.

> **System:** "Caprid. We asked you a question. It was a compliment. Please answer in under four hours."

SCOTTISH (CHANGELING)

Your body is a rumor you started. You remember every hand you shake, and the face that went with it. The copy is never perfect, which is why you wear gloves in front of mirrors. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	none	none

Traits.

- **Touch Memory.** When you touch a willing creature, or hit one with an Unarmed Strike, you can record its appearance. You hold up to PB forms; recording another replaces the oldest.
- **Shift.** As a Magic action, you take the appearance of a recorded form of your size or one size different. Your statistics don't change. The shift ends when you use a Bonus Action, fall Unconscious, or after 1 hour. After you shift, you can't shift again for 10 minutes (or until you finish a Short or Long Rest).
- **Imperfect Facsimile.** Every form has one tell the GM chooses (the eyes, the hands, the laugh). A creature that studies you closely can spot it with a DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) or Intelligence (Investigation) check. You can roll Deception against that DC to hide it.
- **Borrowed Knack.** While shifted, you gain one thing the form plausibly has: Darkvision 60 feet, a Swim or Climb Speed equal to your Speed, or a 1d4 natural weapon. It lasts while you hold the form.
- **Mimic's Ear.** Proficiency in Deception.

Level 3: Quick Shift. Once per Long Rest, you can shift as a Bonus Action and ignore the 10-minute wait.

Level 5: Second Knack. You gain two knacks while shifted.

Drawback. The tell, the wait between shifts, and reverting when you're knocked out. You can't become anyone you haven't touched.

> **System:** "Changeling. A face for every occasion and none of them yours. You'll be popular at parties and blamed after."

AUSTRALIAN (CROCODILIAN)

Thick-skinned, semi-aquatic and built for eating things you killed yourself. The Dungeon likes to hire your kind as muscle. You will be asked to stand near doors. A lot. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft, swim 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	none

Traits.

- **Thick Hide.** Without armor, your Armor Class is 12 + your Dexterity modifier. A shield still adds.
- **Jaws.** Natural weapon, 1d6 piercing.
- **Swimmer.** Swim Speed 30 feet, and you can hold your breath for 1 hour.
- **Monster Meal.** Once per Long Rest, after a 10-minute meal made from a creature of CR 1/4 or higher that you killed since your last Long Rest (the GM approves the cut), you gain temporary hit points equal to twice your level until your next Long Rest.

Level 3: Death Roll. Once per turn, when you hit a Large or smaller creature with your Jaws, you can grapple it without a free hand (escape DC 8 + PB + your Strength modifier). While you hold it this way, you can't bite anything else or speak.

Level 5. Jaws deal 1d8.

Drawback: Typecast. Strangers assume you're hired muscle. You have Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks with creatures who've just met you in "respectable" settings (the GM decides), and Advantage on Charisma (Intimidation) checks against rowdy crowds.

> **System:** "Crocodilian. You're not stupid, you're efficient. The audience prefers the other word."

GERMAN (DOPPELGANGER)

You are clay with opinions. You can sculpt yourself into anyone's shape, but you only get the shape: wings that don't fly, gills that don't breathe. There's a fixed amount of you, and moving it around hurts. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium (Small while sculpted Small)	30 ft	none	none

Traits.

- **Sculpt Self.** As a Magic action, you reshape your look into any Medium or Small Humanoid, including a specific person you've studied for 10 minutes. Your statistics don't change, and you gain none of that creature's traits. The shape lasts until you sculpt again or fall Unconscious.
- **Mass Shaping.** As a Bonus Action, you shape part of yourself into one feature, which lasts until you change it or fall Unconscious: **Blade Arm** (natural weapon, 1d6 slashing or piercing), **Long Reach** (your Unarmed Strikes and natural weapons have 10-foot reach), **Climbing Hooks** (a Climb Speed equal to your Speed), or **Dense Plates** (+1 Armor Class while you aren't wearing Heavy armor). You hold one feature at a time.
- **Shaping Pain.** Each time you use Sculpt Self or Mass Shaping, you take damage equal to your PB. It can't be reduced in any way.
- **Fixed Mass.** You weigh the same in any shape. Sculpted Small, you keep your Medium weight and carrying capacity, but the Small rule for Heavy weapons applies.
- **Mimic.** Proficiency in Deception or Performance (your choice).

Level 3: Flow. You can move through a gap as narrow as 1 foot without squeezing, and you have Advantage on checks to escape a grapple.

Level 5. You hold two features at once.

Drawbacks. Shaping Pain, plus **Equipped Mass**: when you sculpt to a different size, armor you're wearing doesn't change with you unless it was fitted at an Armorer's Workshop (Chapter 6; workshops open from Floor 4). Unfitted armor has to come off first. This is a limit, not free workshop access.

German (Doppelganger) or Scottish (Changeling)? A Scottish (Changeling) copies faces it has touched and borrows a knack. A German (Doppelganger) sculpts any look, borrows nothing, and builds its own tools out of itself.

> **System:** "Doppelganger. Every face, none of the perks, and it stings every time. We call that a learning experience."

ENGLISH (FAIRY)

Wings like stained glass, a temper like a wasp, and magic that lives in the wings. Small enough to ride in a backpack, loud enough that you never will. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Small	30 ft, fly 30 ft (see Wings)	none	none

Variants (cosmetic): Danish (Sprite) or Chinese (Wisteria Fairy).

Traits.

- **Wings.** You have a Fly Speed equal to your Speed. You can't use it in Medium or Heavy armor, while Grappled or Restrained, or with your wings bound. Until level 5, you must end each turn on the ground or another solid surface, or you fall.
- **Fae Magic.** You know the *Druidcraft* cantrip. Choose Intelligence, Wisdom or Charisma as its spellcasting ability. Your magic is in your wings: you can't cast these spells while Grappled or with your wings bound.
- **Fey Mind.** Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition, and magic can't put you to sleep.
- **Underfoot.** You can move through the space of any Medium or larger creature.

Level 3. You can cast *Faerie Fire* once per Long Rest without a spell slot (Fae Magic ability and limits).

Level 5: True Flight. You no longer have to end your turn on a surface.

Drawbacks. A **Small body** (Heavy weapons), and **Fae Steel Only**: you can't wear metal armor or carry a metal shield unless it's made of Fae Steel. Padded, leather, studded leather and wooden shields are fine.

> **System:** "Fairy. Small, shiny and furious. Please stop dusting the camera lens."

TURKISH (FELID)

You've always been agile, unreasonable and fond of being seen. Now the System has made it official. Pick your fur. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium or Small (choose at the Offer)	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	none

Forms (cosmetic): Egyptian (Cat), Taiwanese (Cat Girl), Bangladeshi (Tigran) and Bulgarian (Were-Cat). Every form uses the Felid rules below, unchanged.

Traits.

- **Claws.** Natural weapon, 1d6 slashing.
- **Land on Your Feet.** Reduce falling damage by three times your level. You never land Prone from a fall.
- **Keen Nose and Ears.** Advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.
- **Nine Lives (Minor).** Once per Long Rest, as a Reaction when a creature hits you with an attack, halve the damage (round down). It cuts damage; it never cancels a death on its own.

Level 3: Pounce. Once per Short or Long Rest, after you move at least 20 feet straight toward a creature, you can make one Claws attack against it as a Bonus Action.

Level 5. Claws deal 1d8.

Drawback: Distractible Hunter. Once per session, when a tiny fast-moving lure turns up (a laser dot, a dangling string, a skittering bug), the GM may call for a DC 10 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, you spend your next move and your next action chasing it. When it triggers, you also gain Heroic Inspiration. And dogs and dog-folk have it in for you: you have Disadvantage on Charisma checks against them.

> **System:** "Felid. Remarkably flexible, remarkably smug. The audience will love you for exactly as long as you're cute."

GREENLANDIC (FROST MAIDEN)

Four and a half feet of white hair, cold hands and very clear thoughts. In a crisis your mind goes still, the way a frozen lake goes still. You drift an inch off the floor, and frost follows you into the room. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Small	30 ft	none	none

Traits.

- **Drift.** You float an inch off the ground. You ignore difficult terrain made of ice, snow, mud or shallow water, and you leave no footprints.
- **Cold Skin.** Resistance to cold damage.
- **Clear Mind.** Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition, and magic can't put you to sleep.
- **Frost Touch.** You know the *Ray of Frost* cantrip. Choose Intelligence, Wisdom or Charisma as its spellcasting ability at the rebuild.

Level 3: Frost Nova. Once per Long Rest, as a Magic action, each creature you choose within 10 feet makes a Constitution saving throw (Species DC, your Frost Touch ability). On a failure it takes 2d6 cold damage and its Speed drops by 10 feet until the start of your next turn. On a success it takes half damage only.

Level 5: Hover. You have a Fly Speed equal to your Speed, but you can't rise more than 5 feet above a solid surface or liquid. Frost Nova deals 3d6.

Drawbacks. A **Small body** (Heavy weapons), and **Melting Point**: Disadvantage on saving throws against extreme heat, and in extreme heat your Speed is 20 feet until you cool down for 10 minutes.

> **System:** "Frost Maiden. Cool, calm and slightly see-through. The audience loves an ice queen right up until she melts."

FINNISH (GRULKE)

Five feet of warty, leaping toad person from a proud warrior people. You jump like a rumor and hit like a tongue-shaped sledgehammer. Do not call yourself a frog. The System will do it for you. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	none

Traits.

- **Powerful Legs.** Your jump distances are doubled, and you never need a running start.
- **Tongue Lash.** Natural weapon with 10-foot reach, 1d6 bludgeoning. As a free object interaction, you can also fetch an unattended object of up to 10 lb within 10 feet.
- **Slick Skin.** Advantage on checks and saving throws to escape a grapple or nonmagical restraints.
- **Amphibious Gulp.** You can hold your breath for 30 minutes.

Level 3: Yank. Once per turn, when you hit a Medium or smaller creature with Tongue Lash, you can pull it up to 5 feet straight toward you.

Level 5. Tongue Lash deals 1d8.

Drawback: Damp. Your skin must stay moist. If you go a full day without wetting it (a quart of water poured over you counts), you have Disadvantage on Dexterity saving throws until you do. Some grabby monsters like the taste of you, which is your problem and the GM's punchline.

> **System:** "Grulke. You are not a frog. Your preference has been noted. The word 'frog' will be used in every announcement anyway."

JAPANESE (HOBGOBLIN)

Somewhere in your family tree a goblin got a troll drunk, or the other way round, and the result is you: big, clever, ugly enough to stop traffic, and exceptional at traps, bombs and mayhem. People say you have a face for radio. Then they ask you to disarm that thing. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	**Explosives Handling at rank 5** (Chapter 5). The GM may waive it for a Crawler whose build is clearly sapper-shaped.

Traits.

- **Trapsmith.** Proficiency with Thieves' Tools, and Advantage on Intelligence (Investigation) checks to find traps and on checks to disarm them.
- **Sapper's Edge.** Once per turn, when you deal damage with an explosive or trap you built, or a thrown alchemical item you built (Chapter 6), add your PB to the damage.
- **Keen Ears.** Advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing.
- **Sapper Workshop Access (from Floor 4).** You may use a System **Sapper's workshop in any saferoom for free**, without owning a crafting table or using Personal Space. (A false saferoom is not a saferoom, and has no workshop.) The workshop always works as a **level 1 Sapper's Table**; to work at a higher level, buy or find

a Sapper's Table like anyone else. It opens **no earlier than Floor 4**, even though you became a Hobgoblin on Floor 3, because no crafting table works before then. The **Demolitions Workshop** menu still needs Explosives Handling 5, so a waived gate doesn't unlock it. The access is **personal and is not a table**: you can't trade, stash or lend it, and it doesn't count as one of the party's crafting tables.

Skill family. Traps and explosives are your species' own skill family: System skills in that family can climb to rank 20 instead of 15 (Chapter 5).

Level 3: Troll's Knit. At the start of your turn in combat, if you're below half your maximum hit points and above 0, you regain 1 hit point. It stops for a turn if you took fire or acid damage since your last turn.

Level 5. Troll's Knit restores 2 hit points. Sapper's Edge also adds 1 to the save DC of crafted explosives you deploy.

Drawback: Face for Radio. You have Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks against a creature the first time you try to persuade it. Intimidation and Deception are unaffected.

> **System:** "Hobgoblin. The audience adores you from a safe distance, which is also the distance you prefer."

MEXICAN (LAJABLESS)

Twice a day your body changes its mind. By day you're radiant, a spellcaster's dream, and weak as tea. By night you're a skull-faced horror with terrible strength and worse manners. Your right leg ends in a goat hoof either way. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	Best suited to spellcasters with a low Strength. Anyone can take it; the card warns you plainly if that isn't you.

Phases. Every 12 hours you switch between your **Trinidadian (Radiant Phase)** and your **Saint Lucian (Skull Phase)**. The System rings a Dawn bell and a Dusk bell; in a windowless saferoom it uses its own clock. You start in the Radiant Phase.

Traits (both phases).

- **Dark Eyes.** Darkvision 60 feet.
- **Sure-Footed.** Advantage on saving throws against being knocked Prone.

Radiant Phase.

- **Arcane Thrift.** Once per Short or Long Rest, when you cast a spell with a level 1 or level 2 spell slot, you don't expend the slot.
- **Silver Tongue.** Advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) and Charisma (Performance) checks.
- **Frail.** Disadvantage on Strength checks, and your carrying capacity is halved.

Skull Phase.

- **Boneweight.** Advantage on Strength checks and Strength saving throws. Once per turn, when you hit with a melee weapon or natural weapon using Strength, add your PB to the damage.

- **Dread Visage.** Advantage on Charisma (Intimidation) checks and Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks. You can't use Arcane Thrift.

Level 3: Swap Faces. Once per Long Rest, as a Bonus Action, switch phase now. The 12-hour schedule continues from the new phase.

Level 5: Eclipse. Once per Long Rest, as a Bonus Action, the benefits and the drawbacks of both phases apply to you for 1 minute. Advantage and Disadvantage on the same roll cancel as usual.

Drawback. The phase drawbacks, and the fact that every village has a story about you that ends badly for somebody.

> **System:** "Lajabless. Radiant by day, nightmare by night. We recommend working nights if you want to be taken seriously."

INDIAN (NAGA)

A hood, a hiss and a reputation. You don't mind being feared. You do mind being asked whether you're cold. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	none

Traits.

- **Serpent's Blood.** Resistance to poison damage.
- **Fangs.** Natural weapon, 1d4 piercing.
- **Venom.** PB times per Long Rest, when you hit with your Fangs, you can add 1d6 poison damage and force a Constitution saving throw (Species DC, Constitution). On a failure, the target is Poisoned until the end of your next turn.

Level 3: Hood Display. Once per Short or Long Rest, as a Bonus Action, each creature you choose within 10 feet that can see you makes a Wisdom saving throw (Species DC, Constitution). On a failure, it has Disadvantage on attack rolls against you until the end of your next turn. This isn't a Frightened effect.

Level 5. Venom deals 2d6.

Drawback: Cold-Blooded. Disadvantage on Constitution saving throws against cold damage and extreme cold. In freezing conditions your Speed is 20 feet until you warm up for 10 minutes.

> **System:** "Naga. A tasteful hood and a poor tolerance for winter. We'll be broadcasting the first cold snap."

ARGENTINE (NODLING)

Two heads, one body and a permanent argument about dinner. You're always right, just never the same head at the same time. Strangers address the wrong one, then apologize to both. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	none	none

Head counts (cosmetic): Austrian (Two-Headed Nodling), Dutch (Three-Headed Nodling), Kenyan (Four-Headed Nodling), Colombian (Five-Headed Nodling) and Portuguese (Six-Headed Nodling). Extra heads add opinions, not rules. The traits below say "heads" and mean all of them.

Traits.

- **Two Minds.** Advantage on Constitution saving throws to maintain Concentration. One head holds the spell.
- **Second Opinion.** Advantage on saving throws against being Charmed or Frightened.
- **Watch Head.** During a Long Rest one head stays awake. Being asleep doesn't give you Disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks, and you can be woken without losing the rest.
- **Double Take.** PB times per Long Rest, when you make an Intelligence, Wisdom or Charisma check or saving throw, add 1d4 to the roll. Decide after you see the roll, before the result.

Level 3: Argue Both Sides. Once per Long Rest, when you fail an Intelligence, Wisdom or Charisma saving throw, you can reroll it, and you must use the new roll.

Level 5. Double Take uses a d6.

Drawbacks. Mixed Messages: Disadvantage on Charisma (Deception) checks whenever your heads disagree about the lie, which is usually. **Headgear:** only one head can wear a hat, helm or circlet, so an item worn on the head benefits one head. Extra hats cost credits.

> **System:** "Nodling. Two heads, no clue. Please let the left one finish."

TANZANIAN (PRIMAL)

The original model. You keep your face, your hands and your bad posture, and underneath, the System quietly fixes the factory defects. The audience calls it boring. The audience isn't the one getting hit. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	35 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	none

Traits.

- **Same Face.** You look exactly as you did on Floors 1 and 2, and your tells fade. You pass as Human to anyone who doesn't read your System card. No other effect.
- **Primal Senses.** Darkvision 60 feet, and proficiency in Perception or Survival (your choice).
- **Primal Stride.** Your Speed is 35 feet.
- **Primal Vigor.** Once per Short Rest, when you spend Hit Point Dice, you regain extra hit points equal to your PB. You also have Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Poisoned condition.

Level 3: Primal Rebound. Once per Long Rest, when you fail a Strength, Dexterity or Constitution saving throw, you can reroll it, and you must use the new roll.

Level 5: Blank Slate. Choose one skill you're proficient in. You gain **Expertise** in it. That skill also counts as your species' own skill family: System skills tied to it can train to **rank 20** instead of 15 (Chapter 5).

Drawback: Plain Wrapper. No signature power, no flashy body. The chyron is unimpressed and sponsors look at someone else first. There's no mechanical drawback, which is why the traits are modest.

Tanzanian (Primal) or Canadian (Human)? Canadian (Human) is feats and luck. Tanzanian (Primal) is body and instinct: senses, speed, saves and recovery. A Canadian (Human) who becomes Tanzanian (Primal) loses Resourceful, Skillful and Versatile, as with any oddity.

> **System:** "Primal. You paid nothing, changed nothing, and somehow got an upgrade. Viewers are filing complaints. We are framing them."

MONGOLIAN (RAPTORKIN)

Somewhere in the System's paperwork you were filed as a small, toothy mob, and somebody stamped the wrong form. You're quick, sharp and loyal, in a way that's easy to mock and hard to dismiss. HOUSE

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Small	35 ft	Darkvision 60 ft	none

Traits.

- **Bite.** Natural weapon, 1d6 piercing.
- **Pack Hunter.** Once per turn, when you hit with your Bite and an ally is within 5 feet of the target, add 1d4 damage.
- **Good Nose.** Proficiency in Survival, and Advantage on Survival checks to track by scent.
- **Puppy Eyes.** Once per Long Rest, you can give yourself Advantage on one Charisma (Persuasion) check against a creature that isn't hostile to you.

Level 3: Hunter's Rush. Once per Short or Long Rest, you can take the Dash action as a Bonus Action.

Level 5. Your Speed becomes 40 feet, and Pack Hunter deals 1d6.

Drawbacks. Collared: many NPCs assume you belong to someone. You have Disadvantage on Charisma checks the first time you deal with a creature that notices your paperwork (the GM may waive it for creatures that know you). **Small body:** Heavy weapons.

> **System:** "Raptorkin. A good Crawler. A very good Crawler. We've notified your owner, who doesn't exist."

AMERICAN (SASQUATCH)

Eight feet of hair, shoulders and bad press. Earth spent decades trying to get a clear photo of you. Now you're on every camera in the Dungeon and somehow still blurry. You carry the party's stuff, and you knock over the saferoom lamp every single time. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Large	35 ft	none	**Strength 15 or higher and proficiency in Athletics** at the Offer, or a GM waiver for a Crawler who has clearly spent Floors 1 and 2 smashing things.

Traits.

- **Big.** You're Large and use the Large Crawler rules above: more carrying, Grapple and Shove up to Huge, saferoom doors that fit you, Dungeon doors that may not.
- **Smush.** Natural weapon (fists and stomps), 1d8 bludgeoning.
- **Thick Fur.** Resistance to cold damage.
- **Keen Nose.** Advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Level 3: Bash Through. Once per Short or Long Rest, when you move at least 10 feet in a straight line, you can move through the space of one Medium or smaller creature during that move. It makes a Strength saving throw (Species DC, Strength) or has the Prone condition. You can't end your move in its space.

Level 5. Smush deals 1d10, and you have Advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks.

Drawback: Cryptid. The squeezing rules bite in tight places, you have Disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks except in forest or thick brush, and everybody wants a photo.

> **System:** "Sasquatch. After decades of blurry photos, Earth's most famous no-show has finally arrived. Please stop standing so close to the camera."

ALBANIAN (SKYFOWL)

Eagle-headed, proud to a fault, and very hard to look down on. You can leap off a barn and live. You can also insult a host four different ways in one sentence. INSPIRED

SIZE	SPEED	SENSES	GATE
Medium	30 ft	none (see Keen Eyes)	none

Traits.

- **Keen Eyes.** Proficiency in Perception, and Advantage on Perception checks that rely on sight.
- **Eagle Eye.** Long range doesn't give you Disadvantage on ranged attack rolls.
- **Talons.** Natural weapon, 1d6 slashing.
- **Updraft.** Your jump distances are 10 feet longer.
- **Proud Stock.** Advantage on Charisma (Intimidation) and Charisma (Persuasion) checks against Skyfowl, and against folk who treat Skyfowl as their betters (the GM decides who).

Level 3: Glide. When you fall, you can use your Reaction to take no falling damage and move up to 30 feet horizontally during each round of the fall. You can't glide in Medium or Heavy armor or while carrying too much.

Level 5: Flight. Once per Long Rest, as a Bonus Action, you gain a Fly Speed equal to your Speed for 10 minutes. Not in Medium or Heavy armor.

Drawbacks. Proud to a Fault: Skyfowl have a reputation. You have Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks the first time you deal with a non-Skyfowl who knows it. **Wing Gear:** Glide and Flight don't work in Medium or Heavy armor.

> **System:** "Skyfowl. Eagle-headed, high-minded and still in the doghouse. Please try not to insult the host in four languages."

REPLACEMENT CRAWLERS

A Crawler who joins **after the Floor 3 Offer** never sees the Identity Market. Instead, they pick **any Offer option at creation**: HOUSE

- **Species:** any of the nine starting species, **Human with Unbroken Original** (including its extra Origin feat), or **any oddity** in this chapter. Gates still apply, and the GM may waive them as usual.
- **Background:** as normal, from Chapter 2.
- **Class:** keep the plain class, or take either class option for that class (the locked list above).

No Offer runs for them later; they made their choice at the kiosk. The same applies to a **benched Crawler who missed the Floor 3 Offer**: they pick any Offer option the first time they become active after Floor 3. A replacement still arrives at the party's lowest level with the usual late-entry gear and Silver loot box (Chapter 1). A Crawler who is **revived** keeps their species; revival is not a rebuild.

```
[SYSTEM]
Welcome, late arrival. Everyone else had to earn their weird. You get to order yours off
the menu. The others will be bitter about it, and the System will be broadcasting that.
```

SPECIES CHECKLIST

At level 1 (Chapter 2)

- [ ] Species chosen from the nine, with its lineage or ancestry if it has one.
- [ ] Sub-choices made (an Elf's Keen Senses skill, a Human's Skillful skill and Versatile feat).
- [ ] Look written as human; species features left out or worn as a costume.

At the Floor 3 Offer

- [ ] Level 3 applied; subclass picked now or after the Offer.
- [ ] Offer Card read; questions asked; gains, losses, costs and warnings checked.
- [ ] Species: A (keep), B or C. Human keeping Human: extra Origin feat chosen.
- [ ] Background: keep, or redo (increases, skills, tool, Origin feat).
- [ ] Class: keep, or a class option.
- [ ] Sheet updated: size, speed, senses, traits, hit points, Armor Class, saves, skill bonuses; gear re-equipped.
- [ ] Transformation done. Result announced. No take-backs.

CHAPTER FOUR

CLASSES AND BACKGROUNDS

> *Your Provisional Class is a talent that fell out of you. Your Prior Employment is what you were paid to be. Neither is a personality. Please acquire one.*
>
> THE SYSTEM

This chapter is the deep dive behind Chapter 2's intake screens. Chapter 2 gets a Crawler legal at level 1. Here you get the twelve **Provisional Classes** with play notes for Season Zero, the Fighting Styles Fighters pick now (and Paladins and Rangers pick at level 2), the four **SRD Prior Employments** printed in full, and an appendix of non-SRD reskin names your GM may open later.

Display names always read **Our Name (5e Name)**. Rules key on the parenthesized 5e name. Flavor and System lines stay short (a few sentences). Everything mechanical that is not summarized here lives in the **SRD 5.2**. Where this book and the SRD conflict on the floor, this book wins for Crawl overlays (rests, credits, clocks, boxes).

WHAT THIS CHAPTER IS NOT

No pet rules. No Story Box deed lists. No survey questions and no Fan Profile fields. Those stay out of the printed player book on purpose.

HOW CLASSES WORK IN THE CRAWL

- **Provisional Class** at level 1 means the full SRD class features for that level. Nothing is delayed except the story paint.
- **Official Class Title** arrives on Floor 3 with your subclass. The Title is flavor. The subclass is rules.
- **Milestone leveling:** on the standard track a Crawler arrives at level **N** on Floors **1–3**, **N+1** on Floors **4–9**, and **N+2** on Floors **10–18**. Floor 3 and Floor 9 end bosses each grant an extra level before Floor Onboarding. Floor 1 grants **Midterm Onboarding** (level 2 at the Green Room) before the boss; you arrive on Floor 2 already at level 2. Later floors use **Floor Onboarding** at the first saferoom after descent. Full arrival table in Chapter 1.
- **Multiclassing** follows 5e, including ability score prerequisites. The System will mock the paperwork and still enforce it.
- **Spell lists** are SRD. Spell names stay plain; only kiosk headings get reskins.
- **Death and replacement.** A dead Crawler's player usually brings a replacement at the next saferoom (Chapter 1). The new sheet uses this chapter the same way Chapter 2 does, plus late-entry gear and one **Silver loot box**.

THE TWELVE AT A GLANCE

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	HIT DIE	SAVES	ARMOR	SKILLS	LEVEL 1 HOOK
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	d12	STR/CON	light, medium, shield; Unarmored Defense	2	Rage; Unarmored Defense; Mastery 2
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	d8	DEX/CHA	light	3	Inspiration; Spellcasting
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	d8	WIS/CHA	light, medium, shield	2	Spellcasting; Divine Order
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	d8	INT/WIS	light, shield	2	Spellcasting; Druidic; Primal Order
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	d10	STR/CON	light, medium, heavy, shield	2	Fighting Style; Second Wind; Mastery 3
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	d8	STR/DEX	Unarmored Defense	2	Martial Arts; Unarmored Defense
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	d10	WIS/CHA	light, medium, heavy, shield	2	Lay on Hands; Spellcasting; Mastery 2
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	d10	STR/DEX	light, medium, shield	3	Hunter's Mark; Spellcasting; Mastery 2
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	d8	DEX/INT	light	4	Expertise; Sneak Attack; Cant; Mastery 2
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	d6	CON/CHA	none	2	Spellcasting; Innate Sorcery
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	d8	WIS/CHA	light	2	Pact Magic; 1 Invocation
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	d6	INT/WIS	none	2	Spellbook; Rituals; Arcane Recovery

Weapon and tool proficiencies: SRD 5.2. Tables: chargen-5e.json v0.1.6, species-class-reskins v0.1.5.

FIGHTING STYLES

Fighters pick a Fighting Style at **level 1**. **Paladins and Rangers pick at level 2**, not during intake. Each style is a feat in 2024 terms; take the SRD benefit as written. Names below are kiosk labels.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	BENEFIT (SUMMARY)
Carnival-Booth Sharpshooter (Archery)	+2 to attack rolls with ranged weapons.
Power-Outage Brawler (Blind Fighting)	Blindsight 10 feet while conscious (as SRD).
Bubble-Wrap Enthusiast (Defense)	+1 Armor Class while wearing armor.
Single-Hand Swagger (Dueling)	+2 damage with a single one-handed melee weapon and a free other hand.
Two-Handed Overcompensation (Great Weapon Fighting)	Reroll 1s and 2s on damage dice for two-handed melee weapons.
Human Airbag Reflex (Interception)	Reaction: reduce damage to a nearby ally when they are hit (as SRD).
Crowd-Control Shield Shove (Protection)	Reaction with a shield: impose Disadvantage on an attack against a nearby ally.
Dart-League Menace (Thrown Weapon Fighting)	Draw thrown weapons as part of the attack; +2 damage on thrown weapon attacks.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	BENEFIT (SUMMARY)
Double-Fisting Menace (Two-Weapon Fighting)	Add your ability modifier to the extra attack's damage when you Two-Weapon Fight.
Bar-Fight Haymaker (Unarmed Fighting)	Stronger unarmed strikes; special grapple options as SRD.

HOUSE OPTION • ABILITY SCORES CROSS-REFERENCE

Ability scores still use Factory Preset, Layaway Plan, or Dice Gamble (Roll). Roll is HOUSE: keep an array only if it totals **73 or more**. Full procedure in Chapter 2.

READING A CLASS ENTRY

Each class section below uses the same shape:

1. **Kiosk flavor** (short).
2. **Chassis** — Hit Die, abilities, saves, armor, skills.
3. **Level 1 features** — what intake gives you.
4. **Level 2 preview** — what Midterm Onboarding usually adds.
5. **In the party / On Floor 1 / Rests / Build / Do not** — Season Zero play notes.
6. **System toast** — one jab.

Feature text is a summary for table use. When precision matters, open the SRD entry.

ANGER-MANAGEMENT DROPOUT (BARBARIAN)

Failed the course, kept the certificate, and now charges by the hour for the same thing.

Hit Die: d12. **Saving throws:** STR/CON. **Armor training:** light, medium, shield. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Rage.** Bonus Action to enter Rage. While raging you gain the SRD Rage benefits (damage resistance, bonus damage, and the usual restrictions). **2 uses** at level 1; recharged on a Long Rest.
- **Unarmored Defense.** Without armor, AC = **10 + Dexterity modifier + Constitution modifier**. A shield is allowed.
- **Weapon Mastery.** Choose **2** weapons; you can use their Mastery properties.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Reckless Attack and **Danger Sense**. You swing with Advantage and take the consequences; you also gain Advantage on Dexterity saves against effects you can see.

IN THE PARTY

You are the front door and the fire alarm. Take hits, open Rage when the camera is rolling, and drag downed friends to a saferoom. You are not the planner; you are why the plan survives contact.

ON FLOOR 1

Midterm Onboarding (level 2 at the Green Room) is your first big power spike — Reckless Attack and Danger Sense land before the Floor 1 boss. Do not spend both Rage uses on rats. Save one for the stairwell fight.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Rage recharges on a Long Rest at early levels. Long Rests only count in a saferoom. A field rest fee on Floor 1 (20 credits per Crawler, cap 60) never grants the rest; it only bills you and then interrupts you.

BUILD NOTES

Strength and Constitution first. Unarmored Defense if you refuse a shirt; medium armor if you want fewer jokes about your torso. Weapon Mastery on a greataxe or greatsword plus a thrown handaxe covers most Floor 1 rooms.

DO NOT

Do not dump Constitution. Do not Rage every fight. Do not stand in a collapsing zone arguing about honor — collapse death is death on every floor, Reprieve or not.

```
[SYSTEM]
Rage logged. Property damage logged. Empathy: not found.
```

OPEN-MIC MENACE (BARD)

Unlicensed entertainer with a Bluetooth speaker and four fans. Two of them are family.

Hit Die: d8. **Saving throws:** DEX/CHA. **Armor training:** light. **Skill picks:** 3 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Bardic Inspiration.** Bonus Action; grant an ally a **d6** Inspiration die. Uses = Charisma modifier (minimum 1). Long Rest recharge at level 1.
- **Spellcasting (Charisma).** **2** cantrips; **4** prepared level 1 spells; **2** level 1 slots. Ritual casting as SRD.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Expertise (2 skills) and a bigger Inspiration budget. Your jokes get proficiency.

IN THE PARTY

You are control, support, and the reason the audience stays. Bardic Inspiration is a resource; spend it on the swing that matters, not on the swing that looks cool.

ON FLOOR 1

Your spell list is your toolbox: healing words, locks of sleep, and one insult that deals damage. Midterm Onboarding adds Expertise and more Inspiration — perfect timing for the boss.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Inspiration and slots want Long Rests. Short Rests help teammates more than you at level 1. Sit in the saferoom; open boxes there; do not try emergency opens in a hallway.

BUILD NOTES

Charisma first, then Dexterity for armor and initiative. Take light armor. Skills: pick three that cover talking, noticing, and one sneaky option. Cantrips should include a damage option and a utility option.

DO NOT

Do not treat Inspiration like confetti. Do not ask the System for a loot guitar — Fan Profiles are hidden and requests are Customer Feedback, not orders.

```
[SYSTEM]
Bluetooth speaker detected. Licensing: none. Fans: four. Two are family.
```

URGENT-CARE CHAPLAIN (CLERIC)

Somebody up there signed for you. Pastoral care, triage, and a surprisingly effective hand-sanitizer miracle.

Hit Die: d8. **Saving throws:** WIS/CHA. **Armor training:** light, medium, shield. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Spellcasting (Wisdom). 3** cantrips; **4** prepared level 1 spells; **2** level 1 slots.
- **Divine Order.** Choose once:
- **Hallway Bodyguard (Protector):** martial weapons and heavy armor.
- **Church Rummage-Sale Mystic (Thaumaturge):** extra cantrip; add Wisdom modifier to spell attack bonus and save DC while presenting a holy symbol as a focus (as SRD).

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Channel Divinity and Channel options. Turn the undead; empower a damage cantrip; look very certified.

IN THE PARTY

You are triage with a holy symbol. Keep people standing, turn the worst undead jokes into actual turning later, and decide who gets the last Cure Wounds.

ON FLOOR 1

Divine Order is a permanent fork: Protector for armor and martial weapons, Thaumaturge for extra cantrip punch. Midterm Onboarding brings Channel Divinity before the boss — plan to be alive for it.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Slots and Channel Divinity key off Long Rests. Saferoom Long Rests are the only ones that count. If the Break Room loses service on Floor 1 Day 4, the Green Room is your last honest bed.

BUILD NOTES

Wisdom first, then Constitution. Protectors can lean Strength; Thaumaturges can lean more Wisdom. Prepare a heal, a buff, and a damage spell every day.

DO NOT

Do not hoard every slot for a boss that might not come. Do not refuse to heal because someone "deserved it" — the audience grades cruelty differently than you think.

```
[SYSTEM]
Pastoral care ticket opened. Estimated wait: forever. Please hold.
```

COMMUNITY-GARDEN ZEALOT (DRUID)

Smells like a compost bin with ambition. Has a plot, a hose, and opinions about your lawn.

Hit Die: d8. **Saving throws:** INT/WIS. **Armor training:** light, shield. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Spellcasting (Wisdom). 2** cantrips; **4** prepared level 1 spells; **2** level 1 slots.
- **Druidic.** Secret language. System file: "conspiring with plants."
- **Primal Order.** Choose once:
- **Farmers-Market Hedge Magician (Magician):** extra cantrip; focus-based casting bonus as SRD.
- **Trail-Crew Warden (Warden):** martial weapons and medium armor.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Wild Shape and Wild Shape options. You become a beast; the audience rates the costume.

IN THE PARTY

You control space and patch holes. Entangle, Faerie Fire, and Goodberry do more for Floor 1 survival than another damage cantrip.

ON FLOOR 1

Primal Order forks Magician vs Warden the same way Cleric forks. Wild Shape is level 2 — Midterm Onboarding is when you become a problem with teeth.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Slots refresh on Long Rests. Herbalism and crafting (later chapters) want saferoom time. Field rest fees do not grow berries.

BUILD NOTES

Wisdom first. Warden can wear medium armor; Magician leans harder into spells. Keep a melee backup (shillelagh or a shield) for when slots are gone.

DO NOT

Do not wear metal armor if your table enforces the SRD restriction. Do not Wild Shape into something that cannot climb the route you need.

```
[SYSTEM]
Conspiracy with plants: confirmed. Hose pressure: excessive.
```

OFF-DUTY BOUNCER (FIGHTER)

Fell into it, kept falling. Checks IDs, breaks up fights, and holds a grudge about the cover charge.

Hit Die: d10. **Saving throws:** STR/CON. **Armor training:** light, medium, heavy, shield. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Fighting Style.** Pick one from the table above. This is a level 1 Fighter feature; Paladins and Rangers wait until level 2.
- **Second Wind.** Bonus Action: regain **1d10 + Fighter level** hit points. **2 uses**; recovery as SRD (Short Rest / Long Rest split).
- **Weapon Mastery.** Choose **3** weapons.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Action Surge (extra action, Short Rest recharge) and a Fighting Style bump if your table uses the 2024 progression. The Green Room exists so you have this for the boss.

IN THE PARTY

You are reliable damage and a movable wall. Second Wind is your panic button; Fighting Style is your identity.

ON FLOOR 1

You already have your Fighting Style at level 1. Midterm Onboarding adds Action Surge right before the boss. That is not subtle. That is the point.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Second Wind partially returns on Short Rests; Action Surge wants Short Rests too once you have it. Saferoom Short Rests are uninterrupted. Use them.

BUILD NOTES

Strength or Dexterity first, Constitution second. Defense style plus heavy armor is the boring good choice. Archery or Dueling if you want a concept. Mastery on three weapons you will actually carry.

DO NOT

Do not Action Surge a trash fight. Do not leave the Green Room before Midterm Onboarding if the party can help it.

```
[SYSTEM]
Cover charge unpaid. Bouncer status: provisional. Please step aside.
```

BAREFOOT HOT-YOGA BRAWLER (MONK)

Barefoot by choice. Teaches breathing, punches stress, and makes a living off Namaste and a credits-only mat.

Hit Die: d8. **Saving throws:** STR/DEX. **Armor training:** none. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Martial Arts.** Unarmored and unarmed (or monk weapons): Dexterity for attack and damage; unarmed die **1d6** at level 1; Bonus Action unarmed strike after the Attack action (as SRD).
- **Unarmored Defense.** AC = **10 + Dexterity modifier + Wisdom modifier** while unarmored and not using a shield.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Monk's Focus (Focus points), **Unarmored Movement**, and **Uncanny Metabolism**. Patient Defense, Step of the Wind, and Flurry become available as SRD.

IN THE PARTY

You are mobile damage and a sticky controller. You win by not being where the enemy swung.

ON FLOOR 1

Martial Arts and Unarmored Defense are your whole kit until Midterm Onboarding adds Focus points. Play careful until then.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Focus points (from level 2) want Short Rests. Long Rests still need a saferoom. Do not pay a field rest fee expecting Focus back — you will get neither rest nor dignity.

BUILD NOTES

Dexterity and Wisdom. Dump Strength only if you accept the joke. Carry a simple weapon that counts as a monk weapon for Mastery tricks if your table uses them.

DO NOT

Do not stand still. Do not wear armor "just in case" and lose Unarmored Defense. Do not forget death saves are public.

```
[SYSTEM]
Mat not found. Namaste billed anyway. Credits-only.
```

HOA ENFORCEMENT CRUSADER (PALADIN)

Took an oath. Probably to the bylaws. Clipboard, shining armor, and a fine schedule for unauthorized mailboxes.

Hit Die: d10. **Saving throws:** WIS/CHA. **Armor training:** light, medium, heavy, shield. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Lay on Hands.** Pool of **5 × Paladin level** hit points. Action to heal by touch, or spend 5 to clear one poison or disease (as SRD).
- **Spellcasting (Charisma).** No cantrips. **2** prepared level 1 spells; **2** level 1 slots.
- **Weapon Mastery.** Choose **2** weapons.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Fighting Style (finally), **Divine Smite**, and Paladin spell growth. Midterm Onboarding is when the vest starts glowing on purpose.

IN THE PARTY

You are a durable frontliner who can patch allies and smite problems. Lay on Hands is a pool — spend it like rent money, not like a tip jar.

ON FLOOR 1

No Fighting Style at level 1; you get it at level 2 with Divine Smite after Midterm Onboarding. Survive to the Green Room.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Slots and Lay on Hands want Long Rests. Smite wants slots. Saferoom culture will save your oath.

BUILD NOTES

Strength and Charisma. Heavy armor. Prepare a smite spell and a utility spell. Weapon Mastery on a longsword and a javelin covers indoors and hallways.

DO NOT

Do not empty Lay on Hands on scrapes. Do not lecture the party mid-collapse — reach the stairwell.

```
[SYSTEM]
Bylaw violation recorded. Fine schedule pending. Aura: judgmental.
```

SEASONAL PARK RANGER (RANGER)

Knows which way is north. Has been told it is a rare skill. Drives a truck with a bad radio.

Hit Die: d10. **Saving throws:** STR/DEX. **Armor training:** light, medium, shield. **Skill picks:** 3 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Spellcasting (Wisdom).** No cantrips. **2** prepared level 1 spells; **2** level 1 slots.
- **Favored Enemy.** *Hunter's Mark* is always prepared and does not count against your prepared number.
- **Weapon Mastery.** Choose **2** weapons.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Fighting Style at level 2 (not at intake) and **Deft Explorer**. You become the person who finds the stairwell while everyone else argues.

IN THE PARTY

You are scout, striker, and the person who finds the route. Hunter's Mark is free prep for you — use it.

ON FLOOR 1

Fighting Style arrives at level 2, not intake. Midterm Onboarding is your style + exploration bump. Mark the boss; do not mark every rat.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Slots on Long Rest. Exploration features want you alive more than rested. Still: saferoom Long Rests only.

BUILD NOTES

Dexterity and Wisdom. Archery or Two-Weapon Fighting at level 2. Skills: Perception plus two that match your joke (Survival, Stealth, Insight).

DO NOT

Do not split from the party without a plan to rejoin before collapse. Early descent into stasis is survival, not cowardice, if the clock is cruel.

```
[SYSTEM]
North: that way. Radio: still broken. Pathfinding invoice: sent.
```

FIVE-FINGER DISCOUNT SPECIALIST (ROGUE)

Your record says 'opportunist.' Your references say 'talented.' The mall says 'please leave.'

Hit Die: d8. **Saving throws:** DEX/INT. **Armor training:** light. **Skill picks:** 4 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Expertise.** Choose **2** skills you are proficient in; double the proficiency bonus for them.
- **Sneak Attack.** Once per turn, on a finesse or ranged hit with Advantage (or an eligible ally within 5 feet), deal **+1d6** damage.
- **Thieves' Cant.** Coded cant. System file: "conspiracy, petty."
- **Weapon Mastery.** Choose **2** weapons.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Cunning Action (Dash, Disengage, or Hide as a Bonus Action). The cameras hate you and the Ratings love you.

IN THE PARTY

You are precision damage and locked doors. Sneak Attack once per turn — set it up every turn.

ON FLOOR 1

Expertise and Sneak Attack are enough to matter immediately. Cunning Action at Midterm Onboarding makes you slippery before the boss.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

You need fewer Long Rest resources than casters, but hit points still want saferooms. Short Rests help everyone you just dragged out of a fight.

BUILD NOTES

Dexterity first. Expertise on Stealth and Thieves' Tools or Perception. Finesse weapon Mastery plus a shortbow. Light armor.

DO NOT

Do not Sneak Attack the camera. Do not die alone in a side hallway with unopened boxes — they vanish with you.

```
[SYSTEM]
Opportunist tag applied. Mall ban: interdimensional. References: glowing.
```

LEAKY POWER-BANK (SORCERER)

Over-charged at birth and leaking sparks into everything. Do not plug into the wall.

Hit Die: d6. **Saving throws:** CON/CHA. **Armor training:** none. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Spellcasting (Charisma).** **4** cantrips; **2** prepared level 1 spells; **2** level 1 slots.
- **Innate Sorcery.** Bonus Action; for the duration your spell attacks have Advantage and targets have Disadvantage on saves against your spells (as SRD). **2 uses** per Long Rest at level 1.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

Font of Magic and Metamagic access as SRD. You get a dial, not just a switch.

IN THE PARTY

You are burst magic. Innate Sorcery is a rare Advantage window — open it for the fight that is on the poster.

ON FLOOR 1

Four cantrips do a lot of Floor 1 work. Midterm Onboarding adds Font of Magic; suddenly you have a dial, not just a switch.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Everything you care about wants a Long Rest. Pay the saferoom tax in time, not the field fee in credits.

BUILD NOTES

Charisma and Constitution. Mage Armor or a borrowed shieldbearer friend. Damage cantrip + control spell + one panic button (Shield, if available to you).

DO NOT

Do not Innate Sorcery a single goblin. Do not stand in melee because “the vibe.”

```
[SYSTEM]
Overcharge warning. Wall outlet: do not. OSHA: crying.
```

UNREAD TERMS-AND-CONDITIONS SIGNER (WARLOCK)

Clicked ‘I agree’ without reading. Your patron read it. Your patron has notes.

Hit Die: d8. **Saving throws:** WIS/CHA. **Armor training:** light. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Pact Magic (Charisma).** **2** cantrips; **2** prepared level 1 spells; **1** Pact Magic slot (level 1), recharged on a Short Rest.
- **Eldritch Invocations.** Choose **1** (Armor of Shadows, Eldritch Mind, Fiendish Vigor, Gaze of Two Minds, Lessons of the First Ones, Misty Visions, Pact of the Blade, Pact of the Chain, Pact of the Tome, Devil’s Sight, or Mask of Many Faces).

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

A second invocation and **Magical Cunning**. Your patron escalates the ticket.

IN THE PARTY

You are short-rest magic and a weird contract. Your one slot is a scalpel. Eldritch Blast (if you took it) is the day job.

ON FLOOR 1

One Pact slot and one invocation. Midterm Onboarding adds another invocation and Magical Cunning — your patron escalates the ticket.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Pact slots return on Short Rests. Saferoom Short Rests are invaluable. Long Rests still need a saferoom when you want hit points and the non-Pact world to make sense.

BUILD NOTES

Charisma. Light armor. Invocation: Armor of Shadows if naked; Devil's Sight if dark; Pact of the Blade if melee cosplay. Cantrips: Eldritch Blast unless you have a concept.

DO NOT

Do not spend your only slot on a joke. Do not ignore the collapse clock because you "feel fine after a Short Rest."

```
[SYSTEM]
Terms accepted. Terms unread. Patron notes: attached. Attachment size: hostile.
```

PERPETUAL GRAD STUDENT (WIZARD)

Reads. Gross. Seven years into a thesis nobody asked for, powered by bad coffee and unfunded curiosity.

Hit Die: d6. **Saving throws:** INT/WIS. **Armor training:** none. **Skill picks:** 2 from the class list (see Chapter 2).

LEVEL 1 FEATURES

- **Spellcasting (Intelligence). 3** cantrips. **Spellbook** with **6** level 1 spells; prepare **4**. **2** level 1 slots. Kiosk name for the book: *Cracked Phone App*.
- **Ritual Adept.** Cast ritual-tagged wizard spells as rituals from the book without preparing them.
- **Arcane Recovery.** Once per day on a Short Rest, recover spell slots whose combined level ≤ half your Wizard level (rounded up), no slot above level 5 (as SRD). At level 1: one level 1 slot.

LEVEL 2 PREVIEW

More prepared spells and scholarly features as SRD. Your thesis still is not funded.

IN THE PARTY

You are prepared answers. Your spellbook is the campaign's second brain. Rituals save slots; prepared lists win days.

ON FLOOR 1

Six spells in the book, four prepared, two slots. Midterm Onboarding deepens the toolkit. Arcane Recovery on a Short Rest stretches Floor 1.

RESTS AND RESOURCES

Slots on Long Rest; Arcane Recovery on Short Rest once per day. Saferoom both. Field fees buy you Ceiling Ticks, not slots.

BUILD NOTES

Intelligence and Constitution. Cantrips: damage, utility, control. Book: Shield, Detect Magic, a damage spell, a control spell, a ritual, a panic option.

DO NOT

Do not prepare only damage. Do not drop the spellbook. Do not try to cast an Upgrade Coupon.

```
[SYSTEM]
Thesis progress: 4%. Funding: 0%. Fire Bolt: employed.
```

CLASS OPTIONS AT LEVEL 1

CLERIC: DIVINE ORDER

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SUMMARY
Hallway Bodyguard (Protector)	Armor and martial weapons. Stands between the bleeding and the elevator.
Church Rummage-Sale Mystic (Thaumaturge)	Extra cantrip and sharper at religion. Reads a tarot deck with the price tags still on.

DRUID: PRIMAL ORDER

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SUMMARY
Farmers-Market Hedge Magician (Magician)	Extra cantrip and nature smarts. Sells heirloom tomatoes that are, technically, still cursed.
Trail-Crew Warden (Warden)	Medium armor, shield and martial weapons. Maintains the trail and slaps anyone who feeds the wildlife.

WARLOCK: ELDRITCH INVOCATIONS (PICK ONE AT LEVEL 1)

Invocations use SRD text. Kiosk names live in the create-screens table; rules key on the plain 5e invocation name. Pick one you can use at level 1 under SRD prerequisites.

WEAPON MASTERY COUNTS

CLASS	MASTERY WEAPONS AT LEVEL 1
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	2
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	3
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	2
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	2
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	2

Mastery property names stay plain. Chapter 6 lists weapons.

EXPERTISE TIMING

Rogues pick Expertise at **level 1**. Bards pick Expertise at **level 2** (Midterm Onboarding), not during intake.

PRIOR EMPLOYMENT (BACKGROUNDS)

Your background is the job you had before the world ended. It gives ability score increases among its three listed scores, a fixed **Origin feat**, two skills, a tool proficiency, and an equipment option.

This book prints the **four SRD 5.2 backgrounds** in full. Twelve more appear only in the appendix under **reskin names** (decision 029).

ABILITY SCORE INCREASES

After you assign base scores, apply one pattern among the background's three abilities:

- **Merit Raise and a Gift Card (+2 / +1)**
- **Everyone Gets a Participation Trophy (+1 / +1 / +1)**

No score above 20.

ORIGIN FEATS (SRD FOUR)

Printed in full enough to play; SRD wins on edge cases.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	BENEFIT (SUMMARY)
Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)	Add proficiency bonus to Initiative; you cannot be surprised while conscious; other creatures do not gain Advantage on attack rolls against you for being hidden from you (as SRD).
Group-Chat Prayer Warrior (Magic Initiate — Cleric)	Two Cleric cantrips and one level 1 Cleric spell; cast that level 1 spell once without a slot per Long Rest; further casts spend slots; spellcasting ability as SRD for this feat.
Houseplant Whisperer (Magic Initiate — Druid)	As above, using the Druid list.
Wikipedia Rabbit-Hole Scholar (Magic Initiate — Wizard)	As above, using the Wizard list.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	BENEFIT (SUMMARY)
Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)	Once per turn when you hit with a weapon, you may reroll the weapon's damage dice and use either total (as SRD).
Tech-Support Jack-of-All-Trades (Skilled)	Gain proficiency in any combination of three skills or tools (as SRD).

Human **Versatile** picks a second Origin feat from **these four feats only** (Magic Initiate counts as one feat with a list choice). Non-SRD Origin feats are appendix-only.

EQUIPMENT OPTIONS

- **Cardboard Carton From Your Desk (Package A):** the kit and leftover credits.
- **Severance Envelope, Unmarked (Package B): 50 credits**, no kit items.

Whole credits only. Buying rounds **up** per cart line; selling at half rounds **down** per line (Chapter 1; core §5.10). The Intake Vending Wall never sells magic items.

RESKIN THE REASON

You may rename the old job to fit your story. Keep the skills, tool, feat, and increases. A Sage can be a podcast researcher. A Soldier can be mall security. The System snarks at the job, not at you.

YOUTH-GROUP PIZZA WRANGLER (ACOLYTE)

Ran Wednesday-night youth group on two pizzas and divine patience. Found out heaven has no petty credits.

- **Ability raises among:** Intelligence, Wisdom, Charisma.
- **Origin feat:** Group-Chat Prayer Warrior (Magic Initiate — Cleric).
- **Skills:** Insight, Religion.
- **Tool:** Calligrapher's Supplies.
- **Package A:** Calligrapher's Supplies, a book, a holy symbol, 10 sheets of parchment, a robe, and **8 credits** leftover.
- **Package B: 50 credits** (Severance Envelope, Unmarked).

PLAYING THIS BACKGROUND

You know how to calm a room, read a ritual, and keep a group from melting down. On Floor 1 you are often the person who remembers to ask the System what a word means — that can earn a snark achievement and zero credits.

ON FLOOR 1

Prepare utility and healing. Midterm Onboarding does not change your background; it changes your class power. Your Broadcast Name on Floor 3 may sound like a youth-group nickname you cannot escape.

IN THE PARTY

You pair well with frontliners who forget they have hit points and with Warlocks who forget they have friends.

CALL-CENTER GIFT-CARD FRAUD SPECIALIST (CRIMINAL)

Talked 400 strangers into reading you their card numbers 'for verification'. Your headset is evidence now.

- **Ability raises among:** Dexterity, Constitution, Intelligence.
- **Origin feat:** Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert).
- **Skills:** Sleight of Hand, Stealth.
- **Tool:** Thieves' Tools.
- **Package A:** Two daggers, thieves' tools, a crowbar, two pouches, traveler's clothes, and **16 credits** leftover.
- **Package B: 50 credits**.

PLAYING THIS BACKGROUND

You notice cameras. The System *is* cameras. Alert helps you act first; Stealth helps you not be the highlight reel for the wrong reason.

ON FLOOR 1

Open locks, spot ambushes, and do not die in a side hallway with unopened boxes. Boxes are bound; death reclaims them.

IN THE PARTY

You set up Rogues and Rangers. You also set up disasters. Label your disasters.

ADJUNCT PROFESSOR ON FOUR CAMPUSES (SAGE)

Taught intro rhetoric at four colleges for the combined salary of one decent sandwich. Parking cost more than the pay.

- **Ability raises among:** Constitution, Intelligence, Wisdom.
- **Origin feat:** Wikipedia Rabbit-Hole Scholar (Magic Initiate — Wizard).
- **Skills:** Arcana, History.
- **Tool:** Calligrapher's Supplies.
- **Package A:** A quarterstaff, calligrapher's supplies, a book, 8 parchment sheets, a robe, and **8 credits** leftover.
- **Package B: 50 credits**.

PLAYING THIS BACKGROUND

You read plaques, contracts, and bad ideas. Magic Initiate gives you cantrips even if your class is martial — a Fighter with *Fire Bolt* is a Season Zero classic.

ON FLOOR 1

Identify problems before they identify you. Rituals and Detect Magic save lives and credits.

IN THE PARTY

You make Wizards redundant or terrifying. Either is entertainment.

BLACK-FRIDAY MALL SECURITY (SOLDIER)

Stood between a discount toaster and four hundred people. You lost the toaster but kept the vest.

- **Ability raises among:** Strength, Dexterity, Constitution.
- **Origin feat:** Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker).
- **Skills:** Athletics, Intimidation.
- **Tool:** One Gaming Set.
- **Package A:** A spear, a shortbow, arrows, a gaming set, a Healer's Kit, a quiver, traveler's clothes, and **14 credits** leftover.
- **Package B: 50 credits**.

PLAYING THIS BACKGROUND

Hold lines, bark orders, survive Midterm Onboarding. Savage Attacker rewards the hit that already mattered.

ON FLOOR 1

You are built for the Orientation Pit. Keep the Healer's Kit for the person who ignored Standing Orders.

IN THE PARTY

You glue parties that dump Charisma. Intimidation is a tool; cruelty about a player is not.

MULTICLASSING AND SUBCLASSES

Multiclassing uses the SRD prerequisites and rules. You gain the features of each class for the levels you hold. Spell slots combine as 5e says. The Crawl adds no multiclass tax and offers no forgiveness for a bad split.

Subclasses arrive at **level 3** for every class in this book, together with your **Official Class Title** and the Floor 3 Identity Market. Subclass text is SRD; Titles are flavor and ship with Continuum material. Until then, play the Provisional Class straight.

SEASON ZERO CAST

Season Zero's cast is **your** Crawlers. This book never inserts a pre-written hero from any novel. Pre-built intake concepts in Chapter 2 are blank templates, not NPCs with plot armor.

QUICK PICKS (IF YOU ARE STUCK)

IF YOU WANT…	TRY…
To hit things and not die	Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter) or HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)
To heal and boss people kindly	Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)
To be loud and hard to kill	Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)
To talk, buff, and scheme	Open-Mic Menace (Bard)
To open doors and vanish	Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)
To prepare answers	Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)
Short Rest magic	Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)
Burst caster fantasy	Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)
Scout and mark	Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)
Mobile unarmored striker	Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)
Terrain and summons-of-sorts later	Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)

Pair any class with any of the four SRD backgrounds. The sheet will be legal; the joke is on you.

APPENDIX: NON-SRD BACKGROUNDS AND ORIGIN FEATS

Per decision 029 these entries use **our reskin names only**, with short mechanics summaries in our own words. No parenthetical 5e name. No copied book text. Open them only if your table owns the source books; the sheet still stores the underlying key.

NON-SRD BACKGROUNDS

RESKIN NAME	MECHANICS SUMMARY (OUR WORDS)
Etsy Shop Founder, Three Sales	Ability raises among Str/Dex/Int; craft Origin feat; two skills and artisan's tools.
Pyramid-Scheme Boss Babe	Ability raises among Dex/Con/Cha; deception Origin feat; two skills and a forgery kit.
Wedding DJ With One Playlist	Ability raises among Str/Dex/Cha; performance Origin feat; two skills and a musical instrument.
Farm-to-Table Influencer	Ability raises among Str/Con/Wis; toughness Origin feat; two skills and a farming tool.
Hospital Parking-Garage Attendant	Ability raises among Str/Wis/Cha; alertness Origin feat; two skills and a gaming set.
Trailhead Guide With a Laminated Map	Ability raises among Dex/Con/Wis; initiate-style Origin feat; two skills and navigator-style tools.

RESKIN NAME	MECHANICS SUMMARY (OUR WORDS)
Doomsday Prepper, Collapse Postponed	Ability raises among Con/Wis/Cha; healer Origin feat; two skills and an herbalism kit.
Warehouse Operations Manager	Ability raises among Con/Int/Cha; lucky Origin feat; two skills and navigator's tools.
Trust-Fund Gallery Owner	Ability raises among Str/Int/Cha; skilled Origin feat; two skills and a gaming set.
Cruise-Ship Buffet Deckhand	Ability raises among Str/Dex/Wis; tavern-brawler Origin feat; two skills and navigator's tools.
Law-Firm Paralegal in Redline Hell	Ability raises among Dex/Int/Wis; skilled Origin feat; two skills and calligrapher's supplies.
Couch-Surfing Burrito Courier	Ability raises among Dex/Wis/Cha; lucky Origin feat; two skills and thieves' tools.

NON-SRD ORIGIN FEATS

RESKIN NAME	MECHANICS SUMMARY (OUR WORDS)
Hot-Glue Gunslinger	Faster, cheaper nonmagical crafting; artisan's tools and discounts.
Weekend CPR-Class Graduate	Bonus Action stabilize; heal when you Treat; kit uses refresh on a Short Rest.
Scratch-Ticket Gambler	Luck points to reroll your d20 or force an attacker reroll.
Karaoke Night Regular	Encourage allies after a rest; temporary Hit Points or Heroic Inspiration.
HOA-Meeting Brawler	Better unarmed strikes; easier grapples; once-per-turn extra unarmed/improvised damage.
Gym Bro Who Spots at Dawn	Extra hit points equal to twice your level (+2 HP each level).

LEVEL 1 FEATURE CHECKLIST BY CLASS

Use this when reviewing a sheet at S16. Every box should be true before Confirm.

ANGER-MANAGEMENT DROPOUT (BARBARIAN)

- [ ] Rage uses recorded (2)
- [ ] Unarmored Defense understood, or armor chosen instead
- [ ] Two Weapon Mastery picks named
- [ ] Two skills from the class list

OPEN-MIC MENACE (BARD)

- [ ] Bardic Inspiration die and uses recorded
- [ ] Two cantrips and four prepared level 1 spells listed
- [ ] Two level 1 slots noted
- [ ] Three skills (any)

URGENT-CARE CHAPLAIN (CLERIC)

- [ ] Divine Order chosen (Protector or Thaumaturge)
- [ ] Three cantrips; four prepared spells; two slots
- [ ] Two skills from the class list
- [ ] Holy symbol or focus on the kit

COMMUNITY-GARDEN ZEALOT (DRUID)

- [ ] Primal Order chosen (Magician or Warden)
- [ ] Two cantrips; four prepared spells; two slots
- [ ] Druidic noted
- [ ] Armor choice respects table metal rules

OFF-DUTY BOUNCER (FIGHTER)

- [ ] Fighting Style chosen
- [ ] Second Wind uses recorded (2)
- [ ] Three Weapon Mastery picks
- [ ] Two skills from the class list

BAREFOOT HOT-YOGA BRAWLER (MONK)

- [ ] Martial Arts die noted (1d6)
- [ ] Unarmored Defense formula on the sheet
- [ ] Two skills from the class list
- [ ] No armor if you want Unarmored Defense

HOA ENFORCEMENT CRUSADER (PALADIN)

- [ ] Lay on Hands pool = 5
- [ ] Two prepared spells; two slots (no cantrips)
- [ ] Two Weapon Mastery picks
- [ ] Fighting Style **not** taken yet (level 2)

SEASONAL PARK RANGER (RANGER)

- [ ] Hunter's Mark always prepared noted
- [ ] Two prepared spells; two slots
- [ ] Two Weapon Mastery picks
- [ ] Fighting Style **not** taken yet (level 2)
- [ ] Three skills from the class list

FIVE-FINGER DISCOUNT SPECIALIST (ROGUE)

- [ ] Expertise on two skills
- [ ] Sneak Attack 1d6 noted
- [ ] Thieves' Cant noted
- [ ] Two Weapon Mastery picks
- [ ] Four skills from the class list

LEAKY POWER-BANK (SORCERER)

- [ ] Four cantrips; two prepared spells; two slots
- [ ] Innate Sorcery uses recorded (2)
- [ ] Two skills from the class list

UNREAD TERMS-AND-CONDITIONS SIGNER (WARLOCK)

- [ ] One Pact Magic slot noted (Short Rest recharge)
- [ ] One Eldritch Invocation chosen
- [ ] Two cantrips; two prepared spells
- [ ] Two skills from the class list

PERPETUAL GRAD STUDENT (WIZARD)

- [ ] Spellbook has six level 1 spells
- [ ] Four prepared; two slots; three cantrips
- [ ] Ritual Adept understood
- [ ] Arcane Recovery noted
- [ ] Two skills from the class list

SAMPLE CONCEPTS (LEGAL, NOT PRE-WRITTEN HEROES)

These are starting points, not Season Zero cast members. Rename them. Make them yours.

CONCEPT: DOOR POLICY

Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter) + **Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)** + **Canadian (Human)**. Defense Fighting Style. Savage Attacker + Alert (Versatile). Holds doorways; Midterm Onboarding Action Surge ends arguments.

CONCEPT: HOLD MUSIC

Open-Mic Menace (Bard) + **Youth-Group Pizza Wrangler (Acolyte)**. Charisma focus. Inspiration for the tank; *Healing Word* for the mistake; Insight for the liar.

CONCEPT: UNPAID INTERNSHIP

Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard) + **Adjunct Professor on Four Campuses (Sage)**. Intelligence focus. Rituals first, Fire Bolt second, Shield when the camera zooms.

CONCEPT: VERIFIED ACCOUNT

Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock) + **Call-Center Gift-Card Fraud Specialist (Criminal)**. Charisma + Alert. Eldritch Blast as the day job; one slot as the special.

CONCEPT: COMPOST AMBITION

Community-Garden Zealot (Druid) + **Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)** (reskin the reason: park volunteer who got "promoted" to crowd control). Wisdom focus. Entangle first; Wild Shape at Midterm Onboarding.

PRE-BUILTS

Chapter 2's **Use a pre-built** option fills legal defaults for each class. These concepts are the same idea in prose. Neither is a named NPC with plot armor.

PROGRESSION THROUGH FLOOR 3 (STANDARD TRACK)

FLOOR	TYPICAL LEVEL AFTER ONBOARDING	WHAT USUALLY UNLOCKS
1 (start)	1	Intake kit; Provisional Class
1 (Green Room)	2	**Midterm Onboarding** — level 2 features (Fighting Style for Paladin/Ranger; Action Surge; Wild Shape; etc.)
2 (arrival)	2	No extra level from Floor 1 stairwell
2 clear → 3	3	Subclass + Official Class Title + Identity Market offer

After Floor 3 the standard track keeps climbing (arrive Floor 4 at level 5; arrive Floor 10 at level 12; land at level 20 on Floor 18). Slow-Burn Track (Chapter 1 house option) stretches levels; if your table uses it, Midterm Onboarding timing may shift — log the table's choice at session zero.

RESOURCES THAT CARE ABOUT SAFEROOMS

RESOURCE	RECHARGES ON	NOTES
Long Rest features (Rage uses at L1, most slots, Lay on Hands, Innate Sorcery)	Long Rest	Only in a saferoom
Short Rest features (Second Wind partial, Pact slots, Arcane Recovery window, many Focus recoveries)	Short Rest	Field OK if quiet; saferoom guaranteed
Bardic Inspiration (early)	Long Rest	Later levels may change; SRD wins
Hit points	Rests / features	Death saves are public

Field rest fee reminder (Floor 1): **20 credits per Crawler** per failed Long Rest attempt outside a saferoom, **cap 60 per Crawler per floor**. Never grants the Long Rest.

CREDITS AND STARTING KITS

Starting credits come only from class and background packages (Chapter 2). The Crawl adds **no** stipend. Vendor prices use whole credits with per-line rounding (Chapter 1). Crafting table prices and the **25,000** Upgrade Coupon (basic through Floor 8 / Studio through Floor 5; never Enhanced; level upgrades coupon-eligible on Floors 1–4 only) live in Chapter 6.

OPTIONAL: ASSIGNED COMPANION TABLES

With two players, the System may add an **Assigned Companion** (Chapter 1): GM-run, takes no loot, has opinions. Companions are not pets and not Story Box awards. They do not use this chapter's class entries unless the GM builds them as full Crawlers (rare).

SPELLCASTING SNAPSHOT (LEVEL 1)

Casters skip nothing below that applies. Noncasters skip S11 entirely.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	ABILITY	CANTRIPS	LEVEL 1 PREPARED / KNOWN	SLOTS	NOTES
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	Cha	2	4 prepared	2	Rituals as SRD
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	Wis	3	4 prepared	2	Divine Order may add a cantrip
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	Wis	2	4 prepared	2	Primal Order may add a cantrip
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	Cha	0	2 prepared	2	Half-caster; smite at 2
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	Wis	0	2 prepared	2	Hunter's Mark always prepared
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	Cha	4	2 prepared	2	Innate Sorcery window
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	Cha	2	2 prepared	1 Pact	Slot on Short Rest
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	Int	3	6 in book / 4 prepared	2	Ritual Adept; Arcane Recovery

Spell lists are SRD. This book does not reprint spell text. If a chargen list and the SRD disagree, the SRD wins until Chapter 5/6 verify passes.

ARMOR AND DEFENSE SNAPSHOT

APPROACH	CLASSES THAT OFTEN USE IT	NOTES
Heavy armor	Fighter, Paladin, Cleric (Protector)	Highest AC; Stealth disadvantage on many sets
Medium armor	Barbarian (if armored), Ranger, Cleric, Druid (Warden)	Dex cap usually +2

APPROACH	CLASSES THAT OFTEN USE IT	NOTES
Light armor	Bard, Rogue, Warlock, Ranger	Dexterity does the work
Unarmored Defense	Barbarian, Monk	Formula on the sheet; shields only for Barbarian
Mage Armor / Armor of Shadows	Sorcerer, Wizard, Warlock (invocation)	Slot or invocation tax

SKILLS THAT MATTER EARLY

You can pick what you want. Floor 1 rewards these more often than your pride does:

- **Perception** — traps, ticks, lying saferooms later
- **Athletics / Acrobatics** — doors, climbs, grabs
- **Stealth** — cameras still see you; enemies sometimes do not
- **Insight** — vendors, Continuum later, party members always
- **Intimidation / Persuasion** — vendors, hostages, bad ideas that become good television

Background skills are fixed. Class picks fill holes.

WORKED MICRO-EXAMPLES (ONE FIGHT EACH)

BARBARIAN: THE VESTIBULE

Two rats. You Rage on round one, greataxe Mastery, Reckless not yet (level 1). Second Wind if you are already embarrassed. Save the second Rage for the named fight.

BARD: THE ARGUMENT

Ally misses by 2. Bonus Action Inspiration. You *Vicious Mockery* the boss. You do not Inspiration yourself unless the SRD and your table agree you can — read your feature.

CLERIC: THE BLEED

Ally at 0. Spare the Dying or Cure Wounds. If Protector, you also stood in front. If Thaumaturge, your cantrip already softened the enemy.

DRUID: THE HALLWAY

Entangle the chokepoint. Allies shoot into it. You do not Wild Shape yet. You look smug anyway.

FIGHTER: THE DOOR

Defense style, chain mail, Second Wind after the second swing hits you. Action Surge is tomorrow's problem (Midterm Onboarding).

MONK: THE LANE

Dash with movement, unarmed Bonus Action, do not eat opportunity attacks you can avoid. Focus points tomorrow.

PALADIN: THE POOL

Lay on Hands 5 into an ally at 1 HP. Spell slot saved for the boss. Fighting Style tomorrow.

RANGER: THE MARK

Bonus Action *Hunter's Mark*, bow attack, relocate. Fighting Style tomorrow. Do not lose the marked target in a joke chase into a closed zone.

ROGUE: THE FLANK

Ally adjacent to target. Sneak Attack lands. Hide afterward if Cunning Action exists yet; if not, Disengage the old-fashioned way.

SORCERER: THE POSTER FIGHT

Innate Sorcery up. Fire Bolt with Advantage. Ordinary rats get ordinary cantrips.

WARLOCK: THE SCALPEL

Eldritch Blast for the shift. Pact slot for *Hex* or *Armor of Agathys* when the camera says so. Short Rest after.

WIZARD: THE DOOR MARKED DO NOT

Detect Magic ritual if you have time. *Shield* when you do not. Fire Bolt when philosophy fails.

BACKGROUND ABILITY TRIPLES (SRD FOUR)

BACKGROUND	RAISE AMONG	ORIGIN FEAT
Youth-Group Pizza Wrangler (Acolyte)	Int / Wis / Cha	Magic Initiate (Cleric)
Call-Center Gift-Card Fraud Specialist (Criminal)	Dex / Con / Int	Alert
Adjunct Professor on Four Campuses (Sage)	Con / Int / Wis	Magic Initiate (Wizard)
Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)	Str / Dex / Con	Savage Attacker

Pick **+2 / +1** or **+1 / +1 / +1** among the three. Preview the final modifiers before you Confirm.

COMMON INTAKE MISTAKES

1. **Taking Fighting Style on Paladin or Ranger at level 1.** Illegal. Wait for level 2.
2. **Forgetting Dwarven Toughness +1 HP.** If Vietnamese (Dwarf), add it.

3. **Preparing Ranger spells without noting Hunter's Mark is free.** It is always prepared.
4. **Wizard preparing six spells instead of four.** Six live in the book; four are prepared.
5. **Spending all credits at the Vending Wall and holding 0 with no ball bearings.** Legal, unwise.
6. **Writing species features into the Floor 1 Look.** You look human until Floor 3; the GM handles the small tells.
7. **Asking for a Fan Profile reward.** Hidden. Survey notes are private. Customer Feedback is not a loot menu.
8. **Planning to Long Rest in a hallway.** Saferoom only. Field fee does not equal rest.

TABLE: WHEN FEATURES ARRIVE (LEVELS 1–3)

This is a reminder map, not a full progression table. SRD feature names win.

LEVEL	TYPICAL UNLOCK EXAMPLES
1	Full Provisional chassis (this chapter)
2	Midterm Onboarding on Floor 1: Action Surge; Wild Shape; Focus; Fighting Style (Paladin/Ranger); Channel Divinity; Font of Magic; Cunning Action; Expertise (Bard); etc.
3	Subclass; Official Class Title; Continuum Identity Market offer

Exact feature lists by class are in the SRD. Do not invent a level 2 feature because a novel character had one.

TONE REMINDERS FOR CLASS FANTASY

- Roast the **choice**, not the player.
- Class fantasy may be crude; it is never about a player's real identity.
- "Cut" works instantly.
- Season Zero original cast only: your table's Crawlers.

> **HOUSE OPTION • HOUSE LABELS IN THIS CHAPTER**
>
> Roll's 73+ keep threshold, Floor 1 field rest fees, Midterm Onboarding timing, and coupon notes that wander in from crafting are HOUSE overlays on SRD chassis. Class math is SRD.

BUILDING A PARTY OF FOUR

Season Zero assumes **four active Crawlers**. Two-player tables may receive an Assigned Companion; five or six need a firmer initiative hand (Chapter 1). Use this section when the table is staring at twelve class names and panicking.

COVERAGE CHECKLIST

A resilient Floor 1 party usually covers:

1. **Someone who can take a hit** — Barbarian, Fighter, Paladin, or Protector Cleric.
2. **Someone who can heal or stabilize** — Cleric, Paladin, Druid, Bard, or a Healer's Kit user.
3. **Someone who can open or bypass** — Rogue, Bard, Wizard rituals, or raw Athletics.
4. **Someone who can deal reliable damage every round** — any martial with Mastery, or a cantrip-heavy caster.

You do not need one class per bullet. A Fighter/Cleric/Rogue/Wizard square is classic. Four Barbarians is a documentary.

ROLE OVERLAP IS FINE

Two Face characters (Bard + Warlock) will fight over the microphone and the Ratings will rise. Two tanks will argue about the doorway and survive longer. The System prefers spectacle over optimization.

WHO CARRIES THE CLOCK

Someone must watch the floor clock. Rangers and Rogues often notice exits; Clerics and Paladins often notice dying friends; Wizards often notice bad ideas. Assign the clock out of character if nobody wants it in character.

REPLACEMENT MATH

If someone dies, the replacement joins at the next saferoom at the party's lowest level with a late-entry kit and one **Silver loot box**. Build replacements with this chapter the same way you built the original. Do not inherit the dead Crawler's unopened boxes — those were reclaimed.

DIVINE ORDER AND PRIMAL ORDER DEEP DIVE

HALLWAY BODYGUARD (PROTECTOR)

You train with martial weapons and heavy armor. Your Wisdom still drives spells; your Armor Class looks like a professional. Take this if you want to stand next to the Fighter without flinching. You are still a full caster — do not forget to prepare spells because you found a greataxe.

CHURCH RUMMAGE-SALE MYSTIC (THAUMATURGE)

You lean into the holy symbol. Extra cantrip, stronger save DCs and attack bonuses while the symbol is presented as a focus (as SRD). Take this if you want the sacred equivalent of a customer-service headset that actually works.

FARMERS-MARKET HEDGE MAGICIAN (MAGICIAN)

Druid version of the mystic fork: more cantrip pressure, focus-based casting bonus. Your hose is a focus. Your opinions about lawns remain unwelcome.

TRAIL-CREW WARDEN (WARDEN)

Druid version of the bodyguard fork: martial weapons and medium armor. You can stand in a doorway and still prepare *Entangle*. Metal armor restrictions still apply if your table enforces them.

ELDRITCH INVOCATION PICKS (LEVEL 1 GUIDANCE)

All invocations use SRD text and prerequisites. Practical Season Zero notes:

- **Armor of Shadows** — *Mage Armor* at will. Good if you refuse real armor.
- **Devil's Sight** — see in magical darkness. Situational on Floor 1; hilarious later.
- **Eldritch Mind** — Advantage on Constitution saves to maintain concentration. Quietly excellent.
- **Fiendish Vigor** — false life on yourself. Padding for the first week.
- **Pact of the Blade** — weapon bond fantasy. You still need to hit.
- **Pact of the Chain** — familiar. This is not a pet rules chapter; use the SRD familiar and stop there.
- **Pact of the Tome** — extra cantrips. For people who click agree and also read appendices.
- **Mask of Many Faces** — *Disguise Self* at will. Cameras still know. Audiences sometimes do not.
- **Misty Visions** — *Silent Image* at will. Make a hallway look closed. Pray.
- **Gaze of Two Minds** — share senses. Support and scouting.
- **Lessons of the First Ones** — Origin feat access as SRD. Powerful; check prerequisites.

Pick one. You get more later. Do not try to pick two at intake.

SPECIES INTERACTIONS (POINTER)

Species rules are in Chapter 2 (picking one) and Chapter 3 (the Crawl, Floor 3 and the oddities). Class features do not change them. Notable mechanical nubs:

- **Dwarven Toughness** adds +1 HP per level on top of class Hit Dice.
- **Human Versatile** adds a second Origin feat from the **SRD four** only in this book.
- **Elf Keen Senses** and **Human Skillful** add skills that may overlap class picks — the tool asks for a different skill if a duplicate appears.
- Darkvision quirks are filed as mundane on Floors 1–2. They still work.

On Floor 3 the Identity Market can change your species and background and offer a class option on your current class; Chapter 3 has the details.

OFFICIAL CLASS TITLES (FLOOR 3 PREVIEW)

At level 3 the System certifies your class and hands you an **Official Class Title**: a flashy, nonmechanical name. Subclass choice is real; Title is paint. Examples of tone (not a locked list):

- Off-Duty Bouncer → "Union-Busting Vestigial Authority"
- Perpetual Grad Student → "Defended, Barely"
- Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer → "Preferred Customer (Hostile)"

Your table invents Titles with the System. This book does not assign them at creation.

COMPARING MARTIALS AT LEVEL 1

QUESTION	BARBARIAN	FIGHTER	MONK	PALADIN	RANGER	ROGUE
Best early defensive trick	Rage resist / Unarmored	Armor + Style	Mobility + Unarmored	Heavy armor + Lay on Hands	Medium/light + Mark kite	Light armor + positioning
Burst	Rage damage	Second Wind sustain	Bonus unarmed	Lay on Hands / later Smite	Hunter's Mark	Sneak Attack
Fighting Style when?	—	Level 1	—	Level 2	Level 2	—
Mastery count	2	3	—	2	2	2
Wants Short Rests?	Less at L1	Yes (Second Wind)	Yes (from L2)	Mild	Mild	Mild

COMPARING CASTERS AT LEVEL 1

QUESTION	BARD	CLERIC	DRUID	SORCERER	WARLOCK	WIZARD
Cantrip count	2	3	2	4	2	3
Slot recharge	Long	Long	Long	Long	Short (Pact)	Long (+ Recovery)
Signature button	Inspiration	Divine Order + heals	Control spells	Innate Sorcery	Invocation + Pact slot	Rituals + book
Armor	Light	Light/med (+heavy Protector)	Light (+med Warden)	None	Light	None

BACKGROUND PLAY PATTERNS

YOUTH-GROUP PIZZA WRANGLER (ACOLYTE)

You are social infrastructure. People tell you things. Use Insight before Intimidation. Magic Initiate (Cleric) means even a Rogue can cast *Guidance* and feel holy about lockpicking.

CALL-CENTER GIFT-CARD FRAUD SPECIALIST (CRIMINAL)

You are procedural paranoia. Check ceilings. Check vents. Check the nicer saferoom twice from Floor 2 on. Alert means you act before the surprise round becomes a podcast.

ADJUNCT PROFESSOR ON FOUR CAMPUSES (SAGE)

You are the footnote that saves the party. Read the plaque. Ask the System. Prepare *Detect Magic*. Accept that your Origin feat cantrips will be asked for every session.

BLACK-FRIDAY MALL SECURITY (SOLDIER)

You are crowd control with a paycheck history. Athletics to move people; Intimidation to stop people; Savage Attacker when the toaster metaphor becomes a greataxe.

MULTICLASS MINIMUMS (SRD POINTER)

If you multiclass later, you still need the SRD ability score minimums for each class. The Crawl does not waive them because your story is sad. Record levels separately on the sheet. Spell slots combine; Pact Magic stays weird; Extra Attack features do not stack beyond what 5e allows.

WHAT "PROVISIONAL" MEANS AT THE TABLE

Until Floor 3, NPCs and the System treat your class as an accident. You still get every mechanical feature. A Provisional Paladin can Lay on Hands on Floor 1 Day 1. The story paint says "unlicensed"; the rules say "yes."

CROSS-REFERENCES

TOPIC	CHAPTER
Intake screens S1–S17	2
Species	2 / 3
Skills and achievements	5
Gear, boxes, crafting prices	6
Combat procedure	8
Death, Reprieve, saferooms	1 / 9
Floors and clocks	1 / 10

FREQUENTLY ASKED INTAKE QUESTIONS

Can I start with a subclass? No. Level 3.

Can I start with magic items? No. Welcome Box and other boxes arrive in play, opened in a saferoom.

Can I retrain Fighting Style later? Follow the SRD / table ruling. Intake does not offer a free swap.

Does Midterm Onboarding require a quest? No. It is the Green Room level-up before the Floor 1 boss on the standard track.

Do Paladins and Rangers see Fighting Styles on S6? The kiosk may show a preview; the pick unlocks at level 2.

Can Human Versatile take Lucky? Not in the printed book. Versatile picks from the four SRD Origin feats. Lucky is appendix-only under its reskin name.

Are the twelve non-SRD backgrounds on the Discord kiosk? The live tool may list them; this book prints SRD four in full and appendix reskin names only (decision 029).

What if my table owns the 2024 Player's Handbook? The GM may open appendix entries. Still no copied book text in this PDF — use your PHB at the table.

Can I multiclass at level 1? No.

Does collapse death care about my class? No. If you miss the stairwell, you die. Rage does not help. *Feather Fall* does not help. Being entertaining does not help.

ONE-PAGE CLASS CARDS (COPY BLOCK)

Each card is a reminder, not a replacement sheet.

ANGER-MANAGEMENT DROPOUT (BARBARIAN) — L1

HD d12 · Saves STR/CON · Rage 2/Long · Unarmored 10+Dex+Con · Mastery 2 · Skills 2

OPEN-MIC MENACE (BARD) — L1

HD d8 · Saves DEX/CHA · Inspiration d6 · Spells Cha 2 cantrips / 4 prep / 2 slots · Skills 3 (any)

URGENT-CARE CHAPLAIN (CLERIC) — L1

HD d8 · Saves WIS/CHA · Divine Order · Spells Wis 3 / 4 / 2 · Skills 2

COMMUNITY-GARDEN ZEALOT (DRUID) — L1

HD d8 · Saves INT/WIS · Primal Order · Druidic · Spells Wis 2 / 4 / 2 · Skills 2

OFF-DUTY BOUNCER (FIGHTER) — L1

HD d10 · Saves STR/CON · Fighting Style · Second Wind 2 · Mastery 3 · Skills 2

BAREFOOT HOT-YOGA BRAWLER (MONK) — L1

HD d8 · Saves STR/DEX · Martial Arts d6 · Unarmored 10+Dex+Wis · Skills 2

HOA ENFORCEMENT CRUSADER (PALADIN) — L1

HD d10 · Saves WIS/CHA · Lay on Hands 5 · Spells Cha 0 / 2 / 2 · Mastery 2 · Style at L2

SEASONAL PARK RANGER (RANGER) — L1

HD d10 · Saves STR/DEX · Favored Enemy (Hunter's Mark) · Spells Wis 0 / 2 / 2 · Mastery 2 · Style at L2 · Skills 3

FIVE-FINGER DISCOUNT SPECIALIST (ROGUE) — L1

HD d8 · Saves DEX/INT · Expertise 2 · Sneak 1d6 · Cant · Mastery 2 · Skills 4

LEAKY POWER-BANK (SORCERER) — L1

HD d6 · Saves CON/CHA · Innate Sorcery 2 · Spells Cha 4 / 2 / 2 · Skills 2

UNREAD TERMS-AND-CONDITIONS SIGNER (WARLOCK) — L1

HD d8 · Saves WIS/CHA · Pact slot 1 (Short) · Invocation 1 · Spells Cha 2 / 2 / 1 · Skills 2

PERPETUAL GRAD STUDENT (WIZARD) — L1

HD d6 · Saves INT/WIS · Book 6 / prep 4 · Rituals · Arcane Recovery · Spells Int 3 cantrips · Skills 2

```
[SYSTEM]
That concludes class and employment counseling. Please proceed to the stairwell brochure.
It is also lying.
```

CHAPTER FIVE

SKILLS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

> *You have skills! Some of them are even useful. The rest will be graded on a curve, live, in front of an audience of several billion.*
>
> THE SYSTEM

Every Crawler is good at something. This chapter is about what happens when your Crawler tries something and the outcome is in doubt: the **ability check**, the **eighteen skills** of the fifth edition rules, and the habits a Crawl table uses to keep checks fast and fair. The second half of the chapter is about what happens when the System decides you did something *notable*: **achievements**, the reward ladder behind them, and a starter list of the kind of deeds the System likes to talk about.

The rules for checks are the **SRD 5.2** rules, written out here in our own words with Crawl examples. Nothing about the math has changed. The achievement rules are ours. HOUSE

WHAT THIS CHAPTER IS NOT

This chapter does not explain how the System decides *which* reward suits you. That lives in a hidden profile you never see. It also does not list every achievement in the catalog. The System has the full catalog, and the System does not share.

ABILITY CHECKS

An **ability check** tests what a Crawler can do when failure is possible and interesting: picking a lock while something scratches at the door, talking a vending machine's owner out of a refund policy, or remembering which end of a goblin is the dangerous end. Attack rolls and saving throws are the other two **d20 tests**. This chapter covers checks.

MAKING A CHECK

1. **The GM picks the ability** that fits the task, and a **skill** if one applies (for example, Dexterity (Stealth)).
2. **The GM sets a Difficulty Class (DC).** The table below gives the usual steps.
3. **Roll a d20 and add the ability modifier.** Add your **Proficiency Bonus** if you are proficient in the skill or tool being used.
4. **Meet or beat the DC** and the check succeeds. Fall short and it fails, and the Dungeon gets to decide what failure looks like.

TASK DIFFICULTY	DC
Very easy	5
Easy	10

TASK DIFFICULTY	DC
Medium	15
Hard	20
Very hard	25
Nearly impossible	30

Most checks in a session sit at **Easy** or **Medium**. A Very Easy task usually doesn't need a roll at all, and a Nearly Impossible one should be rare enough to be worth an achievement if somebody pulls it off.

WHEN NOT TO ROLL

Call for a check only when the outcome is uncertain *and* failure would change something. Walking down a hallway, opening an unlocked door and reading a sign do not need dice. A Crawler with all the time in the world and nothing hunting them can usually just succeed at a simple task. In the Crawl that situation is rare, because the floor clock is always running.

CALLING THE CHECK

At this table the System **names the ability, the skill and the DC before the roll** whenever the Crawler would reasonably know what they are up against. That keeps decisions honest: a player who hears "Strength (Athletics), DC 20" for a rusted shutter can choose to look for another way in. HOUSE

By default the System rolls all dice **in the open** and announces the whole result, so everyone can follow it:

> **Strength (Athletics), DC 15.** Roll 14, plus 5. **19. Success.**

A table may let players roll their own dice instead; agree on it at session zero. The System still rolls some checks **in secret** where the fifth edition rules expect it: a monster's Stealth, an Insight read on a liar, or a trap the Crawler shouldn't see coming. Secret or not, **dice stand**. The System does not fudge rolls in your favor or against you.

```
[SYSTEM]
The System does not cheat. The System does not need to. Have you seen your Wisdom score?
```

ADVANTAGE AND DISADVANTAGE

When circumstances help, you have **Advantage**: roll two d20s and use the higher. When they hurt, you have **Disadvantage**: roll two and use the lower. If you have both, they cancel and you roll one d20. Multiple sources of Advantage still mean only two dice. The GM grants Advantage for good tools, good plans and good help, and imposes Disadvantage for bad light, bad footing and bad ideas.

NATURAL 20S AND NATURAL 1S

On an ability check, a roll of 20 or 1 is just a number. It is **not** an automatic success or failure. (The automatic hit and miss belong to attack rolls; death saving throws have their own rule.) The System will still comment on your natural 1. It is contractually obligated to.

HEROIC INSPIRATION

If you have **Heroic Inspiration**, you can spend it to reroll any one die right after you roll it, and you must use the new roll. You can hold only one at a time. The Crawl hands it out for crowd-pleasing moments and as an achievement reward (see "The Reward Ladder" below).

USING DIFFERENT ABILITIES

Each skill is listed under the ability it usually goes with, but the GM may pair a skill with another ability when the task calls for it. Pinning a struggling goblin while you shout questions at it might be Strength (Intimidation). Remembering the layout of a store you worked in might be Intelligence (Survival) instead of Wisdom. The skill says *what you know how to do*; the ability says *how you are doing it*.

PROFICIENCY AND EXPERTISE

Your **Proficiency Bonus** is set by your level and goes up as you descend. Add it to any check that uses a skill or tool you are proficient in.

LEVEL	PROFICIENCY BONUS
1–4	+2
5–8	+3
9–12	+4
13–16	+5
17–20	+6

Where proficiencies come from. Your Prior Employment (background) gives you two skills and a tool. Your class lets you pick more skills from its list. Some species give one (an Elf's Keen Senses, a Human's Skillful trait), and some feats give several (the Skilled Origin feat gives three). Chapter 2 walks through the picks; you can never be proficient in the same skill twice.

Expertise. Some features grant **Expertise** in a skill. When you make a check with that skill, your Proficiency Bonus is **doubled**. A Rogue picks two skills for Expertise at level 1, and a Bard gets it at level 2. Expertise only applies to a skill you are already proficient in.

PLAIN NAMES ON PURPOSE

Ability scores have kiosk nicknames on the intake screens (Gym-Bro Energy, Pub-Quiz Brain, and the rest). **Skill names never get a nickname.** Your sheet, the System's roll posts and this book all say Athletics, Perception and Sleight of Hand, so nobody has to translate in the middle of a fight.

THE EIGHTEEN SKILLS

SKILL	ABILITY	COVERS
Athletics	Strength	Climbing, jumping, swimming, shoving, grappling, forcing

SKILL	ABILITY	COVERS
Acrobatics	Dexterity	Balance, tumbling, staying upright, slipping free
Sleight of Hand	Dexterity	Pickpocketing, palming, planting, fine manual tricks
Stealth	Dexterity	Hiding, sneaking, moving without being noticed
Arcana	Intelligence	Spells, magic items, sigils, magical oddities
History	Intelligence	Past events, people, places, old institutions
Investigation	Intelligence	Deduction, searching for clues, working out how things fit
Nature	Intelligence	Terrain, plants, animals, weather
Religion	Intelligence	Gods, rites, holy symbols, cults
Animal Handling	Wisdom	Calming, steering and reading animals
Insight	Wisdom	Reading intent, spotting lies, sensing mood
Medicine	Wisdom	Stabilizing the dying, diagnosing illness and poison
Perception	Wisdom	Noticing things with your senses
Survival	Wisdom	Tracking, foraging, navigating, reading hazards
Deception	Charisma	Lying convincingly, disguises, misdirection
Intimidation	Charisma	Threats, menace, getting your way by fear
Performance	Charisma	Entertaining an audience on purpose
Persuasion	Charisma	Honest argument, negotiation, charm

Constitution has no skills. When the System asks you to keep drinking, keep running or keep holding your breath, it calls for a plain Constitution check.

SKILLS BY ABILITY

Each entry below says what the skill covers and gives a handful of ways it comes up in the Crawl. The examples lean on Floors 1 and 2, where most new Crawlers spend their first sessions finding out what their sheet is for. Difficulty words (Easy, Medium, Hard) refer to the DC table above.

GYM-BRO ENERGY (STRENGTH)

Strength checks measure raw force: lifting, pushing, pulling, breaking. Without a skill, a Strength check covers forcing a jammed door, bending bars, lifting a collapsed shelf off a friend, or holding a closing gate for one more second.

Athletics

Climbing, jumping, swimming and wrestling. Athletics covers hard physical effort against the world or against a body: scaling a wall, leaping farther than your normal jump allows, swimming against a current, and breaking free when something has you grappled. (Grappling or shoving a creature yourself uses the SRD's Unarmed Strike options, which call for the target's saving throw, not your check.)

- Hauling yourself up a slick maintenance ladder while the lights strobe (Easy) or a greased one while something bites your ankle (Hard).

- Kicking through a flimsy partition wall to skip a hallway the System obviously wants you to walk down.
- Keeping your grip on a rope bridge when the far end starts to unclip itself.
- Shoving a vending machine over onto a goblin. The System will log the property damage.

PARKOUR DELUSION (DEXTERITY)

Dexterity checks measure agility, reflexes and fine control. Without a skill, a Dexterity check covers things like catching a falling vial or steering a stolen shopping cart down a ramp. **Initiative** is a Dexterity check too.

Acrobatics

Balance, tumbling and staying on your feet. Use Acrobatics to keep your footing on ice, oil or a moving floor, to dive and roll through a gap, or to wriggle free of a grapple when the other ability would be Strength (Athletics).

- Running across a floor slick with something you'd rather not identify.
- Dropping and rolling under a closing shutter.
- Landing on your feet after the floor tilts (the System calls this "a fun surprise").

Sleight of Hand

Quick, careful hands. Pickpocketing, palming an object, planting something on someone, loosening a bolt without anyone seeing, and other fiddly work done under observation.

- Lifting a keycard off a sleeping guard.
- Palming a small item off a vendor's counter while you haggle. (Getting caught is also an achievement.)
- Tying a tripwire across a doorway while the rest of the party keeps a mob's attention.

Stealth

Not being noticed. Stealth covers sneaking, hiding and moving quietly. Use it with the **Hide** action (see "Actions That Call for Checks"). Heavy armor that the SRD marks with a Stealth penalty gives you Disadvantage.

- Slipping past a pack of sleeping mobs to reach a loot crate.
- Following a rival party far enough to see where their stairwell is.
- Staying very, very still while something large sniffs the vent you are in.

PUB-QUIZ BRAIN (INTELLIGENCE)

Intelligence checks measure memory, reasoning and knowledge. Without a skill, an Intelligence check covers working out a code, assembling a device from parts, or estimating the value of junk.

Arcana

Magic and the things it leaves behind. Arcana covers spells, magic items, glyphs, magical traditions and the stranger corners of the Dungeon's machinery.

- Recognizing the spell a goblin shaman is winding up before it finishes.
- Working out what an unidentified magic item probably does before you put it on.

- Spotting that a saferoom's glowing sigil is a little *too* glowing.

History

What happened before. History covers past events, famous people, lost places, old organizations and the customs that came out of them. In a game where everything inside was destroyed in one afternoon, history includes everything you knew about the world before.

- Remembering how a real-world building of this type was laid out, and where its back exits were.
- Recalling the name and habits of a faction that shows up on a later floor.
- Recognizing a symbol from a museum exhibit that no longer exists.

Investigation

Deduction. Investigation is searching *and thinking*: noticing that a desk has been moved, working out where a trap's trigger must be from the shape of the room, reading what happened from a scene. Use it with the **Study** action.

- Working out from the scuff marks that the "saferoom" door gets opened from the outside.
- Figuring out how a System puzzle-lock wants to be solved.
- Reading a vendor's price list for the catch.

Nature

The living world. Nature covers terrain, plants, animals, weather and natural cycles. The Dungeon builds habitats, and Nature tells you how they work.

- Identifying a mushroom as edible, poisonous or "edible once."
- Knowing what a creature eats, and therefore what it might be hunting.
- Predicting that the water in a flooded zone will rise with the "tide."

Religion

Gods and the things done in their names. Religion covers deities, rites, prayers, holy symbols, religious orders and cults.

- Recognizing a shrine's patron, and whether offering at it is polite or suicidal.
- Spotting that a cult's chant is counting down.
- Knowing which rites a temple NPC will expect from a visitor.

WARNING SIGNS YOU IGNORED (WISDOM)

Wisdom checks measure awareness, intuition and common sense. Without a skill, a Wisdom check covers getting a gut feeling about a plan or noticing that something about a room is wrong without knowing what.

Animal Handling

Animals and animal-like things. Animal Handling covers calming a frightened beast, keeping a mount steady, reading an animal's mood and guessing what it will do next. Use it with the **Influence** action when you deal with a Beast or a Monstrosity.

- Talking a cornered, frightened dog out of biting you.
- Noticing that the rats have all stopped moving.
- Keeping a skittish mount from bolting when the fireworks start.

Insight

Reading people. Insight covers telling whether someone is lying, guessing what they want, and sensing mood and intent from body language and tone. Use it with the **Search** action when the thing you're searching is a creature's state of mind.

- Telling whether a Crawler from another party is really lost or is scouting you.
- Reading whether an NPC's smile means "deal" or "dinner."
- Sensing that the System's cheerful announcement is hiding something. (It is. It always is.)

Medicine

Keeping bodies working. Medicine covers stabilizing a dying creature, diagnosing an illness, recognizing a poison and working out what killed something. Taking the Help action to stabilize a creature at 0 hit points calls for a DC 10 Wisdom (Medicine) check, as the SRD says.

- Stabilizing an ally at 0 hit points before the next round ends.
- Recognizing which goblin toxin is in the wound, and what it does next.
- Telling from a corpse how long ago something happened, and how.

Perception

Noticing. Perception covers spotting, hearing and otherwise detecting things with your senses: a hidden creature, a tripwire, a quiet sound. It is the skill most often used passively (see "Passive Checks").

- Hearing claws in the ceiling.
- Spotting the shimmer of a pressure plate in a dusty floor.
- Noticing that the stairwell sign is hand-painted.

Survival

Getting by in hostile terrain. Survival covers tracking, hunting, finding food and water, finding your way, and reading hazards in the environment. Use it with the **Search** action for tracks and food.

- Following blood drops back to where a mob is nesting.
- Finding your way back to the last saferoom when the map is still fogged.
- Judging that the "shortcut" across the flooded atrium is a very bad idea.

MAIN-CHARACTER ENERGY (CHARISMA)

Charisma checks measure force of personality and how well you deal with an audience. Without a skill, a Charisma check covers a first impression, a toast, or a clumsy attempt to blend into a crowd. Most social checks use the **Influence** action.

Deception

Lying, and being good at it. Deception covers convincing lies, misleading half-truths, disguises and bluffing. It is opposed by the target's Insight when it matters.

- Convincing a guard that you have every right to be behind the counter.
- Telling a rival party that the hallway behind you is a dead end.
- Pretending you meant to set off that trap.

Intimidation

Getting your way by fear. Intimidation covers threats, menace, a display of force or a very convincing stare.

- Making a gang of mobs reconsider the fight once their leader drops.
- Persuading a stubborn NPC that you will, in fact, keep breaking things.
- Staring down another Crawler at the last vendor in the zone.

Performance

Entertaining on purpose. Performance covers music, acting, comedy, dancing, storytelling and anything else done for an audience. In a game that is broadcast to an audience, Performance comes up more than you'd expect.

- Holding a crowd's attention while the rest of the party loots behind them.
- Turning a disaster into a bit the audience enjoys.
- Delivering a one-liner the System decides to replay.

Persuasion

Honest influence. Persuasion covers good-faith argument, negotiation, diplomacy and charm. Haggling with a vendor is a Charisma check, usually Persuasion (Deception or Intimidation also work; see Chapter 1).

- Haggling a price down at a saferoom vendor.
- Convincing a frightened NPC to come with you.
- Talking a tired party into one more room before the Long Rest.

```
[SYSTEM]
Skills update in real time. Please do not attempt to update them yourself by shouting.
```

TYPICAL CHECKS IN THE CRAWL

The GM sets every DC, but these are the kinds of tasks that come up again and again on the early floors, with the check the System usually calls and how hard it tends to be. Use them as a starting point, not a price list.

TASK	USUAL CHECK	USUAL DIFFICULTY
Force a stuck office door	Strength (Athletics)	Easy to Medium
Climb a collapsed escalator	Strength (Athletics)	Medium
Cross an oil-slicked floor at a run	Dexterity (Acrobatics)	Medium

TASK	USUAL CHECK	USUAL DIFFICULTY
Pick a cheap lock	Dexterity, with Thieves' Tools	Easy to Medium
Pick a System-grade lock	Dexterity, with Thieves' Tools	Hard
Sneak past sleeping mobs	Dexterity (Stealth), often as a group check	Medium
Identify a common potion by smell	Intelligence (Arcana) or Wisdom (Medicine)	Easy
Spot a pressure plate in a dusty corridor	Wisdom (Perception), often passive	Medium
Work out which way a trap fires	Intelligence (Investigation)	Medium
Follow fresh tracks through debris	Wisdom (Survival)	Easy to Medium
Stabilize a dying ally	Wisdom (Medicine)	DC 10
Tell whether an NPC is lying	Wisdom (Insight) vs their Charisma (Deception)	Contest
Talk a hesitant NPC into helping	Charisma (Persuasion), Influence action	15 or the NPC's Intelligence
Haggle with a saferoom vendor	Charisma (Persuasion, Deception or Intimidation)	Set by the vendor
Hide behind a vending machine	Dexterity (Stealth), Hide action	DC 15

PASSIVE CHECKS

A **passive check** is a check nobody rolls. It stands for the average result of doing something over and over, or of doing it without thinking. The GM uses passive checks for things a Crawler would notice or understand without asking, and to keep a busy table moving.

Passive check = 10 + every modifier that normally applies to the check. Add 5 if you have Advantage on it, and subtract 5 if you have Disadvantage.

- **Passive Perception** is the one on your sheet. The System compares it to a hidden creature's Stealth or a concealed trap's DC whenever you walk into a room.
- The System also uses **passive Investigation** and **passive Insight** freely, so that "anything weird about this room?" and "is this guy lying?" don't always need a roll. This holds at every table, whether you play in chat, by voice or face to face. Rolling is still how you look *harder*. HOUSE

> [SYSTEM]
> The System has computed your passive Perception. It has also computed what you missed. Would you like to know? No. You would not.

WORKING TOGETHER

HELPING

When you **Help** an ally with a check, pick one of your skill or tool proficiencies that fits the task. Your ally has **Advantage** on their next check with that skill or tool, as long as they make it before the start of your next turn and you are close enough to help in a way that makes sense. The GM decides whether help is possible; two people can't pick one lock faster, but two people can lift one shelf.

GROUP CHECKS

When the whole party tries something together (sneaking down a corridor, climbing a shaft, searching a big room), the GM can call for a **group check**. Everyone rolls. **If at least half the group succeeds, the whole group succeeds.** Otherwise the group fails. Group checks let the strong carry the weak without anyone making twelve separate rolls.

GROUP CHECKS AND THE SESSION ORDER

Group checks happen outside the session turn order (Chapter 1). The System resolves them in one beat and moves on. Individual checks during exploration still happen on each Crawler's turn.

CONTESTS

Sometimes two creatures want opposite things: you are trying to hide and a guard is trying to spot you, or you are holding a door shut while a mob pushes on it. That is a **contest**. Both sides make the appropriate check; the higher total wins. **On a tie, nothing changes**: the situation stays as it was before the contest.

SITUATION	YOUR CHECK	THEIR CHECK
Sneaking past a lookout	Dexterity (Stealth)	Wisdom (Perception)
Telling a convincing lie	Charisma (Deception)	Wisdom (Insight)
Palming an item while watched	Dexterity (Sleight of Hand)	Wisdom (Perception)
Wrestling over a weapon	Strength (Athletics)	Strength (Athletics)
Holding a door shut	Strength (Athletics)	Strength (Athletics)
Slipping out of a crowd's grip	Dexterity (Acrobatics)	Strength (Athletics)

ACTIONS THAT CALL FOR CHECKS

Several SRD 5.2 actions are built around an ability check. Each one takes your action on your turn.

ACTION	CHECK	USE IT TO
Search	Wisdom: Insight, Medicine, Perception or Survival	Look for something you can sense: a hidden creature or object, an ailment, someone's state of mind, tracks or food
Study	Intelligence: Arcana, History, Investigation, Nature or Religion	Think hard about something: a spell, an item, a clue, a creature, a symbol
Hide	Dexterity (Stealth), DC 15	Conceal yourself (see below)
Influence	Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, Performance or Persuasion), or Wisdom (Animal Handling) for a Beast or Monstrosity	Urge a creature to do something it is hesitant about
Utilize	Varies	Use an object or tool, including System terminals, levers and vending machines

Hiding. To Hide, you must be heavily obscured or behind three-quarters or total cover, and out of any enemy's line of sight. Succeed on a **DC 15 Dexterity (Stealth)** check and you have the **Invisible** condition. Note your total: it becomes the DC for anyone trying to find you with Wisdom (Perception). You stop being hidden if you make a sound louder than a whisper, make an attack roll, cast a spell with a Verbal component, or get found.

Influence. The GM decides whether the creature is **willing** (it just does it), **unwilling** (no check will make it), or **hesitant** (you roll). A hesitant creature's DC is **15 or its Intelligence score, whichever is higher**. If you fail, you can't urge it in the same way again for a while, usually a day. Roleplay first; the check settles what the conversation could not.

INFLUENCE AND THE SYSTEM

The System is not a creature and has no Intelligence score worth mentioning. You cannot Influence it. You can, however, file a complaint at any System terminal, where it will be read aloud for comedic effect.

TOOLS

A **tool** is a kit that lets you do something you otherwise could not: Thieves' Tools for locks and traps, Herbalism Kit for remedies, Disguise Kit for faces, Tinker's Tools for gadgets. Each tool in the SRD names the ability it uses and what you can do and make with it.

- **Tool proficiency** adds your Proficiency Bonus to checks made with that tool.
- **Tool plus skill.** If you are proficient with the tool *and* with a skill that applies to the same check, you have **Advantage** on it. Picking a lock with Thieves' Tools while you also know Sleight of Hand is the classic case.
- **No tool, no check.** Some tasks are impossible without the right tool. You can't pick a lock with your opinion of it.

Crafting in the Crawl runs on these same tool proficiencies, at saferoom workstations, with a no-roll default called **Steady Hands**. Chapter 6 covers tables, recipes and crafting skills.

SYSTEM SKILLS

In the source series, the System keeps its own list of **skills**: specific, often ridiculous talents with numbered ranks, from fighting with your fists to lacing your boots. They grow with use, from potions and from training, and they usually top out at 15. INSPIRED

System skills sit on your sheet under **Skills**, each with a rank. They don't replace the eighteen skills, proficiency or Expertise; those still carry most checks, and your Proficiency Bonus still climbs with your level. A System skill is narrower: one talent the System has noticed you have, like Lockpicking, Cartography or Vending Machine Diplomacy, growing on its own track.

THE SKILL TRACK

Earning a rank. A System skill rises **one rank** when you earn it in play: INSPIRED

- **Meaningful use.** You lean on the skill when it matters and it makes the difference. Hard or clever use counts; routine use doesn't.
- **A first-time feat.** You pull off something for the first time. That can raise a skill, or hand you a new one at rank 1.
- **Inventive crafting.** You build something new. Real invention can raise more than one skill at once.
- **Potions.** A **Skill Potion** adds 1 rank to a skill. A **Cheat Code Potion** adds 3 ranks to a random skill. You don't pick.
- **Guild training.** A training guild the GM places teaches you a rank, usually with strings attached.

No grinding. There are no use counters. Swinging at a hundred rats adds up to a hundred dead rats and nothing else. The GM grants every rank, the System announces it, and it applies at the next safe point, where the GM records it on your sheet. HOUSE

```
[SYSTEM]
Skill up! Lockpicking is now rank 5. The door you were working on has filed a complaint.
```

Caps. A System skill tops out at **rank 15**. A skill in your species' or class's own family can climb to **rank 20**: a Hobgoblin's traps and explosives, for example, or the skill a Primal picks for Blank Slate (Chapter 3). Pushing a skill past 15 the hard way, through real fights, is a very rare achievement: **You now tread in the realm of gods.** INSPIRED

What a rank does. Each rank widens what the skill can do, and the GM tells you what the new rank opens up. At **ranks 5, 10 and 15** the skill also adds **+1** to d20 checks made with it, so the bonus stacks to +3. A family skill that reaches **rank 20** adds one more, for **+4**. HOUSE

RANK	BONUS TO D20 CHECKS WITH THE SKILL
1–4	+0
5–9	+1
10–14	+2
15–19	+3
20 (family skill only)	+4

The crafting skills and the Cockroach Clause below are System skills with their own short rank scales. Where their rules say something different, their rules win.

CRAFTING SKILLS

These are the System skills a crafter is most likely to see. All of them are GM-granted. The full rules, and the tables and terms they refer to, are in Chapter 6. INSPIRED

SKILL	RANKS	WHAT IT DOES	EARLIEST
Explosives Handling	1–5	1: tell an explosive's tier and stability by looking. 2: Advantage to disarm, defuse or safely carry explosives. 3: pick up and re-place your own armed mines and traps without setting them off. 4: +1 to explosive recipe checks. 5: unlocks the Demolitions Workshop menu at a Sapper's Table.	Rank 5 from Floor 4

SKILL	RANKS	WHAT IT DOES	EARLIEST
IED	I–III	Your crafted explosives deal extra damage equal to your rank × half their damage dice (rounded down, minimum 1), and count as one stability step better per rank against early detonation.	Rank II from Floor 4; rank III from Floor 9
Bomb Surgeon	—	Take apart an explosive at a Sapper's Table for half its ingredients, or split one into two of the next tier down.	—
Infusion	I–II	–2 to the DC of infusions per rank; infused items leave the table one stability step better.	—
Alchemy	—	+1 to alchemy checks; Quick recipes can be made without a table (still in a saferoom).	—
Trap Engineer	—	Thieves' Tools trap recipes treat your Sapper's Table as one level higher.	—
Agent Provocateur	—	+1 Sapper's Table level (ignoring the usual cap) and the right to design Very Rare bomb recipes at a level 5 Sapper's Table. One Crawler per party, from a quest or a Benefactor only.	Floor 6

Ranks usually come quickly at first. A Crawler typically gains rank 1 of Explosives Handling with their first bomb, then about one rank per floor of real use. HOUSE

THE COCKROACH CLAUSE

The most famous System skill in the source is a death-cheat: once a fight, a chance to shrug off a blow that should have killed you. Our version is the **Cockroach Clause**, a permanent boon in two tiers. INSPIRED

- **Tier 1.** Once per combat (or, outside combat, once per Short Rest), when a hit or effect would reduce you to 0 hit points or kill you outright from massive damage, you drop to **1 hit point** instead.
- **Tier 2.** As Tier 1, but the **first** such blow in each combat (or each Short Rest outside combat) deals you **no damage at all**. If a second fatal blow lands in the same combat, Tier 1 applies to it, but only once per Long Rest.

Nobody starts with it. The GM grants it as a reward, or a Crawler trains it. Each time the Clause fires counts as a **use**; after five uses, the GM may upgrade Tier 1 to Tier 2. It can also come from a rare training potion, or from a training guild the GM places, at **3,000 credits for Tier 1** and **10,000 credits for Tier 2**, always with strings attached. Like every near-death buffer, it stops a death but never undoes one, and it does nothing against effects that kill without dealing damage. Chapter 9 covers buffers in full. HOUSE

```
[SYSTEM]
Cockroach Clause invoked. You have been informed that you are not allowed to enjoy this.
```

ACHIEVEMENTS

The System is watching, and the System takes notes. When a Crawler does something **notable**, the System may announce an **achievement**: a banner, a line of commentary, and sometimes a reward. Achievements are how the show tells you it noticed. They are also how most of the Crawl's treasure arrives. INSPIRED

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

ACHIEVEMENT UNLOCKED: ACHIEVEMENTS

You opened the chapter about achievements. Studying for the test is a choice.

REWARD Nothing. You have been seen, and that is worse.

GUIDELINES, NOT A VENDING MACHINE

The single rule that governs every achievement: **the System decides.** It decides what is notable, when to say so, and what (if anything) it pays. The achievement catalog the System works from is a **seed list and tone guide**, not a contract. The System may award a catalog entry as written, rename it, change it, or invent a brand-new achievement on the spot. Meeting an entry's criteria never means you are *owed* it. HOUSE

- **Many achievements pay nothing.** A snark-only banner is a feature. The System enjoys them more than you do.
- **Achievements never grant XP**, and they never turn a failed check into a success.
- **Players can't request rewards.** Asking the System for a specific prize is itself an achievement candidate, and the reward is a joke at your expense.

WHAT COUNTS AS NOTABLE

The System toasts a moment when it is one of these:

KIND	EXAMPLES
Firsts	First kill, first loot box, first saferoom, first death save, first time a feature does its thing
Extremes	Overkill, surviving at 1 hit point, beating something far above your weight, a flawless fight
Creativity	A plan the rules allow but nobody expected; using the environment; talking a boss down
Comedy	A running bit, a perfect one-liner, a spectacular failure
Character	A choice that defines who your Crawler is: mercy, cruelty, loyalty, refusing a sponsor
Mystery	Touching something the System cares about. These toast *without* explaining why.
The show's agenda	Whatever Production wants to encourage, or punish, on this floor

Routine competence is not notable. A normal hit or a passed Easy check gets no banner unless it is your first.

WHEN THE SYSTEM ANNOUNCES

TIMING	WHAT IT'S FOR
Instant toast	Snark, small rewards, firsts and comedy. In a fight, the System waits for the end of the round rather than interrupting a turn.
Saferoom claim	Anything with real loot. The achievement is announced at once; the box or item is **claimed and opened in a saferoom**.
Pending review	Big or mysterious deeds. "This achievement is under review by Production." It may pay off floors later.
Floor recap	At descent, the System may post a Floor Summary with stragglers, statistics and a few parting insults.

How often. Expect roughly **one to three toasts per Crawler per session**. The System spreads the spotlight around: a Crawler who hogs the banners finds the System getting bored of them, and noticing someone else.

Away from the table. A Crawler running on **Standing Orders** while their player is away still fights and can still die, but earns only snark-only achievements.

THE TOAST

Every achievement is read out the same way: a banner, the achievement's name, one line describing what you did (usually phrased as an accusation), and the reward.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

STRATEGIC RETREAT SPECIALIST

You left a fight at full health and nobody laid a hand on you. The audience respects your cardio.

REWARD Their respect, which is non-transferable and worth exactly nothing.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

LOOT GOBLIN

You opened a crate in the middle of combat.

REWARD You are being attacked.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

CUSTOMER FEEDBACK

You asked the System for a specific reward.

REWARD Your request has been received, logged and laughed at.

Keep toasts short. One line of description and one reward line is the standard; the System saves longer speeches for the moments that earn them.

THE REWARD LADDER

When an achievement pays, the System sizes the reward on a seven-step ladder. HOUSE

TIER	NAME	WHAT YOU GET	TYPICAL USE
R0	**Snark-only**	Nothing. Logged. Maybe a cosmetic Title.	Humor, failures, cowardice, brag entries, repeats
R1	**Pocket change**	A few credits and/or a Title	Small firsts, notable-but-routine feats
R2	**Heroic Inspiration**	5e Heroic Inspiration, as written	Great roleplay, crowd-pleasing stunts, brave choices
R3	**Consumable**	A potion, scroll, ammunition, oil or other one-use item at the floor's rarity	Clever play, survival, crafting

TIER	NAME	WHAT YOU GET	TYPICAL USE
R4	**Minor boon**	A Crawl Charm (below) or a small blessing-style perk	Rare achievements, character moments
R5	**Loot box**	A box, Bronze and up (tier by floor, below)	Big achievements, bosses, floor clears
R6	**Headliner**	A specific magic item at the floor's peak rarity, a permanent Blessing, a story unlock, or (level 19+) an extra Epic Boon	Campaign-defining moments

Ladder rules.

- The System may move a reward **one tier up or down** from the catalog's suggestion freely, and two tiers with a reason.
- **Real mechanical power only comes from R2 to R6.** R0 and R1 are flavor and pocket money.
- **Heroic Inspiration from achievements** arrives at most **once per session** per Crawler, on top of the usual 5e sources.
- The catalog's usual R1 seed is **a Title plus 25 credits** at Floor 1 scale.

TITLES

A **Title** is a cosmetic name the System pins to your Crawler ("Blooded," "Oriented," "Fine Print"). Titles show on your sheet and in the System's announcements. They are cosmetic by default; NPCs and the audience may react to them. A rare Title may carry a tiny narrative effect (a faction recognizes it, a bartender comps you a drink), but **never a number on your sheet**.

CREDITS AND THE FLOOR MULTIPLIER

Credits in an achievement reward are written at **Floor 1 scale** and multiplied as you descend. The same multiplier applies to System fees. **Credits pulled out of a loot box do not get the multiplier**: box amounts are final on every floor. HOUSE

FLOORS	ACHIEVEMENT CREDITS AND SYSTEM FEES
1–4	× 1
5–9	× 5
10–14	× 20
15–18	× 50

So a "Title + 25 credits" achievement pays 25 credits on Floor 2, 125 on Floor 6 and 1,250 on Floor 15. All credits are whole numbers (Chapter 1).

ACHIEVEMENT BOXES

When an achievement pays a loot box (R5), the box's tier depends on how big the deed was and where you did it. The catalog marks each achievement **Common**, **Rare** or **Legendary**. That tag is the *achievement's* rarity, not a box tier. HOUSE

ACHIEVEMENT RARITY	USUAL REWARD	BOX IF ONE IS PAID: FLOORS 1–2	FLOORS 3–8	FLOORS 9–14	FLOORS 15–18
Common	R0–R1 (R2 if great)	No box by default	No box by default	No box by default	No box by default
Rare	R2–R5	Bronze	Silver	Silver (Gold from Floor 10)	Gold
Legendary	R5–R6	Bronze	Gold	Platinum	Legendary box or Headliner, within the caps

- **Achievement boxes on Floors 1–2 are Bronze.** Silver there comes only from the Boss Box, or from a GM override with a stated reason. Expect about two or three achievement boxes per Crawler per floor; this is a soft guideline, and the System may pay another for a great moment.
- **Late-entry compensation isn't an achievement box.** The Silver loot box a replacement Crawler brings to the table (Chapter 1) is compensation for joining late, not an achievement reward, so the Floors 1–2 Bronze rule doesn't apply to it.
- **The floor's ceiling always wins.** If an achievement names a box above what the floor allows, the System pays the highest tier the floor allows instead. No Platinum boxes are awarded on Floors 1–8.
- **Every box is named for the deed** that earned it, and the System reads the name aloud: a *Bronze Stabbed the Vending Machine Box*, a *Silver Technically Alive, Spiritually Gone Box*. Cheap boxes get short jabs. Expensive ones get long, breathless, insulting names.
- **Boxes open only in a saferoom**, all of them at once, lowest tier first. A box is bound to the Crawler who earned it. What comes out is ordinary loot. Chapter 6 covers the rest.

```
[SYSTEM]
Congratulations! Your box has been named after your worst decision of the day.
Competition was fierce.
```

RARITY CEILINGS BY FLOOR

Every ordinary reward respects the floor's **rarity ceiling**, whether it comes from an achievement, a boss, a vendor or a box. (A sponsor's Benefactor Box is the one ordinary exception; Chapter 6 explains.) The **default** column is what a meaningful drop usually is; the **peak** is the best the System will hand out, as a Headliner or boss loot, about once per Crawler per floor arc. HOUSE

FLOORS	DEFAULT RARITY	PEAK RARITY	NOTES
1–2	Common	Uncommon	Consumables dominate; one Uncommon per Crawler by the end of Floor 2 is fine
3–5	Uncommon	Rare	The first Rare usually comes from a floor boss or a Legendary achievement
6–9	Rare	Very Rare	Sponsors and hunters bring the shiny stuff
10–14	Very Rare	Legendary	Legendary items stay rare: about one per Crawler across this band
15–18	Very Rare or Legendary	Legendary (Artifacts only through the story)	Endgame loadouts

TAILORED REWARDS

The System personalizes rewards. **Same achievement, different Crawler, different prize.** Two Crawlers who earn the same toast may get different items of the same tier: one gets the crossbow, the other gets the hat. The System fits rewards to your build and to a **hidden Fan Profile** that it builds itself, from play. You never see the profile, you can't edit it, and nothing you say at the table will make the System admit it exists. Tailoring changes *which* item you get, never how much power the floor hands out. INSPIRED

> [SYSTEM]
> Congratulations! You are the only Crawler on this floor to receive this item. Nobody else wanted one. Please stop crying, you're scaring the audience.

FAIR PLAY

The System is petty, but it keeps the books honest. HOUSE

- **No farming.** Repeat a stunt on purpose and it pays snark after the first time. "Again? Production has seen this episode."
- **No double dipping.** The same achievement never pays the same Crawler twice. The same *kind* of deed on a new floor can pay again, possibly smaller.
- **No self-harm for loot.** A stunt that endangers the party just to trigger a toast pays snark and may draw a complication.
- **No catalog hunting.** Players who read the catalog and hunt its rows get roasted. The catalog belongs to the System.
- **Shared deeds.** When two Crawlers earn something together, both get the toast. Tangible rewards are split or tailored separately.
- **No take-backs.** Removing an awarded achievement needs the table's agreement or a clear rules error.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Here is how checks and achievements fit together at the table. The System is the GM; Dev, Ines and Rook are three Crawlers on Floor 1.

System: The corridor ends in a shuttered snack kiosk. Something behind the shutter is chewing. Dev, it's your move.

Dev: I take the Help action for Ines. I'll hold the bottom of the shutter so it doesn't rattle when she lifts it. I'm proficient in Stealth.

System: Noted. Ines, your move. Rook, your passive Perception tells you the chewing just stopped.

Ines: I lift the shutter quietly and look in.

System: Lifting it is easy. Doing it quietly is not: Dexterity (Stealth), DC 15, and Dev's help gives you Advantage. Rolls 9 and 17, take the 17, plus 5: 22. The shutter goes up without a sound. Inside: four rats the size of beagles, and a crate.

Rook: My move. I throw a lit flare into the kiosk, drag the shutter back down and lean on it.

System: The rats push back. Strength (Athletics) contest. Your 18 beats their 11. The kiosk is now an oven, and the rats have stopped pushing.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

CLOSED FOR RENOVATIONS

You locked a room full of mobs in with a fire and held the door.

REWARD Bronze Pest Control Is a Lifestyle Box. Claim it at the next saferoom.

System: Rook gets the toast. The box goes into Rook's System Inventory unopened. It opens at the next saferoom, with any other boxes Rook is holding. Dev, the crate is yours to loot when the smoke clears.

The example shows the habits this chapter describes: the System names the check and DC up front, rolls in the open, uses passive Perception to share a clue, resolves a Help and a contest in session order, toasts once the moment is over, and holds the box for a saferoom. It also shows the most important rule of achievements: nothing on the sheet said this would earn one. The System decided it did.

CRAWL CHARMS AND BLESSINGS

A **Crawl Charm** is the System's favorite R4 reward: a small, one-use or few-use supernatural gift, built like the Charms of the fifth edition *Dungeon Master's Guide*. Unless a Charm says otherwise, it vanishes when its uses run out **or when you descend**, whichever comes first. **You can hold two Charms at once.** HOUSE

CHARM	EFFECT
Second Season	Once: when you would drop to 0 hit points, drop to 1 hit point instead.
Commercial Break	Once: gain a Short Rest's benefits in 1 minute (out of combat only).
Fan Mail	Twice: gain Heroic Inspiration when you otherwise wouldn't; you still can't hold more than one.
Slow-Mo Replay	Once: as a Reaction, after you see a d20 result within 30 feet, force a reroll.
Product Placement	Once: pull any mundane item worth 25 credits or less from your System Inventory, even if you never had one.
Stage Lighting	3 uses: as a Bonus Action, outline a creature you can see in light until the end of your next turn. Attacks against it have Advantage, and it can't benefit from being Invisible.
Contract Fine Print	Once: Advantage on a check to find a loophole, read a contract, or argue with a System terminal.
Laugh Track	Once: as an action, one creature within 30 feet makes a Wisdom save (DC 8 + your Proficiency Bonus + your highest mental ability modifier) or has the Incapacitated condition until the end of its next turn, laughing.
Map Leak	Once: reveal the nearest saferoom or stairwell on your System Map.
Stunt Double	Once: when a creature hits you with an attack, an ally within 5 feet may take the damage instead (their choice).
Sponsor's Bottle	Once: as a Bonus Action, a Potion of Healing appears in your hand. It is branded.

CHARM	EFFECT
Encore	Once: regain one expended spell slot of level 2 or lower, or one use of a feature that recharges on a Short Rest.

Blessings are permanent R6 rewards, built like the *Dungeon Master's Guide*'s Blessings. Three examples: **Recognized** (your Broadcast Name works twice per Long Rest instead of once), **Iron Stomach** (Advantage on saving throws against the Poisoned condition), and **Lucky Number** (once per Long Rest, treat a d20 roll of 1 as a 10). HOUSE

SAMPLE ACHIEVEMENTS

Here is a starter set drawn from the System's catalog, chosen for Floors 1 and 2 and for achievements that work on any floor. It is a **seed list**, not a menu. The System decides what is notable, and it will rename these, adapt them, skip them and invent new ones. The full catalog runs to well over a thousand entries, and the System keeps it to itself.

How to read the table. *Floor* is where the entry fits best ("Any" travels). *Rarity* is the achievement's own tag (Common, Rare, Legendary). *Typical reward* is the catalog's suggestion before the System tailors it:

- **Snark only:** a banner and a line, nothing else (R0).
- **Title + 25 credits:** pocket change at Floor 1 scale (R1); the credits take the floor multiplier.
- **Box + Title:** an achievement box at the floor's tier, which is **Bronze on Floors 1–2** (R5).
- **Big box + Title + flair:** the Legendary-achievement box for the floor (Bronze on Floors 1–2, Gold on 3–8) plus a cosmetic flourish.

Achievement names marked † borrow the *shape* of a deed from the source series; the names and wording here are ours. INSPIRED

COMBAT

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
First Blood	Any	Landed the killing blow on your first mob.	Common	Title (Blooded) + a junk weapon oil
Overkill Artist	Any	Dealt at least three times a target's remaining hit points in one hit.	Rare	Box + Title
Crowd Control King	Any	Put a controlling condition on five or more enemies in one fight.	Rare	Box + Title
David vs Goliath	Any	Killed a creature whose CR is at least your level + 5 (at levels 1–4, at least twice your level).	Legendary	Big box + Title + flair
No Hit Wonder	Any	Won a fight without taking any damage.	Rare	Box + Title
Combo Meal	Any	Finished a kill together with an ally in the same round.	Rare	Box + Title
Boss Claim	1	Defeated the floor's boss or gate guardian.	Rare	Box + Title
Minion Mower	1	Defeated 25 ordinary enemies on one floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Environmentalist	1	Killed an enemy with a floor hazard.	Rare	Box + Title
Perfect Ambush	1	Started a fight hidden and won it without an ally dropping.	Rare	Box + Title

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Elite Hunter	2	Defeated three elite enemies on Floor 2.	Rare	Box + Title
Lost Initiative, Won Anyway	1	Lost initiative and still won the fight.	Common	Title + 25 credits

EXPLORATION

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Cartographer's Scratch	Any	Revealed half of a floor's map.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Full Fog Breaker	Any	Revealed an entire floor's map.	Legendary	Map cosmetic + box
Secret Door Sniffer	Any	Found three hidden doors on one floor.	Rare	Box + Title
Saferoom Skeptic	Any	Walked into a saferoom and immediately searched it for traps.	Rare	A tool upgrade (trap kit)
Hidden Cache	1	Found a hidden loot cache.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Locksmith	1	Opened five locked containers on one floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Stair Seeker	2	Located the stairwell before the floor's boss was dead.	Rare	Box + Title
Saferoom With Teeth	2	Discovered that a saferoom was hiding a hazard.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Trap Sense Tingling	2	Disarmed three traps on Floor 2.	Rare	Box + Title
Slow Burn	2	Took the long route on purpose and still cleared the floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits

SOCIAL

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Silver Tongue	Any	Succeeded on five Charisma checks in one session.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Barter Baron	Any	Haggled a vendor's price down by a quarter or more.	Rare	Box + Title
Name Dropper	Any	Invoked your Broadcast Name for a social benefit (Floor 3 and later).	Rare	Box + Title
Vendor Regular	1	Bought from the same vendor twice.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Peaceful Path	1	Ended a hostile encounter by talking.	Rare	Box + Title
Local Contact	2	Gained a named NPC ally.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Rumor Mill	2	Collected three rumors on one floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Pay a Fine	1	Paid a fine. On purpose or otherwise.	Common	Title + 25 credits
The Honest Option	1	Told the truth when a lie would have been safer.	Common	Title + 25 credits

SURVIVAL AND PARTY

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Down But Not Out	Any	Were stabilized from 0 hit points.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Close Call	Any	Survived at exactly 1 hit point.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Wipe Adjacent	Any	Were the only one left standing after a near-wipe.	Legendary	Big box + Title + flair
Buddy System	Any	Stabilized an ally or got them back on their feet.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Sacrifice Play	Any	Took a hit that would have dropped an ally.	Rare	Box + Title
Ironman Cub	1	Cleared Floor 1 without anyone in the party dropping to 0 hit points.	Legendary	Big box + Title + flair
Poison Tolerant	1	Suffered a poison or disease and got it cured.	Common	Title + 25 credits

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Share the Snacks	1	Shared your food with the party.	Rare	Box + Title

LOOT AND CRAFTING

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Pocket Lint	Any	Looted your first container.	Common	25 credits
Named Drop	Any	Obtained a named magic item of Uncommon rarity or better.	Rare	Box + Title
Loot Council	Any	Let the party vote on who gets a named item.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Vending Gore	1	Looted a vending machine on Floor 1.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Crowbar Starter	1	Equipped a junk melee weapon as your first weapon.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Junk Architect	1	Looted fifteen junk items on one floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Full Sellout	1	Sold ten items to vendors on one floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Field Craft	1	Crafted or cooked something for the first time on this floor.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Kit Bash	1	Combined two junk items into something useful.	Rare	Box + Title
Dungeonpreneur †	Any	Invented a new weapon, device or potion (first time).	Rare	The System decides: usually a Title, sometimes an ongoing trickle of credits
Grease Monkey †	Any	Built a wheeled lure, bomb or similar contraption and sent it into a fight (once ever).	Rare	Box + Title
You Call That a Trap? †	Any	Hurt a mob with a trap or hazard you left lying around on purpose.	Rare	Box (floor tier)

HUMOR AND META

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Hoarder	Any	Carried twenty different junk items at once.	Common	Snark only
Bad Idea Bear	Any	Proposed a plan everyone agreed was terrible, then pulled it off.	Rare	Box + Title
Tutorial Complete	Any	Finished Floor 1 alive.	Common	Title (Oriented)
Season Ticket	Any	Played five sessions.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Rules Lawyer Adjacent	Any	Cited a line of this book that changed a ruling.	Rare	Title (Fine Print)
The Audience Is Watching	Any	Caused a ratings spike.	Rare	Heroic Inspiration, with applause
Achievement for Achievements	Any	Earned 25 achievements in one campaign.	Common	Title (Collector)
Patch Notes Incoming	Any	Survived a rule change in the middle of a floor.	Rare	Box + Title
Murder-Show Smile	Any	Delivered a post-kill one-liner the table was still quoting later.	Common	Snark only
Don't Skip Intro	1	Read or listened to an entire System tutorial popup.	Common	Snark only
First Down	1	Dropped to 0 hit points on Floor 1.	Common	Snark only
Bleed Tax	1	Used up three healing items on one floor.	Common	Snark only

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Floor Bit	1	Started a running joke the table kept using.	Common	Snark only
Scenic Panic	1	Panicked out loud before a fight you then won.	Common	Snark only
Camera Shy	1	Destroyed a camera or a drone.	Common	Snark only
Critical Failure	1	Rolled a natural 1 at the worst possible moment.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Too Proud to Heal	1	Refused healing out of pride.	Common	Title + 25 credits
Soft Open Survivor	2	Cleared Floor 2.	Common	Title + 25 credits

ONCE EVER

A few achievements can only be earned **once per Crawler, ever**, however many floors you see.

ACHIEVEMENT	FLOOR	WHAT YOU DID	RARITY	TYPICAL REWARD
Not Unpacking †	Any	Took a stairwell down within one in-game hour of arriving on a floor.	Legendary	A Platinum box, paid at the floor's ceiling tier, + Title
Down Is a Direction †	Any	Found a stairwell down to the next floor.	Common	Snark only
Left Before the Cake †	Any	Went down a stairwell more than six hours before the floor collapsed.	Rare	Title (Left Before the Cake)

```
[SYSTEM]
Congratulations on finding the stairs! They go down. So, eventually, will you.
```

HOUSE OPTION • INVENTING ACHIEVEMENTS

The best achievements are the ones nobody planned. When the table laughs, gasps or groans at something a Crawler did, that is an achievement. Give it a name that sounds like an accusation, write one line saying what happened, pick a tier from the ladder, and keep the reward inside the floor's ceiling. Most invented achievements should be snark-only or a Title. Save the boxes for deeds the table will still be talking about next session.

QUICK REFERENCE

RULE	SUMMARY
Ability check	d20 + ability modifier + Proficiency Bonus (if proficient) vs DC
DCs	5 / 10 / 15 / 20 / 25 / 30: Very easy to Nearly impossible
Calling the check	The System names ability, skill and DC first when the Crawler would know the stakes; dice in the open; dice stand
Natural 20 or 1	No special effect on ability checks
Expertise	Double Proficiency Bonus for that skill
Passive check	10 + modifiers (+5 Advantage, –5 Disadvantage)
Help	Ally gets Advantage on their next check with a skill or tool you're proficient in
Group check	At least half succeed, everyone succeeds
Contest	Higher total wins; a tie changes nothing

RULE	SUMMARY
Tool + skill	Advantage when you're proficient in both
System skills	+1 rank for meaningful use, a first-time feat, inventive crafting, a potion or guild training; GM grants it, no counters; cap 15 (20 for your species' or class's family); +1 to checks at ranks 5, 10, 15, and +4 at rank 20 for a family skill
Achievements	The System decides; many pay nothing; never XP; no requests
Reward ladder	R0 snark · R1 pocket change · R2 Heroic Inspiration · R3 consumable · R4 Charm · R5 box · R6 Headliner
Credit multiplier	Achievement credits and System fees × 1 / 5 / 20 / 50 by floor band; box credit pulls never
Achievement boxes	Bronze on Floors 1–2 (Silver only from the Boss Box or a stated GM override); floor ceiling always wins; open only in a saferoom
Charms	Hold two; gone when used up or at descent

> [SYSTEM]
> That concludes the skills portion of your evaluation. Your score has been recorded. You may not see it. It is very funny.